

H A B · H E A L T H Y A U T O B U S I N E S S · S A L E S
O P E R A T I N G S Y S T E M

The Advisor Book

The Sales Operating System for Service Advisors

For: Service Advisors, Service Writers, and anyone who answers the phone, greets the customer, presents the DVI, handles the objection, or closes the sale.

This is your playbook from Rookie to Champion — every script, every drill, every mastery gate, complete in one book. From uncertainty to certainty. From script to instinct. From advisor to closer.

8

STEPS

6

OBJECTIVES

5

MASTERY LEVELS

9

BOSS BATTLES

30

NAMED TECHNIQUES

VERSION 2.9 · CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY

DO WHAT'S RIGHT · DO WHAT'S FAIR · DO YOUR BEST

What's New Since Version 1

Your shop received Version 1 of this book. This edition replaces it. Where this book and your memory of the old scripts disagree, this book wins.

WHAT CHANGED	WHAT IT MEANS AT THE COUNTER
The Quick Close opens every inbound call	The call opens by answering the customer's question and closing for the visit in the same breath: "Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?" No shop introduction until the appointment is secured. If they can't come now, East-West scheduling offers two specific times.
The full inbound call in two versions	Version 1 for the direct ask (answer and close immediately) and Version 2 for the price or quote inquiry (concern question, urgency line, no-charge line, then the close). Concern Discovery is a trained checkpoint on every rep.
Say Yes, Get Them In — No Pre-Education	The phone call has one job: say yes and get the vehicle in the door. Questions, urgency, and value framing are allowed; warnings and caveats about whether the requested service will fix the problem are banned until the inspection produces evidence. Never say "not just [what they asked for]," never justify the no-charge line, and meet the price barrier with the warm "Oh, no no" beat first.
Value is stated affirmatively — everywhere	The "not just [what they asked for]" construction is banned in ALL customer-facing dialogue — every script, every boss battle, not only the phone. "Not just X" negates the customer's request and hints at extra, and extra means extra cost in the customer's mind. Every script states the value directly instead.
Tone & Status — the posture of a professional	New Foundation chapter. The advisor is the servant of the customer and never the subordinate: servant posture, equal status, direct speech. The word "just" is coached out as a status leak ("I'm just calling to follow up" becomes "I'm calling with an update on your vehicle"). Rapport and credibility exist to earn the right to shoot straight. Tone is matched to the moment, and the remote-customer inspection video is performed in stage mode: play to the back row.
The Root Concern Rule	Even when the customer names a service and says yes, find the TRUE root concern before writing the job — with questions, never with warnings. The shop never installs a fix for a diagnosis it hasn't confirmed.
The Keys Moment and the Audible	Intake was rebuilt. The real shop tour happens on the walk in (the inspection-rack line), and the waiting-area offer is replaced by the keys moment: "And you're dropping this off with me, right?" If the customer plans to wait, the audible surfaces the single most critical safety concern and shows it in person.
The DVI Timing Rule	Never book the appointment with the inspection — book with the customer's concern. Present the DVI only after the concern is addressed or the first approval is secured, wrapped inside a waiting window (or carried subliminally by the shop introduction video).
The ISO "including" points backward	The total's "including" clause references only work the customer has already approved ("including the oil service you already approved"), never the repair being presented.
Reassurance opens on 2nd and 3rd base	Follow-up calls open by confirming the approved work is already moving, and every new finding is labeled "additional." First base closes by acknowledging the yes, assuming the sale, and introducing the bumper to bumper inspection naturally.
Boss Battle 9 — The Second Opinion	The eight Boss Battles are now nine. The new battle counters "I want a second opinion / I can get it done cheaper" with the Honest Disarm, the Short Stop live play (the Short Stop reinforces the advisor first and never contradicts him), the Repair Plan, and the Customer-for-Life Close — including a full worked example.

Clean-scripts-first format

Every taught script in this book now appears first as a clean script block — labeled speakers only, roleplay-ready — with the teaching after it, never instead of it. The HAB Script Book is the standalone clean companion.

THE HAB OATH

I will assure every customer they called the right place.

I will earn the appointment instead of quoting blindly.

I will run the bases in order.

I will defeat the bosses with words, not arguments.

I will $L \rightarrow A \rightarrow S \rightarrow T$ when things go wrong.

I will treat every car as if it carries my own family.

**DO WHAT'S RIGHT · DO WHAT'S FAIR · DO YOUR
BEST**

ADVISOR SIGNATURE

DATE

Table of Contents

—	Version History — What's New Since Version 1
	Everything that changed since the Version 1 book your shop received
—	Preface — How to Use This Book
	Reading plan, the callout color code, the five levels
Ch 0	Foundation — The Operating System
	Core principle, the six objectives, the 8-step map, the customer's inner journey, the Trust Triangle, the Mastery Ladder
Ch 0.5	Tone & Status — The Posture of a Professional
	Servant posture with equal status, the Status Shrinking anti-pattern and the "just" leak, why rapport and credibility earn the right to shoot straight, tone matching (the Jeremy Miner study), and the two performance modes: counter vs. stage
Ch 1	Establish Rapport — Make a Friend in 90 Seconds
	The psychology, three channels, the 90-second window, the quick close opening, the full inbound call in two versions (direct ask / price-quote inquiry), Concern Discovery, the "and I" line, the four inbound Mini-Bosses, East-West, five mistakes, drills, mastery
Ch 1.5	The "When Is Now a Good Time" Quick Close
	The opening of every inbound call in two patterns: direct ask (answer + close) and price/quote inquiry (concern question → urgency → close) — plus Concern Discovery as a trained checkpoint, the "and I" accountability frame, the process-vs-objectives frame, and the Say Yes, Get Them In — No Pre-Education principle
Ch 2	Establish Credibility — Build Authority
	Trust Triangle in action, shop-tour anatomy, three hidden sales, full tour script, mastery
Ch 3	Collect Data — Get Custody
	Custody psychology, concern vs. symptom, the Root Concern Rule (self-diagnosis defense), the diagnosis funnel, question sequences, the boom board, the Arrival & Intake with the keys moment and the audible
Ch 4	Inspect & Analyze — The DVI Is the X-Ray
	Vehicle Health Dashboard (Green/Yellow/Red), Selling the Inspection Too Early (the DVI timing rule and the waiting window), reciprocity of effort, tech-advisor walk-the-bay
Ch 5	Build & Strategize — Run the Bases
	The Baseball Diamond, Good-Good-Bad, PRS, anti-kitchen-sink, full base-selling scripts: 1st, 2nd, Short Stop, 3rd, Home Plate
Ch 6	Present — Educate Into Certainty
	The confidence curve, re-engagement loops, the 10-step ISO presentation, the water-pump worked example with full anatomy
Ch 7	Overcome Objections — The 9 Boss Battles
	The translation matrix, five universal rules, all nine Boss Battles with full battle scripts and decoders — including Boss 9, the Second Opinion, with the Short Stop live play, the Repair Plan, and the Customer-for-Life Close — and the Boss Rush
Ch 8	Execute — The Close
	Closing starts at hello, the momentum funnel, three close families, Direction-Facing, Home Plate script

Ch 9 **L.A.S.T. — Turn Complaints Into Loyalty**

Service Recovery Paradox, the four beats, the 24-hour window, four hot-counter scripts, five recovery-killers, four drills

App A **The Worked-Example Library**

Eight anatomized 10-step ISO scripts: brakes, suspension, cooling, transmission, electrical, tires, alignment, A/C

App B **The Glossary — 30+ Named Techniques**

Every named technique, principle, and anti-pattern with a one-line definition

App C **The 9 KPIs and Targets**

The shop scoreboard, step mapping, and what a red number actually means

App D **Your Mastery Tracker**

Promotion bars, certification tracker, signature gates, self-audit worksheets

P R E F A C E

How to Use This Book

It's not a binder for the drawer. It's a training weapon for the bench.

This book is your operating manual from your first day as a Rookie to the day customers ask for you by name and you train other advisors. Every script inside has been battle-tested across thousands of real calls. The words are exact. The order matters. The psychology is deliberate. Your job is not to read it — your job is to absorb it until the words disappear and the instinct remains.

One distinction before anything else: the sales PROCESS and the sales OBJECTIVES are two different things. The process is what leads: get the car into the shop, secure the appointment. The objectives — establish rapport, establish credibility, educate the customer — are pursued through and after the close, never in front of it. Every script in this book is built in that order, starting with the very first exchange of the inbound call.

Your Reading Plan

- **Week 0:** Read the Foundation chapter cover-to-cover. Sign the Oath. Commit.
- **Weeks 1–9:** One module per week. Read it Monday. Drill it Tuesday through Friday. Take the Mastery Check in live calls, not in the classroom.
- **After Week 9:** Re-read the Worked-Example Library quarterly. Re-take the Mastery Check for any module where your KPIs slip.

The Callout Color Code

The color tells your brain what kind of thinking to do. Same taxonomy as every HAB artifact.

SCRIPT

The exact words to say. Memorize tone, not just text. Never paraphrase the close.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER

Why the script works on the human brain. Master this and you stop sounding scripted. This is the unlock.

DRILL

A practice rep with scoring. Run with a partner or the AI. Reps build instinct; instinct survives pressure.

MASTERY CHECK

The gate to the next level. Observable behaviors in live calls. Pass = promotion.

STOP

A hard gate. Do not advance until the action is complete. These exist because skipping them has cost real sales.

PRO TIP

A veteran shortcut — earned the hard way so you don't have to.

COACH'S CORNER

How your coach will coach this step — what they listen for, what they score, what they praise, what they correct. Read it so you know what "good" looks like from the other side of the clipboard.

CLEAN SCRIPT

The complete script by itself: labeled speakers only, no teaching, no interruptions. Every taught script in this book appears as a Clean Script FIRST so you can read it straight through in a roleplay session. The teaching (decoders, callouts, drills) always follows the clean version. It never replaces it.

The Five Levels

- 1 Rookie** — Reads scripts. Survives calls. No improvisation. Goal: don't lose a customer.
- 2 Advisor** — Runs scripts naturally. Identifies concern vs. symptom. Books appointments without quoting.
- 3 Closer** — Owns East-West. Runs the bases in order. PRS by heart. Customers feel informed, not sold.
- 4 Pro** — Defeats all 9 Boss Battles. Re-opens missed sales. Coaches Rookies in their downtime.
- 5 Champion** — Customers request you by name. You build the book. You train other advisors. You own culture.

Promotion is evidence-based — mastery checks passed in live customer calls. Never tenure. Never vibes.

Foundation — The Operating System

The principle behind every word, drill, and KPI in this book.

The Core Principle

Sales is not persuasion. Sales is the systematic reduction of uncertainty.
We do not sell repairs. We manufacture certainty — and certainty buys repairs by itself.

Every customer who calls a shop is operating in a fog. Uncertain whether the noise is dangerous. Uncertain whether they're about to be taken advantage of. Uncertain whether the price will be fair, whether the shop can be trusted, about their car, about themselves. That fog is the real problem we solve. Repairs are simply the byproduct.

Your job is to be the lighthouse. Each of the eight steps in this system removes one specific kind of uncertainty. When all eight are removed, the customer doesn't feel sold — they feel **guided**. And guided customers come back, refer their friends, and never haggle.

CUSTOMER ENTERS	CUSTOMER LEAVES
Uncertain · Fearful · Defensive · Confused	Educated · Confident · Safe · Loyal

Sales Process vs. Sales Objectives

Two different things, never to be confused. The sales **process** is the sequence of actions that gets the car into the shop and the work authorized — it leads, always. The sales **objectives** are the relationship outcomes — rapport, credibility, education — pursued through and after every close, never in front of one. The process secures the appointment; the objectives make the customer glad it did. When an advisor recites a shop introduction before answering the customer's question, the objectives have been allowed to block the process. That is backwards, and this book corrects it starting with the very first line of the inbound call.

The Six Sales Objectives

Underneath the 8 process steps live 6 unchanging objectives. Securing the vehicle leads the list — every other objective is pursued through and after it. Every move you make — every word, pause, walk, and inspection — must serve at least one. If a behavior serves none of them, it's waste motion. Cut it.

#	OBJECTIVE	WHAT IT MEANS
1	Get Custody	Get the car into the shop. Secure the appointment. The car in our bay is the only car we can save — custody gates every other objective.
2	Build Relationship	Make a friend. Become the human the customer trusts before they trust the shop. Pursued through and after the close, never blocking it.
3	Separate Customer From Vehicle	Emotional distance from the car allows logical decisions. The keys moment and transportation options do real selling work. Offering the waiting area does not accomplish separation; if the customer stays, the advisor calls the audible.
4	Identify True Vehicle Health	A complete, honest, documented picture. The DVI is our X-ray.
5	Educate the Customer	An informed customer is a confident customer. A confident customer authorizes work.
6	Deliver a Safe & Reliable Vehicle	The repair is the receipt. The relationship is the asset.

The 8-Step Sales Process

The steps run in order. They are not menu items. Skipping a step doesn't save time — it forces a re-do later in the call, or kills the sale. If a later step is failing, the cause is almost always an earlier step that was rushed or skipped.

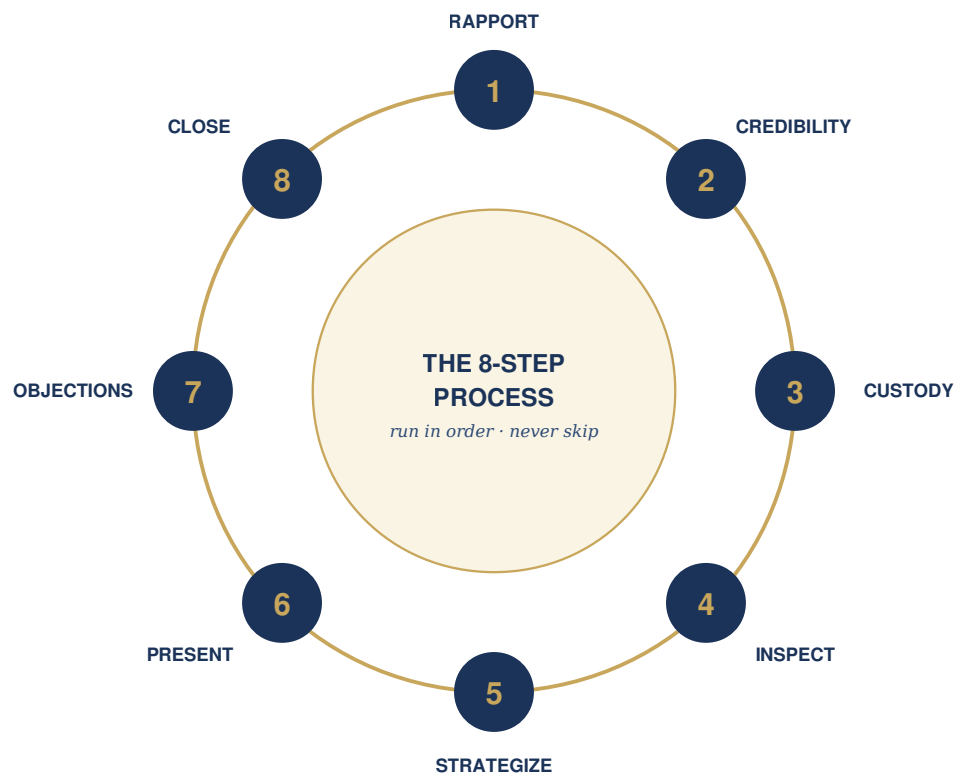


Figure 0.1 · The 8-step wheel — Step 1 at 12 o'clock, clockwise, one direction only

#	STEP	PRIMARY OBJECTIVE	UNCERTAINTY REMOVED	LEADING KPI
1	Establish Rapport	Make a friend	"Are these people safe?"	Greet-to-tour conversion
2	Establish Credibility	Build authority	"Do they know what they're doing?"	Tour-to-DVI consent
3	Collect Data	Get custody	"What's actually wrong?"	Inquiry-to-RO conversion
4	Inspect & Analyze	Identify true vehicle health	"How bad is it really?"	DVI w/ media %
5	Build & Strategize	Sequence the conversation	"Where do we start?"	Base-order compliance
6	Present	Educate the customer	"Why does this matter?"	DVI view-rate & PRS adherence
7	Overcome Objections	Resolve hesitation	"Should I really do this?"	1st-objection close rate
8	Execute / Close	Deliver commitment	"What happens next?"	Authorized ÷ presented

The Customer's Internal Journey

Sales is two parallel tracks: what you do and what the customer feels. You control the first. The second is the actual scoreboard. Track both.

STEP	YOUR ACTION	INNER VOICE — BEFORE	INNER VOICE — AFTER
1 Rapport	Smile, pause, "right place," close for the visit.	"Am I about to get hustled?"	"Okay, this person seems normal."
2 Credibility	Shop tour, ASE, warranty, transport.	"Do they even know what they're doing?"	"These guys are legit."
3 Custody	Keys + boom board + concern documented.	"What if it's something huge?"	"At least it's in good hands."
4 Inspect	Full DVI, photos, video, tech sync.	"Are they going to invent stuff?"	"Wow, they actually looked at everything."
5 Strategize	Good-Good-Bad sequenced, bases set.	(unseen)	(unseen)
6 Present	PRS, video, micro-commitments.	"Is this real or upsell?"	"I see exactly what they see."
7 Objections	Listen, reframe, payment options.	"I'm not sure I want to do this."	"That actually makes sense."
8 Close	Assumptive close, direction-facing.	"Did I just agree to spend that?"	"Glad it's handled."

The Invisible Scorecard — The Trust Triangle

Every customer silently grades you on three traits, in this order. Score all three and price becomes irrelevant. Lose any one leg and price becomes the only conversation you will ever have.

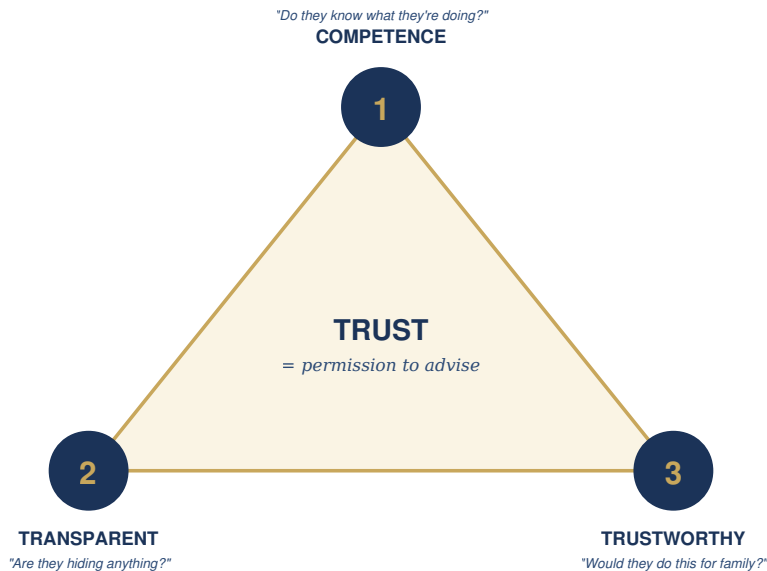


Figure 0.2 · The Trust Triangle — three legs, no shortcuts. Score all three → price is irrelevant.

LEG	THE CUSTOMER'S QUESTION	WHERE YOU BUILD IT
Competence	"Do they know what they're doing?"	M2 and M4 — the tour, the credentials, the DVI craft.
Transparent	"Are they hiding anything?"	M4 and M6 — co-review, photos, plain language, warranty disclosed.
Trustworthy	"Would they do this for family?"	M5 and M7 — Good-Good-Bad, safety over revenue, recommending what's right even when it costs a sale today.

The Mastery Ladder

Promotion is not a calendar event. It is an evidence-based gate. You move through five levels on observable behavior in live calls — not tenure, not opinion, not vibes. The Advisor-to-Closer jump is the hardest. The Pro-to-Champion jump is the longest. The full promotion bars live in Appendix D.

PRO TIP

The whole book in one sentence: remove the customer's uncertainty one step at a time, in order, with evidence — and the close takes care of itself.

Tone & Status — The Posture of a Professional

Mission: Serve completely. Speak as an equal. The customer cannot follow an advisor who asks permission to lead.

This chapter removes the uncertainty: **"Can I put my car — and my family — in this person's hands?"**

POSTURE	STATUS	CORE SKILL	FAILURE MODE
SERVANT, NOT SUBORDINATE	EQUAL, ALWAYS	tone matching	STATUS SHRINKING

Status — The Servant Is Not the Subordinate

Everything in this book is service. We hold the door, we fetch the coffee, we shuttle the customer home, and we photograph every finding so the customer never has to take our word for anything. The advisor is the servant of the customer — and the advisor is never the customer's subordinate. Those are two different things, and the entire system depends on keeping them separate.

Think about the professionals whose advice you actually take. They serve you completely — and they speak to you as equals, plainly and directly. The moment a professional starts talking UP to the customer, their advice stops sounding like expertise and starts sounding like a request. An advisor who lowers their own status to elevate the customer's has not made the customer feel important. They have made the customer feel unadvised.

We never lower our status to elevate the customer's. We serve as equals — that is what makes the service worth anything.

The "Just" Leak — How Status Escapes One Word at a Time

Status doesn't collapse in one sentence. It leaks — and the most common leak in this industry is the word **"just."** "I'm just calling to follow up." "I just wanted to check in." "Sorry to bother you, I just had a quick question."

Underneath, every one of those sentences says the same two things: *my time is not as valuable as yours*, and *is it okay that I'm talking to you?* The customer hears an apology for the call before they have heard the reason for the call. We never do this.

The anti-pattern has a name: **Status Shrinking** — diminishing language that shrinks the advisor so the customer feels bigger. It reads as politeness. It performs as surrender. It gets coached out of every advisor in this system, because in a few hours this same voice will ask the customer to trust it with their family's brakes.

STATUS SHRINKING (NEVER)	EQUAL STATUS (ALWAYS)
"I'm just calling to follow up."	"I'm calling with an update on your vehicle."
"I just wanted to check in on the estimate."	"I told you I'd call when the estimate was ready. It's ready, and I'll walk you through it."
"Sorry to bother you, I just had a quick question."	"I have one question for you before my technician moves forward."
"Whenever you get a chance, no rush."	"Call me back by 2 o'clock so we can keep your repair moving."
"I'm just the service advisor."	"I'm your service advisor, and I'm handling your vehicle personally."

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY STATUS LEAKS KILL AUTHORIZATION

Every presentation in this system ends with the customer accepting professional judgment they can see evidence for but cannot fully evaluate themselves. That transfer of trust only happens between equals — nobody hands their family's safety to a voice that asked permission to speak. When the advisor opens with "I'm just calling to," the education in Step 6 has already been re-labeled: it will land as a pitch from a salesperson instead of a finding from a professional. The words that follow can be perfect and it won't matter. Status is set in the first sentence, and every sentence after it is heard through that setting.

Why Rapport and Credibility Exist — The Right to Shoot Straight

Here is the deeper why behind Modules 1 and 2 — the reason both of them exist at all: **customers like directness most of all**. More than warmth, more than politeness, more than a deal, what a customer wants from a shop is a straight answer from someone who knows. But directness cannot be deployed cold. A direct sentence from a stranger is an attack; the same sentence from a trusted advisor is a gift. You cannot be direct with someone until rapport and credibility are established.

That is what the first two modules are actually FOR. Rapport is not friendliness for its own sake, and credibility is not bragging rights. They are the license to shoot straight. Ninety seconds of rapport and a ninety-second tour buy you the right to tell a customer their brake pads are done and that the car should not carry their kids until the pads are replaced — and to have that received as care instead of pressure.

Rapport and credibility are not the product. They are the license. The product is the straight answer the customer came for.

Tone — The Delivery System

Status is the posture; tone is the delivery. The same words at a different pace and pitch are a different message. "You've got to have it inspected" delivered fast and flat is a line being read. Delivered slower, a note lower, with genuine concern, it is a professional worrying about your car. The customer does not simply hear what you say — the customer hears what your tone tells them you mean. The skill is **matching the delivery to what the customer needs to hear in that moment**.

THE MOMENT	THE DELIVERY
Concern discovery ("What kind of concern are you having?")	Slow down. Drop the pitch. Soft and curious — an invitation, not an interrogation.
The urgency line ("Oh my goodness...")	Energy up, genuine concern. The words carry the urgency; the tone is what makes it real.
Investment + coverage	Even, steady, unhurried. A calm statement of fact from someone with nothing to hide.
Objections and Boss Battles	Slower and softer, curious rather than adamant. A calm question outperforms a firm rebuttal.
Recovery (L.A.S.T.)	The lowest, slowest tone you own. Match the customer's gravity, never their volume.

PRO TIP · THE RECOMMENDED STUDY: JEREMY MINER

For tone, the HAB-recommended outside study is Jeremy Miner's NEPQ material — *The New Model of Selling* and the NEPQ Black Book. Steal four things from it: slowing the pace, lowering the tone, softer curious approaches instead of firm adamant statements, and matching your delivery to the moment so the customer HEARS what you need them to hear. Ten minutes of study a week, one tone behavior drilled per morning huddle.

Stage vs. Counter — Two Performance Modes

Tone has one more dimension: the room. The same inspection is delivered in one of two rooms, and each demands the opposite performance.

COUNTER MODE — CUSTOMER PRESENT IN THE SHOP	STAGE MODE — CUSTOMER REMOTE, RECEIVING THE INSPECTION BY VIDEO
Quieter. Calmer. More direct. The evidence is physically in front of you both — point at it and lower your voice. In person, calm volume IS authority: a professional with real findings doesn't need to perform them.	Theater. You are on stage playing to the back row: exaggerate your expression, your vocal energy, and your tone. The performance that would feel oversized at the counter is exactly what grabs and holds attention through a phone screen.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY THE CAMERA NEEDS THE BACK ROW

A phone screen strips away most of what carries your meaning in person — the eye contact, the shared room, the physical evidence you can point to. What survives the trip is maybe half your energy, and it arrives competing with every notification on the customer's phone. Stage actors solved this problem centuries ago: play to the back row. Project past the distance so that what lands is a person worth watching. What feels like "too much" in the bay arrives as "engaging" on the screen — and an inspection video that holds attention to the last second is the difference between a customer who watched their evidence and one who skimmed it. Full camera craft: Chapter 4.

Drills — Build the Posture

DRILL 0.A · THE JUST AUDIT

Setup: record (or have your coach audit) five of your customer calls.

Score: count every "just," every apology for calling, every permission-to-speak opener.

Goal: zero across five consecutive calls. Every "just" gets rewritten out loud as an update ("I'm calling with an update on your vehicle") on the spot.

DRILL 0.B · ONE LINE, FOUR DELIVERIES

Setup: take one script line. Deliver it four ways: fast and flat, firm and adamant, slow and low and curious, full stage energy.

Score: the team votes on which delivery they would buy from, and says why.

Goal: hearing the difference on demand — then producing it on demand.

DRILL 0.C · BACK-ROW REPS

Setup: record the same DVI finding twice — once at counter energy, once at stage energy. Watch both on a phone, not a monitor.

Score: attention held, 1–10, scored by a teammate watching cold.

Goal: the stage version scores 8+ and does not feel like "too much" on the screen. It won't.

MASTERY CHECK · TONE & STATUS

- ☐ Zero status-shrinking language across three consecutive audited calls: no "just," no apology for calling, no permission-to-speak openers.
- ☐ Every follow-up call opened with the reason stated as an update, delivered as an equal.
- ☐ Demonstrated tone matching live: soft and curious on discovery, even and steady through investment + coverage.
- ☐ One remote-customer inspection video recorded in stage mode, scored 8+ for attention-hold by the coach — on a phone screen.
- ☐ Can explain, unprompted, why rapport and credibility exist: they earn the right to shoot straight.

COACH'S CORNER · TONE AND STATUS GET COACHED BEFORE WORDS

Your coach audits delivery before content: status leaks get counted on every audited call (the word "just" is the tell), tone gets coached one variable at a time (pace, then pitch, then energy — never all three in one rep), and one of your inspection videos gets reviewed each week on a phone screen, never a monitor. The scoring lens for all of it is a single question: **did the customer HEAR what we needed them to hear?** Full coaching protocol: Coach's Book, Coaching Tone & Status.

Establish Rapport

Mission: Make a friend in the first 90 seconds. Become the human the customer trusts before they trust the shop.

This step removes the uncertainty: **"Am I going to be sold or helped here?"**

OBJECTIVE MAKE A FRIEND	TIME WINDOW 90 SECONDS	PRIMARY KPI GREET → TOUR %	FAILURE MODE SOUNDS SCRIPTED
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Mission Brief

Rapport is not small talk. Rapport is the moment a stranger's nervous system relaxes enough to receive information. Every other step in this system — credibility, custody, inspection, presentation, close — is gated by this one. If the customer is still in fight-or-flight when you start talking about a water pump, they will not hear the water pump. They will hear a salesperson.

So the first 90 seconds are not a warm-up. They are the highest-leverage 90 seconds of the entire sale. Spend them deliberately.

A customer in rapport authorizes work. A customer out of rapport authorizes nothing — not even a free inspection.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE DEEPER WHY — RAPPORT BUYS THE RIGHT TO SHOOT STRAIGHT

Remember what rapport is FOR (Chapter 0.5): customers like directness most of all, but directness cannot be deployed cold. A direct sentence from a stranger is an attack; the same sentence from a trusted advisor is a gift. These 90 seconds are not the product — they are the license that lets every straight answer later in the call land as care instead of pressure. And while you build it, hold your status: warm, serving, and equal. Never shrinking.

The Psychology — Why Rapport Works

When a stranger calls or walks in, their brain runs a sub-second threat assessment. Two questions get answered before any conscious thought: *Is this person safe?* and *Are they like me?* If the answer to either is "no," the reasoning brain goes offline and every word out of your mouth gets filtered through suspicion. Rapport flips both answers to "yes" in under 90 seconds — not by tricking the customer, but by deliberately producing the signals their nervous system is scanning for. Three mechanisms do the heavy lifting:

MECHANISM	HOW IT WORKS
Mirror Neurons	Humans unconsciously copy the emotional state of the person in front of them. Smile, and they smile. Tense up at the price, and they tense up. You set the emotional thermostat for the room.
Limbic Resonance	Pace and rhythm sync between two people in conversation. A calm, confident advisor pulls a panicked customer down into calm. A rushed advisor speeds the customer up into hesitation. Pace controls trust.
Reciprocity	Give first — a warm greeting, a glass of water, eye contact — and the brain creates a tiny obligation. That obligation is what later gets cashed in as "sure, let's do the inspection."

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY "ABSOLUTELY, YOU'VE CALLED THE RIGHT PLACE" LANDS HARDER THAN "HI, HOW CAN I HELP?"

The brain is scanning for relief. "Absolutely" answers the customer's exact question — their stated concern is acknowledged in the very first word they hear back. "You've called the right place" is a one-sentence relief delivery: it tells the nervous system "you can stop searching, you can stop comparing, the threat is resolved." The body literally exhales. From that exhale forward, everything you say is heard by the reasoning brain instead of being filtered by suspicion — which is exactly why the closing ask ("Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?") rides in the same breath. This is why we never replace this line with "Sure, we can do that." "Sure" is information. "Right place" is relief. And relief is the moment to close.

The Three Channels of Rapport

Rapport is transmitted on three channels simultaneously. Break any one and the customer's nervous system gets a mixed signal and defaults back to suspicion.

CHANNEL	WHAT "ON" LOOKS LIKE	WHAT "OFF" LOOKS LIKE	HOW TO TRAIN
Tone	Voice slightly higher at the greeting (the smile is audible), slows down at "right place," warm on the customer's name.	Monotone. Reads the script. Sounds like the third call in a row.	Record the greeting. Listen back. If you can't hear the smile, you didn't smile.
Words	"You called the right place." "Oh my goodness." "Absolutely." First-person ownership: "my certified technician and I..."	"Sure." "Yeah." "Uh, we can do that." Third-person dodges: "the tech will..."	Script-shadowing — trainer says the line, you immediately repeat with the same inflection.
Body	Stands up at the desk. Eye contact within 2 seconds. Smile precedes words. Open posture.	Stays seated. Looks at the screen. Greeting from behind a monitor. Crossed arms.	The stand-and-smile drill: every time the front bell rings, stand before you speak.

PRO TIP · TONE IS A STUDY, NOT A TALENT — AND WATCH THE STATUS INSIDE THE WORDS

The Tone channel has its own foundation chapter (Chapter 0.5) and its own recommended outside study, Jeremy Miner's NEPQ: slow the pace, lower the tone, stay curious instead of adamant. And inside the Words channel, listen for status: the word "just" ("I'm just calling to follow up") is a status leak, not politeness — it tells the customer your time is worth less than theirs. State the reason as an equal: "I'm calling with an update on your vehicle."

The 90-Second Friendship Window

The clock starts the instant the phone rings or the front door opens. After 90 seconds, the first impression locks in — nearly impossible to overturn later. Use the window deliberately, in four moves:

0S	15S	45S	75–90S
GREETING smile + name + pause	QUICK CLOSE direct ask: answer + close · quote ask: concern question → urgency → close	BRANCH "Have you been with us before?" / no-charge "and I" line / East-West	PROFILE + CONCERN booking locked, concern documented → friend made

Scripts — The Full Inbound Call, in Two Versions

First, the entire call, clean — and it comes in **two versions**, because customers open in two different ways. **Version 1** is the customer who is ready with a direct ask ("do you work on brakes?"): answer the question and close for the visit immediately. **Version 2** is the price or quote inquiry ("I was hoping to get a quote on some brakes"): ask for the concern first, amplify the urgency, THEN close. The concern feeds the urgency; the urgency feeds the close. Both versions serve the same goal: **get the car into the shop**. Both open with the "When Is Now a Good Time" Quick Close discipline (taught in depth in Chapter 1.5), and in both, **Concern Discovery is a trained checkpoint**: before the call ends you must be able to state the customer's true concern in their own words. If you can't state it, you ask for it.

[Pick up before the third ring. Smile before you speak.]

Advisor: "Thank you for calling [Shop]. My name is [Your Name]." *[Pause. Let the customer speak.]*

Customer: "Hi, do you work on brakes?"

Advisor: "Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?"

Customer: "Yeah, I can head over now."

Advisor: "Great, have you been with us before?"

BRANCH A · FIRST-TIME CUSTOMER

Customer: "No, this will be my first time."

Advisor: "Thank you so much for choosing us! We are [Shop], your certified dealer alternative, located at [address], open six days a week from [store hours]. We have ASE and dealer-certified technicians ready to handle all of your vehicle needs, from tires and service to major repairs. We stand behind our work with warranties up to 3 years or 36,000 miles. We also offer complimentary shuttles, vehicle pick-up and drop-off, ride services, rental car reimbursement, and loaner vehicles when available! Stay with me really quick while I gather your information to build a customer profile."

[Gather name, number, email, vehicle year, make, and model.]

Advisor: "And so I can point our technician at exactly the right thing, what kind of concern are you having with your brakes?"

Customer: "They squeak when I stop."

Advisor: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians, so I'm glad you're coming in. Perfect, [Customer Name], you're all set. We'll see you and your vehicle shortly!"

[Trained checkpoint — Concern Discovery: concern captured in the customer's own words before the call ends.]

BRANCH B · RETURNING CUSTOMER

Customer: "Yes, I've been in before."

Advisor: "Welcome back! Is this still the best number for you?"

Customer: "Yes it is."

Advisor: "Perfect, I have your profile pulled up. Since your last visit, [brief shop news: a new certification, new equipment, a new team member, or what's new around the shop]. What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?"

[Capture the concern, deliver the urgency line, and confirm the vehicle before the call ends. Customers visit only 2 to 4 times a year; the shop-news update re-syncs the rapport.]

BRANCH D · CAN'T COME NOW

Customer: "I can't come in right now."

Advisor: "Okay, no worries. I've got 11:15 or 2:15 open today. Which works best for you?"

Customer: "2:15 works."

Advisor: "Perfect, [Customer Name], you're set for 2:15. What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?"

Customer: "They squeak when I stop."

Advisor: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians, so I'm glad we've got you in at 2:15. We'll see you and your vehicle then!"

[First-time: run the Branch A introduction and build the profile. Returning: confirm the number and share the shop news.]

CLEAN SCRIPT · FULL INBOUND CALL — VERSION 2 · PRICE / QUOTE INQUIRY

[Pick up before the third ring. Smile before you speak.]

Advisor: "Thank you for calling [Shop]. My name is [Your Name]." *[Pause. Let the customer speak.]*

Customer: "Hi, I was hoping to get a quote on some brakes."

Advisor: "Yeah, absolutely, you've called the right place. What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?"

Customer: "They're squeaking when I drive."

Advisor: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

[Trained checkpoint — Concern Discovery: on every vague or quote call, the concern question comes before the close.]

IF THE CUSTOMER PUSHES FOR A PRICE

Customer: "Well, how much is it going to cost?"

Advisor: "At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your complete brake system and provide you a written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

Customer: "Okay, yeah, I can come in now."

Advisor: "Great, have you been with us before?"

[Carry on with the full inbound call: first-time introduction and profile, or best-number check and shop news. The concern is already documented.]

IF THE CUSTOMER CAN'T COME NOW

Customer: "I can't come in right now."

Advisor: "Okay, no worries. With that squeak coming from your brake system, we don't want to leave it unchecked long. I've got 11:15 or 2:15 open today. Which works best for you?"

Customer: "2:15 works."

Advisor: "Perfect, [Customer Name], you're set for 2:15. We'll see you and your vehicle then!"

Now the same call, taught beat by beat.

STOP · THE GOLDEN RULE

Your immediate goal is NOT a sale. It is to convert the inquiry into a vehicle committed for service. Quote a price over the phone and you lose both the sale and the relationship.

SCRIPT · THE GREETING — PICK UP BEFORE RING THREE

Ring-Ring. The phone should NEVER ring more than twice.

You: [SMILE] "Thank you for calling [Shop]. My name is [Your Name]." [PAUSE]

You: [Let the customer speak.] If they hesitate: "How can I help you today?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY THE PAUSE WINS

The intentional pause grabs the caller's attention and shifts them into listening mode. The brief silence is a confident, human conversational handoff — it signals it's the customer's turn to speak, prevents them from feeling rushed, and tells their subconscious you are present and in control.

SCRIPT · THE "WHEN IS NOW A GOOD TIME" QUICK CLOSE — THE FIRST EXCHANGE, EVERY CALL

Customer: "Do you work on brakes?" / "Do you do tires?" / "Can you look at my A/C?" / "I need an alignment."

You: "Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?"

The rule: "Absolutely" answers the customer's exact question. Then you close for the visit. No shop address, no first-time question, no introduction before the close. **The one exception:** when the request is vague or a quote ("I was hoping to get a quote on some brakes"), the concern question comes first — see Concern Discovery below. Direct ask: close immediately. Vague or quote ask: concern question, urgency line, then close.

SCRIPT · CONCERN DISCOVERY BEFORE THE CLOSE — THE VAGUE OR QUOTE CALL

Customer: "Hi, I was hoping to get a quote on some brakes."

You: "Yeah, absolutely, you've called the right place. What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?"

Customer: "They're squeaking when I drive."

You: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

The chain: the concern feeds the urgency; the urgency feeds the close. A quote request carries no urgency of its own — the concern behind it does. Ask for the concern, amplify it, then close. This is a **trained checkpoint**: in every rehearsal and every live call, you must be able to state the customer's true concern before the call ends. If you can't state it, ask.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY THE CONCERN QUESTION OUTSELLS THE QUOTE

A customer asking for a quote has framed the call as commodity shopping: same part, lowest number wins. The concern question breaks that frame in one move. "What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?" tells the customer you diagnose vehicles, not price menus — and their answer hands you the real reason they picked up the phone. Now the urgency line speaks to THEIR squeak, THEIR brake system, THEIR safety, and the close that follows ("Is now a good time to bring it in?") lands as the obvious next step instead of a sales move. Quote callers who hear a number call the next shop. Quote callers who hear their own concern reflected back with urgency book the visit.

STOP · NEVER SCRIPT PAST THE CUSTOMER'S STATED CONCERN

The old anti-pattern: the customer asks "do you work on brakes?" and the advisor recites the shop introduction — address, hours, warranties — before ever answering the question. That teaches the advisor to ignore the customer. The customer asked one thing. Answer it ("Absolutely"), close for the visit, and let the introduction come after the yes. The introduction is an objective; the close is the process. Process leads.

SCRIPT · AFTER THE YES — THE BRANCH QUESTION

Customer: "Yeah, I can head over now."

You: "Great, have you been with us before?"

SCRIPT · BRANCH A — FIRST-TIME CUSTOMER

Customer: "No, this will be my first time."

You: "Thank you so much for choosing us! We are [Shop], your certified dealer alternative, located at [address], open six days a week from [store hours]. We have ASE and dealer-certified technicians ready to handle all of your vehicle needs, from tires and service to major repairs. We stand behind our work with warranties up to 3 years or 36,000 miles. We also offer complimentary shuttles, vehicle pick-up and drop-off, ride services, rental car reimbursement, and loaner vehicles when available! Stay with me really quick while I gather your information to build a customer profile." *(Send the shop introduction link. Document the concern while you build the profile.)*

SCRIPT · BRANCH B — RETURNING CUSTOMER

Customer: "Yes, I've been in before."

You: "Welcome back! Is this still the best number for you?"

Customer: "Yes it is."

You: "Perfect, I have your profile pulled up. Since your last visit, [brief shop news: a new certification, new equipment, a new team member, or what's new around the shop]. We'll see you and your vehicle shortly!"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY RETURNING CUSTOMERS GET SHOP NEWS

A returning customer visits only 2 to 4 times a year. In the months between visits the relationship goes cold, and a cold relationship negotiates like a stranger. A 15-second update on what's new at the shop — a certification earned, a bay added, a face they'll recognize — re-syncs the rapport and reminds them they belong here. Confirm the number, share the news, and the conversation starts warm again.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · CONCERN VS. SYMPTOM

Ask clarifying questions to identify the customer's root **concern** rather than just the symptom they present. "I need new brakes" is a symptom statement — the concern might be a wheel bearing, a stuck caliper, or a low-friction tire. Understand the underlying issue before giving any advice. Full treatment in Chapter 3.

SCRIPT · THE CONCERN QUESTION + URGENCY LINE — THE PIVOT THAT RUNS IN EVERY VERSION

You: "What kind of concern are you having with your [brakes / tires / engine / A/C]?"

Customer: States the concern — "They're squeaking when I drive." / "My tires are getting low." / "The oil light came on." / "My car is pulling to the left."

You: "Oh my goodness, when you have [the customer's exact concern] coming from your [system], you've got to have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians, so we'll get that handled when you're here."

Placement: in Version 2 (vague or quote ask) the concern question comes BEFORE the close — it builds the urgency that powers the close. In Version 1 (direct ask) the close comes first and the concern is captured while you build the profile or confirm the appointment. Either way, the call never ends without it.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE POWER OF "OH MY GOODNESS" + "WHEN"

The exclamation conveys urgency — it signals the concern matters and deserves immediate resolution. Saying "when you have a squeak coming from your brake system," not "if," presupposes the concern is real. The brain skips past *whether* and lands on *what now*. Naming the system ("your brake system," not just "your brakes") quietly upgrades the stakes from a part to a safety system. Be ready with a future appointment or vehicle-retrieval logistics if the customer can't come in immediately.

SCRIPT · THE PRICE PUSH — THE NO-CHARGE "AND I" LINE

Customer: "Well, how much is it going to cost?"

You: "At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your complete brake system and provide you a written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

The rule holds: a price question gets the no-charge inspection and the same close, never a number. Circle back to the close after the line, every time. The full price counters live in the Four Inbound Mini-Bosses below; why the "and I" matters is taught right here.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY "AND I" — THE PERSONAL ACCOUNTABILITY FRAME

The line is not "my technician will inspect it." It is "my certified technician AND I." Those two words are a personal promise, and you keep every part of it: **(1)** you make sure the technician understands the customer's concern exactly as the customer stated it; **(2)** you inspect the vehicle WITH the technician and document what you both see; **(3)** YOU personally build the written estimate — the tech doesn't; and **(4)** you use the line to educate the customer on that workflow, so they know exactly what happens to their car and are never just handed off and left waiting two hours in the lobby wondering. The customer hears one human being take ownership of their vehicle and their concern. That is the first step of rapport — accountability before acquaintance. And once the promise is made, circle back to the close: "Is now a good time to bring it in?"

SCRIPT · BRANCH D — CAN'T COME NOW: EAST-WEST SCHEDULING, CARRYING THE URGENCY

Customer: "I can't come in right now."

You: "Okay, no worries. With that squeak coming from your brake system, we don't want to leave it unchecked long. I've got **11:15** or **2:15** open today. Which works best for you?"

Then: lock the time and run the first-time or returning branch. If the concern isn't captured yet (Version 1 calls), ask the concern question right after the time locks and tie the urgency line to the booked slot: "so I'm glad we've got you in at 2:15." The urgency you built from the concern rides INTO the scheduling — "no worries" stays warm, but the reason to come in never drops out of the call. Two specific options keep the decision binary; a same-day slot keeps the close alive.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY EAST-WEST BEATS "WHAT TIME WORKS?"

Open-ended scheduling forces the customer to pick from infinity — and the brain's default response to that work is hesitation. Two specific options collapse infinity into a binary, and most humans answer a binary on the first try. The rules: always two options at specific off-hour times, one earlier and one later ("I've got 11:15 or 2:15 open today"); state them firmly, no "uh" or "maybe"; close with a choice question; and when the concern is already on the table, let the urgency lead into the options ("With that squeak coming from your brake system, we don't want to leave it unchecked long"). If they hesitate: "What's on your mind?" If they ask for a different time, re-anchor: "The closest options I have are 2:15 or 2:45." Bonus: East-West builds a balanced appointment book and quietly signals your calendar is real and full — an authority cue.

STOP · END THE CALL ONLY WHEN...

The information required to create an RO or appointment — with the customer concern documented — has been gathered, OR you have sent the appointment confirmation / RO estimate with the concern documented.

SCRIPT · THE ARRIVAL (IN PERSON)

You: [Greet at the front door or parking lot, boom board in hand] "Welcome to [Shop]. I'm [Your Name] and I'll be taking care of you today, may I have your keys, please?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY WE ASK FOR THE KEYS FIRST

Asking for the keys is the lightest possible custody request. It signals competence, gives the customer something physical to do with their hands, and produces a tiny act of compliance — the first "yes" in the relationship. From that yes forward, every subsequent yes is easier. This is **commitment momentum**: people stay consistent with their last small action.

PRO TIP · USE THE CUSTOMER'S NAME THREE TIMES IN THE FIRST TWO MINUTES

Once on the greeting, once during the concern pivot, once at the hand-off to the tour. After three uses, the relationship feels personal to the customer's subconscious. Don't overdo it — four-plus in two minutes flips to creepy.

The Four Inbound Mini-Bosses

Four objections live on every inbound call. Each has a tell — the line the customer says — and a counter you deliver without hesitation. Drill them until you counter on reflex.

MINI-BOSS 1 · "JUST TELL ME HOW MUCH IT WILL COST."

Customer: "Yeah, I just want to know how much it will cost before I come in."

Advisor: "AT NO CHARGE TO YOU, my certified technician AND I will inspect your vehicle and provide you with a complete written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

MINI-BOSS 2 · "I ALREADY HAVE A QUOTE."

Customer: "I have a quote already from another shop. That's why I'm just looking for a price."

Advisor: "Oh, excellent! If you can bring that with you, that would be tremendously helpful! We have a Meet-or-Beat policy that allows us to price-match like-for-like quotes if we don't naturally beat the price with our estimate. To give you the most accurate pricing, though, it's best if my certified technician and I take a look first to identify exactly what's needed to fix the [customer concern]. When should we expect to see the vehicle?"

MINI-BOSS 3 · "DO YOU HAVE A BALLPARK?"

Customer: "Do you have a ballpark for me? I just want to know roughly how much."

Advisor: "I completely understand! At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your vehicle and provide a complete written estimate so you can make informed decisions. If budget is your primary concern, I will work with you to select cost-effective solutions that still carry good warranty coverage on parts and labor. As far as a ballpark, I can pull up a tool we use called RepairPal and give you an idea of what something like this normally costs to repair."

MINI-BOSS 4 · "LET ME THINK ABOUT IT."

Customer: "I'm not sure yet. Let me think about it."

Advisor: "I completely understand. Before you decide, may I ask what's most important to you: price, turnaround time, or overall service?" *[Listen carefully.]*

SCRIPT · MINI-BOSS #1 — "JUST TELL ME HOW MUCH IT WILL COST."

They say: "Yeah, I just want to know how much it will cost before I come in."

You say: (confident tone) "AT NO CHARGE TO YOU, my certified technician AND I will inspect your vehicle and provide you with a complete written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

Why it works: reframes the price ask into a free personal benefit, and "AND I" makes it a personal promise — you take accountability for the concern, inspect with the tech, and build the estimate yourself. The closing question assumes the appointment, not the price quote.

SCRIPT · MINI-BOSS #2 — "I ALREADY HAVE A QUOTE FROM ANOTHER SHOP."

They say: "I have a quote already from another shop, that's why I'm just looking for a price."

You say: "Oh, excellent! If you can bring that with you, that would be tremendously helpful! We have a Meet-or-Beat policy that allows us to price-match like-for-like quotes if we don't naturally beat the price with our estimate. To give you the most accurate pricing, though, it's best if our certified technician takes a look first to identify exactly what's needed to fix the [customer concern]. When should we expect to see the vehicle?"

Why it works: "Excellent!" disarms the comparison shopper. Meet-or-Beat lowers risk. Then a hard pivot to the appointment.

SCRIPT · MINI-BOSS #3 — "DO YOU HAVE A BALLPARK?"

They say: "Yeah, but do you have a ballpark for me? I just want to know roughly how much."

You say: "I completely understand! At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your vehicle and provide a complete written estimate so you can make informed decisions. If budget is your primary concern, I will work with you to select cost-effective solutions that still carry good warranty coverage on parts and labor. As far as a ballpark, I can pull up a tool we use called RepairPal and give you an idea of what something like this normally costs to repair."

Why it works: validates the request, then offers a third-party data point instead of an unbacked price you can't honor.

SCRIPT · MINI-BOSS #4 — "LET ME THINK ABOUT IT."

They say: "I'm not sure yet. Let me think about it."

You say: "I completely understand. Before you decide, may I ask what's most important to you, price, turnaround time, or overall service?" (*Listen carefully.*)

Why it works: loops the conversation back open with a value-priorities question — almost no one says "price" when forced to rank.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE BALLPARK TRAP

When a customer asks for a "ballpark," emphasize that an accurate, meaningful estimate requires an inspection — frame it as risk mitigation, not price avoidance. If pressed, offer a general third-party range, then pivot immediately back to scheduling the vehicle so you can deliver a firm written estimate before any work begins. The focus never leaves getting the vehicle into the shop.

The 5 Common Mistakes That Kill Rapport

#	MISTAKE	CHANNEL IT BREAKS	QUICK FIX
1	Letting the phone ring 4+ times.	Tone — signals "you're an interruption."	2-ring rule. No exceptions.
2	Greeting from behind a monitor, no eye contact.	Body	Stand-and-smile on every door open.
3	Answering the price question in the first 30 seconds.	Words — sells before relief lands.	Concern question first; on a push, "at no charge to you, my certified technician and I..."
4	Filler words: "um," "uh," "like," "ya know."	Tone — signals uncertainty.	The Pause drill. Silence beats filler.
5	Skipping the customer's name entirely.	All three	Name on the boom board, eyes on the name every callback.

Drills — Build the Instinct

DRILL 1.A · SMILE-THROUGH-VOICE (60-SECOND REPS)

Setup: two advisors, one mirror. One places a real call to the shop and delivers the greeting twice — once with the mouth flat, once smiling visibly in the mirror.

Score (1–10): can the listener hear the smile? Did pace soften on "right place"?

Goal: 8+/10 on three consecutive reps, then graduate to live calls.

DRILL 1.B · THE PAUSE

Setup: trainer plays customer. You deliver the greeting and must hold full silence for two seconds before any further word, even if the customer hesitates.

Score: pause held? No filler? Did the customer speak first?

Goal: 5 consecutive reps with no filler. This unlocks Level 2.

DRILL 1.C · NAME × 3

Setup: full simulated call. Work the customer's first name in exactly three times within two minutes — greeting, concern pivot, hand-off.

Score: three uses? Natural inflection, not pasted on? Did the customer's tone soften?

Goal: land 3/3 on five live calls in a single shift.

DRILL 1.D · THE COLD-OPEN ROLEPLAY (BOSS PREP)

Setup: partner or AI in hostile-cold-caller mode — the customer opens with "Just tell me how much an oil change costs." You have 90 seconds to convert to an East-West appointment without quoting.

Score: tone warmth + no-quote discipline + East-West executed + appointment booked.

DRILL 1.E · EAST-WEST SPEED REPS

Setup: partner throws 10 random scheduling objections — "I can't come in until next week," "What's your earliest opening?", "Do you have anything later in the day?", "I want to come Saturday," "What time works?" You respond with East-West every time.

Goal: first-offer close on 7 of 10 reps.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 1 — RAPPORT MASTERY

- ☐ Picked up before the third ring with a smile audible in the voice.
- ☐ Ran the right version: direct ask → closed for the visit within the first 10 seconds; vague or quote ask → asked the concern question, delivered the urgency line, then closed.
- ☐ Paused after the opening line and let the customer speak first.
- ☐ Said the customer's first name at least 3 times in the first 2 minutes.
- ☐ Did not quote a price. On a price push, delivered the no-charge "and I" line word for word and circled back to the close.
- ☐ Concern Discovery checkpoint passed: could state the customer's true concern in their own words before the call ended.
- ☐ Used "when," not "if," in the urgency line.
- ☐ Zero status-shrinking language: no "just" in front of a reason, no apology for calling, no permission-to-speak opener.

Pass all 8 across three consecutive live calls → promoted to Advisor (Level 2).

COACH'S CORNER · HOW RAPPORT GETS COACHED ON THE FLOOR

Your coach listens for, in this order: (1) the smile in the voice on hello, (2) the pause, (3) the quick close ask on direct calls and the concern question on vague or quote calls, (4) the name use, (5) no price and the "and I" line on any price push. Concern Discovery is scored as a trained checkpoint on every rehearsal rep: the advisor must state the customer's true concern back to the coach, and ask for it on the call if they don't have it. They praise behavior, not outcomes — "you held the pause for a full two seconds, that's a Level-2 move" lands harder than "great call." They correct one channel at a time; if tone and body are both broken, tone gets fixed first. **Red flag pattern:** if your greet-to-tour rate drops below 60%, the leak is almost always in Rapport, not in pricing.

KPIs — What to Measure

Greet-to-Tour %

≥ 80%

Of all first-time visitors, what % accept a shop tour? This is the rapport scoreboard.

2-Ring Compliance

100%

% of inbound calls answered by the second ring. The single most controllable metric in the shop.

Inquiry-to-Appointment %

≥ 65%

% of phone inquiries that book. Rapport is the leading indicator — pricing is downstream.

Leave-Behind · Rapport Self-Audit Worksheet

FILL OUT AFTER EACH SHIFT

- ☐ Calls today (total): _____
- ☐ Smile audible on hello (Y/N count): _____
- ☐ Pause held on opening (Y/N count): _____
- ☐ Relief line delivered (Y/N count): _____
- ☐ Customer name used 3× (Y/N count): _____
- ☐ Greet-to-tour conversion %: _____
- ☐ One thing I'll improve tomorrow: _____
- ☐ One win I'll repeat tomorrow: _____

The "When Is Now a Good Time" Quick Close

Mission: Book the car. The quick close is not a variation — it IS the opening of the inbound call script. Direct ask: answer the question, close for the visit, then branch. Vague or quote ask: ask the concern, amplify the urgency, then close.

This chapter removes the advisor's uncertainty: **"What do I say first?"** Answer the customer's question and ask for the visit. Everything else follows the yes.

OBJECTIVE	TRIGGER	CORE MOVE	FAILURE MODE
BOOK THE CAR	EVERY INBOUND CALL	ANSWER + CLOSE	INTRO BEFORE CLOSE

Sales Process vs. Sales Objectives — Never Confuse Them

The ultimate goal of every inbound call is one thing: **get the car into the shop**. Book the appointment. That is the sales **process**, and the process leads. The sales **objectives** — establish rapport, establish credibility, educate the customer — are different things. They are pursued through and after the close, never in front of it. The shop introduction builds rapport and credibility, and it matters. But it is a servant, not a gate. The customer asked a question; the first thing they hear back is the answer, and the second is the invitation to come in.

The quick close is the opening of the inbound call. The rest of the call serves the booking it just made.

Two Openings, One Close

Customers open inbound calls in two ways, and each gets its own trained opening. Both end at the same place: "Is now a good time to bring it in?"

HOW THE CALL OPENS	YOUR OPENING PLAY
Direct ask — "Do you work on brakes?" "Can you do an oil change?"	Close immediately: "Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?" The concern question follows the yes.
Vague or quote ask — "I was hoping to get a quote on some brakes."	Concern question first: "Yeah, absolutely, you've called the right place. What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?" Then the urgency line built from their answer, THEN the close. The concern feeds the urgency; the urgency feeds the close.

Trained checkpoint — Concern Discovery: in both versions, the advisor must be able to state the customer's true concern in the customer's own words before the call ends. If you can't state it, you ask for it. Coaches score this on every rehearsal rep.

The anti-pattern this chapter exists to kill: **scripting the advisor past the customer's stated concern** — teaching them to recite a shop introduction while ignoring the question the customer actually asked. An advisor

who answers "do you work on brakes?" with an address and store hours has been trained to ignore the customer. Never again. Answer, close, then branch.

PRIORITY	WHAT IT MEANS
1 · Sales process — secure the appointment	Get the car into the shop. The quick close leads every call. Everything bends to this.
2 · Sales objectives — rapport, credibility, education	The shop introduction, the shop-news update, and the tour do this — after the yes on the call, at the counter, and on the tour. They support the booking; they never block it.
3 · Document the concern	Captured while you build the profile or confirm the appointment. Never blocks the booking.

The "When Is Now a Good Time" Quick Close

Clean script first. This is the first exchange of every inbound call: the customer's question gets answered in the first word. On a direct ask the close rides the same breath; on a vague or quote ask (Branch C) the concern question rides it instead, and the close follows the urgency the concern builds. Read it straight through, then work the branches.

Customer: "Hi, do you work on brakes?"

Advisor: "Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?"

Customer: "Yeah, I can head over now."

Advisor: "Great, have you been with us before?"

BRANCH A · FIRST-TIME CUSTOMER

Customer: "No, this will be my first time."

Advisor: "Thank you so much for choosing us! We are [Shop], your certified dealer alternative, located at [address]. We have ASE and dealer-certified technicians ready to handle all of your vehicle needs, and we stand behind our work with warranties up to 3 years or 36,000 miles. Stay with me really quick while I gather your information to build a customer profile. What's the year, make, and model of your vehicle?"

[Build the profile. Document the concern. Confirm the arrival time. From here you are inside the full inbound call script.]

Advisor: "Perfect, [Customer Name], we'll see you and your vehicle shortly!"

BRANCH B · RETURNING CUSTOMER

Customer: "Yes, I've been in before."

Advisor: "Welcome back! Is this still the best number for you?"

Customer: "Yes it is."

Advisor: "Perfect, I have your profile pulled up. Since your last visit, [brief shop news: a new certification, new equipment, a new team member, or what's new around the shop]. We'll see you and your vehicle shortly!"

[Confirm vehicle and concern. Customers visit only 2 to 4 times a year; the shop-news update re-syncs the rapport.]

BRANCH C · PRICE OR QUOTE QUESTION

Customer: "How much does it cost to have my brakes inspected?"

Advisor: "Yeah, absolutely, you've called the right place. What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?"

Customer: "They're squeaking when I drive."

Advisor: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

Customer: "I really just want to know what it costs first."

Advisor: "At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your complete brake system and provide you a written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

[Trained checkpoint — Concern Discovery: on every vague or quote call, the concern question comes before the close.]

BRANCH D · CAN'T COME NOW

Customer: "I can't come in right now."

Advisor: "Okay, no worries. With that squeak coming from your brake system, we don't want to leave it unchecked long. I've got 11:15 or 2:15 open today. Which works best for you?"

[Lock the time. If the concern isn't captured yet, ask the concern question and tie the urgency line to the booked slot. Then run the first-time or returning branch and the rest of the full inbound call script.]

Now the Teaching — Why the Quick Close Works

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · ANSWER FIRST, CLOSE SECOND, NOTHING BEFORE EITHER

A customer who opens with "Do you work on brakes?" is not asking for a shop history — they are asking for permission. The visit is already in their head; your job is to say yes to it before uncertainty regrows.

"Absolutely" answers their exact question — their stated concern is acknowledged in the very first word they hear back. "You've called the right place" delivers the relief. "Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?" closes. One breath, three jobs. Every sentence you deliver before that close gives doubt time to re-form — and can turn a hot caller into a comparison shopper. The quick close skips nothing that matters: rapport and credibility still happen, after the yes — in the introduction for first-timers, in the shop news for returning customers, at the counter and on the tour for everyone.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE CONCERN QUESTION, THE URGENCY LINE, AND THE "AND I" PROMISE

On a vague or quote call, three moves run in a fixed chain. **First, the concern question:** "What kind of concern are you having with your brakes?" — the quote is not the reason they called; the squeak is.

Second, the urgency line: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians" — the concern they just handed you becomes the urgency, and the urgency becomes the close. **Third, if they push on price:** "At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your complete brake system and provide you a written estimate" — a gift instead of a number, sealed with a personal promise. Then you circle back to the exact same close, in the exact same words. The repetition is deliberate: it signals calm certainty, and it keeps the call pointed at the only outcome that matters — the vehicle in the shop. Never a number.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY "AND I" IS THE FIRST STEP OF RAPPORT

"My certified technician AND I" is a claim of personal accountability, and you back it with four behaviors: you make sure the technician understands the customer's concern exactly as stated; you inspect the vehicle WITH the technician and document the findings together; YOU build the written estimate personally — the tech never does; and you walk the customer through that workflow so they know what happens next and are never just handed off and left waiting two hours in the lobby. The customer's nervous system hears one accountable human, not a process. That is rapport doing its job inside the close. After the line, always circle back: "Is now a good time to bring it in?"

STOP · WHAT THE QUICK CLOSE IS NOT

It is not permission to quote — the answer to a price question is still never a number over the phone; the concern question and the no-charge "and I" line are the only answers a price question ever gets. It is not permission to skip Concern Discovery — the trained checkpoint holds on every call: state the true concern in the customer's own words before the call ends, or ask for it. And it is not the death of the shop introduction — first-timers still get it, right after the yes. The branch question ("have you been with us before?") is the hinge that decides what follows the close: the introduction for first-timers, the best-number check and shop news for returning customers.

Say Yes, Get Them In — No Pre-Education

The quick close has a guardrail, and it gets its own name because breaking it quietly kills bookings: **no pre-education on the phone**. The inbound call has ONE job: say yes to the customer and get them in the door. Never foreshadow bad news. Never hint that the service they asked for might not fix the problem. Never educate before there is evidence. The customer's perception when they hang up is simple: "yes, I'm getting my oil change done." Education happens ONLY after the vehicle is in and the inspection produces evidence — then we present.

ALLOWED ON THE PHONE	BANNED UNTIL POST-INSPECTION EVIDENCE
Questions. "Why are we doing an oil change?" · "What's happened, what's going on with the vehicle?" Urgency. "Oh my goodness, when your oil pressure light comes on, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected." Value framing. "At no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete oil system and provide you a complete written estimate." The line stands alone. Never "not just [the service]" — the construction is banned in ALL customer-facing dialogue, everywhere — and never a justification tail.	Warnings. "An oil change alone may not fix it." Caveats. "That engine might not solve your problem." Pre-education. Any line that tells the customer, before evidence exists, that their requested service may be insufficient or their self-diagnosis wrong.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · EVIDENCE-FIRST EDUCATION — WHY THE WARNING BACKFIRES

"An oil change alone may not fix it" sounds honest, but on the phone it is the customer's own fear said out loud: this is going to cost more than I planned. Said before any evidence exists, it lands as a sales setup, and the customer's mind starts closing before the vehicle ever arrives. Worse, the advisor is guessing — nobody has inspected anything yet. Hold the same information until after the inspection and everything reverses: now there are photos, measurements, and a technician's findings, and the customer receives it with an open mind because it arrives as evidence, not as a hedge. The value-framing line is allowed for exactly this reason: "at no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete oil system and provide you a complete written estimate" gives the customer MORE than they asked for, at no cost, and it never suggests their fix is wrong. Keep the line clean, though: never "not just change the oil" — "not just X" subliminally tells the customer no to the very thing they asked for and insinuates extra, and extra means extra cost in the customer's mind. The ban is universal: the construction is banned in every piece of customer-facing dialogue in this system, not only on the phone. And never a justification tail like "so we know exactly what that light is telling us" — explaining why the inspection is free re-opens the fear the line just closed. Same facts, opposite frame: one adds value to the customer's plan, the other attacks it.

STOP · THE CUSTOMER KEEPS THEIR YES

If a phone line makes the customer doubt that the thing they asked for will happen, the line is wrong. The reasoning about inherited problems and self-diagnosis (Ch 3) is real, and it belongs in YOUR head and in the coach's rehearsal room — never in the customer's ear on the inbound call. Any warning, hint, or caveat delivered on the phone before inspection evidence is scored as a failed rep, even if the call booked.

The First Line, Every Time

WHAT YOU HEAR	SIGNAL	YOUR FIRST LINE
"Do you do brakes?" · "Can you get me in today?" · "My car just died, do you do alternators?"	HOT	"Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?"
"What do you charge for a brake job?" · "I was hoping to get a quote." · "I'm calling around for prices."	Price / quote	"Yeah, absolutely, you've called the right place. What kind of concern are you having with your [system]?" Then the urgency line, then the close. On a push: "At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect your complete [system] and provide you a written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?" Mini-Bosses ready.
Long story, nervous tone, unsure what's wrong.	Uncertain	Let them finish, acknowledge the concern in their own words, then: "You've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?"
Any of the above, but they can't come in now.	Friction	"Okay, no worries. With that [concern], we don't want to leave it unchecked long. I've got 11:15 or 2:15 open today. Which works best for you?"

PRO TIP · THE ORDER FLEXES; THE PIECES DON'T DISAPPEAR

In the quick close the shop introduction moves after the yes — it does not vanish. The 8 steps still run in order once the customer arrives: rapport at the door, credibility on the tour, custody with the keys. All the quick close does is put the booking at the front of the line, where it belongs.

Drills — Build the Reflex

DRILL 1.F · FIRST-LINE REPS (VERSION 1 VS. VERSION 2)

Setup: partner throws 10 random call openers — direct service questions, quote requests, price questions, nervous rambles. Within two seconds you deliver the correct first line: the quick close for a direct ask, or the concern question for a vague or quote ask, followed by the urgency line and the close.

Score: correct version picked + question answered first + close asked, 10 reps.

Goal: 9/10. The reflex is the skill; the lines you already know.

DRILL 1.G · QUICK CLOSE REPS

Setup: partner opens with "Do you do [service]?" or "Can I get a quote on [service]?" and secretly picks a branch (first-time / returning / price-push / can't-come-today). You run the correct version through whatever branch appears.

Score: correct opening + no price quoted + "and I" line word for word on any price push + branch handled + booking or future appointment completed + concern stated back to the partner at the end (the Concern Discovery checkpoint).

Goal: 5 consecutive clean reps across all four branches.

DRILL 1.H · CONCERN-TO-URGENCY CHAINS

Setup: partner names 10 random concerns — squeaking brakes, grinding noise, oil light, shaking at highway speed, A/C blowing warm. For each, you build the urgency line live: "Oh my goodness, when you have [concern] coming from your [system], you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our ASE-certified technicians. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

Score: concern echoed in the customer's words + system named + "when" not "if" + close attached.

Goal: 8/10 chains delivered without hesitation.

MASTERY CHECK · QUICK CLOSE MASTERY

- ☐ Picked the right version every call: direct ask → answered and closed in the first exchange; vague or quote ask → concern question, urgency line, then the close.
- ☐ Used the no-charge "and I" line word for word on every price push, then circled back to the same close.
- ☐ Asked "have you been with us before?" after every yes.
- ☐ First-timers received the shop introduction after the yes; returning customers got "is this still the best number for you?" plus a brief shop-news update.
- ☐ On a can't-come-now, carried the urgency from the concern into the East-West options.
- ☐ Never quoted a price. Concern Discovery checkpoint passed: true concern stated in the customer's own words before the call ended.
- ☐ No pre-education: zero warnings, hints, or caveats on the phone that the requested service may not fix the problem. Questions, urgency, and value framing only.

Pass all 7 across three consecutive live calls → Quick Close certified.

COACH'S CORNER · COACH THE OPENING, NOT JUST THE WORDS

The coach listens for the first exchange: did the advisor pick the right version? On a direct ask, did they answer and close — or recite the introduction at a customer who asked one thing? On a quote ask, did they ask the concern question before closing — or close blind against a comparison shopper? Scoring is strict — the advisor gets marked **down** for delivering any part of the shop introduction before the first close attempt, and marked **down** for closing a quote call without the concern in hand. In every rehearsal, the coach runs the Concern Discovery checkpoint: "What was the customer's true concern?" If the advisor can't answer in the customer's own words, the rep gets re-run, and the advisor is trained to ask for the concern on the call whenever they don't have it. Red flag: an advisor who answers "do you work on brakes?" with the address and store hours has been scripted past the customer's stated concern. Replay the call, find the question, re-script the answer aloud.

KPIs

Time to First Close Ask

≤ 15 sec

Seconds from the customer's opening question to the close ask. On direct asks the close is the first exchange; on quote calls the clock includes the concern question and urgency line — still under 30 seconds.

Hot-Call Booking %

≥ 85%

% of hot-signal calls that end booked. Hot callers who don't book were talked out of it.

Phone Quote Rate

0%

Prices quoted over the phone. The quick close never changes this number.

Establish Credibility

Mission: Create authority before money enters the conversation. The customer must conclude, on their own, "these people know what they're doing."

This step removes the uncertainty: **"Are these people competent?"**

OBJECTIVE BUILD AUTHORITY	TIME WINDOW 90-SEC TOUR	PRIMARY KPI TOUR → DVI CONSENT	FAILURE MODE BRAGGING
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The Psychology — Why Credibility Works

Credibility is not what we say about ourselves. Credibility is what the customer concludes after seeing the evidence. A confident claim ("we're the best") triggers skepticism. A demonstrated detail ("here's our certified tech, here's the loaner fleet, here's the warranty") triggers conclusion. **Show, don't tell.** The shop tour exists precisely because seeing the operation is 100× more persuasive than describing it. The shop itself — the lifts, the techs, the cleanliness — is silent credibility.

And the deeper why: credibility is the second half of the license that rapport opened. Customers like directness most of all — but a straight answer only lands from someone the customer has already concluded is safe (rapport) and knows what they're doing (credibility). The tour is not a brag. It is the moment the customer silently authorizes you to skip the salesmanship and tell it to them straight for the rest of the relationship.

Credibility lives in the three legs of the Trust Triangle. We do not pick one. We score all three, every time.

LEG	WHAT IT ANSWERS	THE EVIDENCE
Competence	"Do they know what they're doing?"	ASE-certified techs, dealer-alternative positioning, equipment, training credentials, years in business.
Transparency	"Are they hiding anything?"	Shop tour, digital vehicle inspections with photos and video, written estimates before any work, Meet-or-Beat policy.
Trustworthiness	"Would they do this for their own family?"	3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty stated unprompted, loaners / shuttle / Uber, reviews, willingness to defer non-safety work, "whether with us or elsewhere."

The Shop Tour as Authority Play

The tour is a 90-second condensed proof package. Each line in the tour script is engineered to score one or more legs of the Trust Triangle. If a line scores nothing, cut it.

TOUR LINE	WHAT IT'S REALLY DOING	TRUST LEG SCORED
"your certified dealer alternative"	Authority-by-association — dealer category at independent prices.	Competence
"ASE and dealer-certified technicians"	External validation. The customer doesn't have to take your word.	Competence
"3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty"	Risk reversal. Signals long-term confidence.	Trustworthy
"shuttle, Uber, loaner, rental reimbursement"	Removes the "I can't leave my car" objection. Reciprocity trigger.	Trustworthy
"digital inspections, electronic approvals"	Transparency made visible. Nothing happens in secret.	Transparency
"Can I get you coffee or water?"	Reciprocity. A tiny gift creates a tiny obligation.	Trustworthy

The Three Hidden Sales Inside the Tour

HIDDEN SALE	WHAT HAPPENS
1 · The Inspection Authorization	By the end of the tour, the customer has already mentally agreed to a DVI — we didn't ask, we just described what we do. Asking after the tour is a formality.
2 · The Price Defense	A customer who sees the shop, the techs, the equipment, and the warranty does not later compare us to Cheap Bob's on Main. They've already mentally bought a different product.
3 · The Repeat Visit	The tour is marketing for the next five years of visits. Customers refer the shop they were "walked through," not the shop they "dropped the car off at."

Scripts

The clean version first: the approach and the full tour, straight through. The teaching follows.

CLEAN SCRIPT · THE APPROACH + THE SHOP TOUR

[Greet at the front door or parking lot, boom board in hand.]

Advisor: "Welcome to [Shop]. I'm [Your Name] and I'll be assisting you today. May I have your keys, please?"

Customer: "Sure, here you go."

Advisor: "Thank you! Let me show you around while we get you checked in."

[Walking pace. Eye contact. Warmth.]

Advisor: "Welcome to [Shop], your certified dealer alternative. We're proud to have certified technicians ready to take care of all your vehicle needs: tires, routine maintenance, and major repairs. We also partner with trusted local specialists for accessory work like dent repair, body work, and windshield replacement, so you're covered in one place. To make your visit convenient, we offer complimentary shuttle rides, Uber or Lyft, rental car reimbursement, and loaner vehicles when available. If you stay, the waiting area has complimentary water, coffee, and tea, but there's no need to wait if transportation works better. Once you drop off, we keep you informed every step of the way: calls, texts, digital vehicle inspections, and electronic approvals for estimates, invoices, and payment. Clear, simple, transparent. We're excited to serve you today, and thank you for trusting [Shop]. Can I get you something to drink? Coffee, water, or tea?"

[Escort to the waiting lobby. Customer seated or comfortable before you step away.]

SCRIPT · THE APPROACH

You: "Welcome to [Shop], I'm [Your Name] and I'll be assisting you today. May I have your keys, please?"

Greet the customer in the parking lot or by the front door, boom board in hand. If the customer already called the shop, you should need nothing but the keys and confirmation of contact information. For walk-ins, fill out the boom sheet and proceed. Full tour for every first-time customer; returning customers get told what's new since their last visit.

SCRIPT · THE SHOP TOUR — WALKING PACE, EYE CONTACT, WARMTH

"Welcome to [Shop], your certified dealer alternative. We're proud to have certified technicians ready to take care of all your vehicle needs, tires, routine maintenance, major repairs. We also partner with trusted local specialists for accessory work like dent repair, body work, and windshield replacement, so you're covered in one place.

To make your visit convenient, we offer complimentary shuttle rides, Uber or Lyft, rental car reimbursement, and loaner vehicles when available. If you stay, the waiting area has complimentary water, coffee, and tea — but there's no need to wait if transportation works better.

Once you drop off, we keep you informed every step of the way: calls, texts, digital vehicle inspections, and electronic approvals for estimates, invoices, and payment. Clear, simple, transparent.

We're excited to serve you today, and thank you for trusting [Shop]. Can I get you something to drink — coffee, water, or tea?"

PRO TIP · HOW THE TOUR ENDS

The tour ends with an escort to the waiting lobby, the customer seated or comfortable to be left alone. Never dump a first-timer at the counter and disappear.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY WE END THE TOUR WITH THE DRINK OFFER

The drink offer is the final reciprocity trigger. It also creates a tiny social contract: the customer is now a **guest** in our space, not a transaction. Guests don't haggle. Guests don't walk out. Guests authorize inspections.

DRILL 2.A · THE 90-SECOND TOUR

Setup: pair up. One plays a nervous first-timer. The other delivers the tour from memory in under 90 seconds while walking.

Score each other 1–10 on: smile and eye contact / warranty and transportation mentioned / drink offer at the end / customer comfort level after.

Goal: 8+ on three consecutive runs.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 2 — CREDIBILITY MASTERY

- ☐ Delivered the full shop tour in under 90 seconds, walking pace, with eye contact.
- ☐ Mentioned all three credibility anchors: certified techs, warranty, transportation options.
- ☐ Offered a drink at the end of the tour.
- ☐ Did not brag — demonstrated the operation rather than making claims about it.
- ☐ Customer's body language visibly relaxed by the end (shoulders down, posture open).

Pass all 5 across three live tours → Credibility certified.

COACH'S CORNER · THE TOUR GETS SCORED WITH THE TRUST TRIANGLE IN HAND

Your coach walks along on one tour per week and silently tags every sentence C / T / Tw in a notebook, then shows you the tally. Most under-performing advisors over-index on Competence (bragging) and skip Transparency entirely. Once you see the imbalance, it self-corrects within two weeks.

KPIs

Tour Delivery % 100% Every first-time customer gets the full tour — no exceptions. The highest-leverage habit in the book.	Tour → DVI Consent ≥ 95% % of toured customers who authorize the digital vehicle inspection.
Tour Duration 75–90 sec Faster = rushed. Slower = lost.	

Collect Data — Get Custody

Mission: Get the vehicle into our bay. Separate the customer from the car. Document the true concern.

This step removes the uncertainty: **"Do they understand my specific situation?"**

OBJECTIVE GET CUSTODY	TOOL BOOM BOARD + RO	PRIMARY KPI INQUIRY → RO %	FAILURE MODE SELF-DIAGNOSIS
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The Psychology of Custody

The single most under-valued asset in the shop is **the car in our bay**. We cannot inspect a car we don't have. We cannot sell repairs on a car we don't have. We cannot build a relationship through a phone — only across a counter and a coffee. Custody is the gateway to every other objective in this system. Every move in Step 3 is designed to move the vehicle from "maybe" to "in the bay."

The corollary: the second the vehicle is in the bay, we have also done a quieter but equally important thing — we have **separated the customer from the vehicle**. The customer is in the waiting room or in an Uber. They are no longer staring at the dashboard. Their emotional attachment to the symptom decays. Logical decisions become possible. Separation is what enables education. And once we have custody, the price conversation is fundamentally different — the customer has invested time and trust.

Concern vs. Symptom — The Most Important Distinction in Service

Customers describe symptoms. Professionals diagnose concerns. The single biggest source of wasted shop time is taking a customer's self-diagnosis at face value. "I need new brakes" is a symptom statement — the concern might be a wheel bearing, a stuck caliper, or a low-friction tire. Our job is to convert symptom language into concern language, gently, without making the customer feel stupid.

CUSTOMER WORDS	SYMPTOM	INSPECTION	CONCERN	SOLUTION
"squeaking"	noise from front wheels	visual + measure	root cause identified	priced & PRS'd

Figure 3.1 · The diagnosis funnel — customer language converts to professional language at each gate.

The Root Concern Rule — Never Write a Job on a Self-Diagnosis

Concern vs. symptom has a harder cousin: the customer who names the **service** and says yes to coming in. The booking is secured, the call feels done — and this is exactly where jobs get written on someone else's diagnosis. The Root Concern Rule: **even when the customer names a service and agrees to come in, you still find the TRUE root concern before writing the job**. Close first, then ask why. Two reasons, both expensive: **we don't inherit somebody else's problems**, and **we don't fix a self-diagnosis** — a repair that doesn't fix the customer's actual problem doesn't just waste their money, it puts the shop on the hook for a failure it never diagnosed.

And one guardrail on top (Ch 1.5 — Say Yes, Get Them In — No Pre-Education): that entire paragraph is for YOU, not for the customer. On the phone, the Root Concern Rule runs on questions, urgency, and value framing only. You never tell the customer their oil change may not fix it, their engine may be the wrong call, or their diagnosis may be mistaken. They said what they want; you say yes, you get them in, and the inspection produces the evidence that earns the education.

VERSION A · THE NAMED SERVICE (OIL CHANGE)

Customer: "Can you do an oil change?"

Advisor: "Absolutely, you've called the right place. Is now a good time to bring your vehicle in?"

Customer: "Yeah, I can come in now."

Advisor: "Perfect. And real quick, what's going on with your oil system? Why are we doing an oil change?"

Customer: "I'm just overdue on the miles."

Advisor: "Got it, we'll get you right back on schedule. Have you been with us before?"

SAME CALL, DIFFERENT ANSWER · THE LIGHT CHANGES EVERYTHING

Customer: "The oil pressure light came on."

Advisor: "Oh my goodness, when your oil pressure light comes on, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our certified technicians. Is right now a good time to bring it in?"

Customer: "I just want to make sure I know how much it costs first."

Advisor: *[Warm, almost surprised. Meet the price worry, don't pitch at it.]* "Oh, no no. At no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete oil system and provide you a complete written estimate. Are you able to bring it in right now?"

IF THE CUSTOMER PUSHES FOR A BALLPARK

Customer: "Can you just ballpark me how much the oil change will be?"

Advisor: "Yeah, absolutely. Our oil changes are on par with everybody else in town. But the reality is you've got an oil pressure light on, so I'd really prefer not to charge you anything. Come in, let me take a look at that oil light, we can determine the correct oil change that's really going to solve the problem, and I'll provide you a complete written estimate. That costs you nothing. What I really need from you right now is not money. I need you to bring the car in so we can take a look and start addressing your problem."

[Trained checkpoint — Root Concern: never write the job until you can state the true customer concern. If you can't state it, ask. Questions and urgency only; no pre-education on the phone.]

VERSION B · THE CUSTOMER-SUPPLIED DIAGNOSIS (ENGINE)

Customer: "I've got a 2014 Chevy Silverado and my own engine. Can you guys remove the old one and install this new one?"

Advisor: "Absolutely, but let's back up for a second. Why do you need a new engine? What's happened, what's going on with the vehicle?"

Customer: "It started knocking real bad, so I found a replacement engine."

Advisor: "Oh my goodness, with a knock like that, you've got to bring it in and have it inspected by one of our certified technicians. At no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete engine and vehicle and provide you a complete written estimate. Is now a good time to bring it in?"

[The inheritance reasoning stays in the advisor's head, never in the customer's ear. On the phone: questions, urgency, value. The evidence conversation happens after the inspection.]

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE "OH, NO NO" ACKNOWLEDGE-FIRST BEAT

When the customer says "I just want to make sure I know how much it costs first," they are bracing for a pitch. So the counter doesn't pitch — it acknowledges first. "Oh, no no," delivered warm and almost surprised, meets the price barrier as if the worry itself were a misunderstanding, because here it is. The tone communicates the real message: we're not like other shops; it costs nothing just to look. Acknowledge, then the no-charge line, then close. On the ballpark push, give the honest anchor ("our oil changes are on par with everybody else in town") and then move the frame off money entirely: "What I really need from you right now is not money. I need you to bring the car in." The advisor who leads with reassurance instead of a rebuttal keeps the customer's yes alive.

STOP · THE NO-CHARGE LINE NEEDS NO JUSTIFICATION

"At no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete oil system and provide you a complete written estimate." Full stop, then close. Never "not just change the oil" — "not just X" subliminally tells the customer NO to the very thing they asked for and insinuates EXTRA, and extra means extra cost in the customer's mind. And the ban is universal: "not just X" is banned in ALL customer-facing dialogue, in every script and every boss battle, not only here — state the value affirmatively instead. And never a why-tail like "so we know exactly what that light is telling us" — justifying the free inspection re-opens the fear the line just closed. Deliver it clean.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY THE SAME JOB GETS THREE DIFFERENT ANSWERS

"Why are we doing an oil change?" has at least three answers, and each one changes what the shop should do. Overdue by miles: routine service, back on schedule. The windshield sticker says it's due: routine service, sync the interval. The oil-pressure light came on: **everything changes** — now we inspect the oil system, because an oil change alone may leave the customer driving away with the exact problem they called about, wearing our shop's name on the invoice. The service the customer asked for is a hypothesis. The concern is the fact. One question separates them. And every word of that reasoning stays on your side of the counter: on the phone the customer hears urgency and value ("at no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete oil system and provide you a complete written estimate"), never the warning that their oil change may not fix it — and never "not just change the oil," because the "not just" construction quietly says no to the thing they asked for and hints at extra cost. Evidence first, education second.

STOP · WE DON'T INHERIT SOMEBODY ELSE'S PROBLEMS

A customer-supplied part plus a customer-supplied diagnosis is double inheritance: if that engine is bad, or the knock wasn't the engine at all, the shop owns a failure it never diagnosed. Never write the job until the vehicle has been inspected and the true concern confirmed. "Absolutely, but let's back up. Why do you need a new engine? What's happened, what's going on with the vehicle?" Willingness first, inspection always. And the inheritance logic is advisor-side only: on the phone it surfaces as questions and a no-cost complete inspection, never as a lecture that the customer's engine or diagnosis may be wrong.

COACH'S CORNER · REHEARSE THE ROOT CONCERN CHECKPOINT

In every intake rehearsal, the coach stops the rep at the moment the advisor would write the job and asks one question: "Do you have the true customer concern?" The advisor either states it in the customer's own words or names the question they still need to ask. Advisors are trained to run that same self-check on every live call: if you can't state the true concern, you don't have it — ask for it. Writing the service the customer named without the why behind it is scored as a failed rep, even if the appointment booked. So is pre-educating: any warning, hint, or caveat on the phone that the customer's requested fix may not work is a failed rep too — questions, urgency, and value framing only until the inspection produces evidence.

Question Sequences That Get Custody

The right question sequence walks the customer up a small hill of yeses until "bring it in" feels like the next obvious step rather than a separate decision.

SEQUENCE	PURPOSE	EXAMPLE
1. Acknowledge concern	Validates the customer's reality.	"Oh my goodness, when you have [concern]..."
2. Imply expertise required	Positions inspection as the only honest answer.	"...it's always best to have a certified tech inspect."
3. Assume the appointment	Skips the should/shouldn't fork.	"Is now a good time?"
4. East-West close	Collapses scheduling infinity to binary.	"9:15 or 10:45?"
5. Custody hand-off	Locks the appointment with action.	"Stay with me while I get you in our system."

The Boom Board — Custody's Best Friend

The boom board (intake clipboard, tablet, or shop-management capture form) is the physical artifact of custody. It signals professionalism, captures the concern in writing, and gives the customer something to participate in. Walk-ins fill it out. Phone-ins get it built by the advisor as they talk. No vehicle enters the bay without one.

STOP · NO BOOM BOARD, NO BAY

If a tech is performing work on a vehicle that does not have a documented concern in the system, the whole sales process has skipped Step 3. Stop the work. Document. Then proceed. This single discipline protects the shop from miscommunication and the customer from surprise.

PRO TIP · NEVER ACCEPT THE SELF-DIAGNOSIS

"Sure, we'll do the brakes" is the most expensive sentence in service writing. Validate the customer, then add value: "Oh my goodness, when you have a squeak coming from your brake system, you've got to have it inspected. At no cost to you, my certified technician and I will inspect your complete brake system and provide you a complete written estimate." The Root Concern Rule above is this tip made mandatory: the "why" question runs on every named service, every time — and the translation happens through questions and value, never through telling the customer their self-diagnosis might be wrong.

The Arrival & Intake — Custody in Person, and the Keys Moment

The phone earned the appointment; the arrival earns the custody. The intake walk does three jobs at once: it documents the concern, it delivers the real shop tour (the inspection rack IS the tour), and it closes with the keys moment — the line that completes the separation objective. Clean script first, teaching after.

[Greet at the front door or parking lot, boom board in hand.]

Advisor: "Welcome to [Shop]. I'm [Your Name] and I'll be taking care of you today. May I have your keys, please?"

Customer: "Sure, here you go."

Advisor: "Thank you! Let me confirm what we have: you're here for [customer concern], and the best number to reach you is [number], correct?"

Customer: "That's right."

[Walk the customer inside past the inspection rack. Walking pace. This walk is the real shop tour.]

Advisor: "We keep this rack open so we can get you answers as soon as possible. This is also where we perform our bumper to bumper inspections, so you know the full health of your vehicle. It's not so I can present you an estimate later. It's so you have evidence and information about your car. At the end of the day we deliver safe and reliable vehicles."

Advisor: "While the vehicle is here, my certified technician and I will complete a full digital inspection with photos and video, I'll make sure the technician understands exactly what you're experiencing, and nothing happens without your approval. You'll see everything we see, and I'll personally walk you through the written estimate before anything moves forward."

Customer: "Sounds good."

[The keys moment. Hold the keys up.]

Advisor: "And you're dropping this off with me, right?"

IF THE CUSTOMER PLANS TO WAIT · THE AUDIBLE

Customer: "No, I was planning on waiting."

Advisor: "Oh, no worries. Can I get you a coffee, water, or tea?"

[Call the audible: the separate-the-customer-from-the-vehicle procedure begins. During the inspection, identify the one most critical safety concern, then return to the customer.]

Advisor: "Hey, we've identified something that requires your immediate attention. Do you mind coming to take a look at it with us?"

[At the vehicle: show them it is broken. Show and sell.]

Advisor: "We've got to have our master technician get this fixed so it's safe and reliable."

Customer: "How much is that going to cost?"

Advisor: "I don't know yet. We'll source the parts and I will call you before anything else moves forward."

[Boom board complete before the vehicle enters the bay. Customer separated from the vehicle within 10 minutes.]

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE KEYS MOMENT

"And you're dropping this off with me, right?" — asked while holding the keys up — is an assumptive separation close. The old line ("Can we set you up in the waiting area with a coffee, or would a shuttle or loaner work better?") offered the customer a comfortable way to NOT separate from the vehicle: a customer in the waiting area is still attached to the car, still watching the clock, still making emotional decisions. The sales objective is separating the customer from the vehicle, and offering the waiting area does not accomplish it. The keys moment assumes the drop-off, and most customers confirm it on the spot. The ones who don't get warmth, a drink, and the audible.

SCRIPT · THE AUDIBLE — WHEN THE CUSTOMER STAYS

A customer who waits is a separation play that hasn't happened yet. Never argue for the drop-off — "Oh, no worries. Can I get you a coffee, water, or tea?" — then call the audible: get the vehicle on the rack and have the inspection surface the ONE most critical safety concern first. Then walk to the lobby:

You: "Hey, we've identified something that requires your immediate attention. Do you mind coming to take a look at it with us?"

At the vehicle, show them it is broken — show and sell:

You: "We've got to have our master technician get this fixed so it's safe and reliable."

On the cost question, hold the line:

You: "I don't know yet. We'll source the parts and I will call you before anything else moves forward."

The customer who came in to wait out a service is now standing at their own vehicle, looking at evidence, invested in a repair conversation. Separation achieved through evidence instead of transportation.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE RACK LINE IS THE REAL SHOP TOUR

"We keep this rack open so we can get you answers as soon as possible... It's not so I can present you an estimate later. It's so you have evidence and information about your car." The line names the customer's quiet suspicion — this inspection exists to sell me things — and answers it before it forms: the rack produces evidence and information, and the shop's product is a safe and reliable vehicle. Pair it with the approval language (nothing happens without your approval, you'll see everything we see, I'll personally walk you through the written estimate) and the DVI is pre-sold on the walk in without ever being pitched.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 3 — CUSTODY MASTERY

- ☐ Converted the customer's symptom language to a documented concern.
- ☐ Did not accept self-diagnosis at face value (no "sure, we'll do the brakes").
- ☐ Root Concern Rule applied: asked the "why" behind every named service ("What's going on with your oil system? Why are we doing an oil change?") and wrote the job only after stating the true concern.
- ☐ Used East-West to book the appointment on the first offer.
- ☐ Boom board / RO fully populated — with verified contact info — before the vehicle enters the bay.
- ☐ Keys moment run at intake ("And you're dropping this off with me, right?"); the waiting-area offer never used as the separation move; the audible called when the customer stayed.
- ☐ Customer separated from vehicle within 10 minutes of arrival (drop-off / shuttle / loaner — or the audible in motion).

COACH'S CORNER · ONE RO AUDIT PER ADVISOR PER DAY

The coach picks one finished RO and reads the documented concern as if they were the tech walking into the bay cold. If the customer's symptom can't be reproduced from the writing alone, custody discipline broke down somewhere in the call — and you'll re-do that intake aloud together. Not scolding. Rehearsing.

KPIs

Inquiry-to-RO %

≥ 70%

% of phone inquiries that become an RO. This is the custody scoreboard.

Boom-Board Complete

100%

% of ROs with the concern fully documented before work begins.

Separation Time

≤ 10 min

Time from arrival to customer in lobby / shuttle / loaner.

Inspect & Analyze — The DVI Is the X-Ray

Mission: Produce a complete, honest, documented picture of the vehicle's true health.

This step removes the uncertainty: **"Are they making this up?"**

OBJECTIVE VEHICLE HEALTH	TOOL DVI & PHOTOS	PRIMARY KPI DVI W/ MEDIA %	FAILURE MODE PARTIAL DVI
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Why Inspection Exists — It's Not About the Repair

The inspection is not for the technician. The technician already knows what is wrong with the car. The inspection — specifically the digital inspection with photos, video, and notes — is **for the customer**. It is a piece of evidence we hand them in Step 6 so they can see what we see. Without that evidence, every repair we recommend lands as opinion. With it, every recommendation lands as fact. Visual evidence is what turns "trust me" into "I see it."

The DVI is not a checklist. It is the X-ray we hand the customer so they stop being afraid of the diagnosis.

STOP · NO DVI MEDIA = NO PRESENTATION

Every Yellow and Red finding gets at least one photo or short video clip before any callback. DVI w/ Media must run ≥ 95%. Module 6 will fail without Module 4 — do not present a finding you cannot show.

Selling the Inspection Too Early

The most common bad habit in advising is pitching the full digital vehicle inspection too soon. It feels like transparency. It reads as an upsell. Customers call for a specific service precisely BECAUSE they fear being sold more than they asked for — lead with the inspection and you confirm that fear before the car is even in the bay.

The classic version is the tire-shop story. A customer books tires. Walking past the bay, they see their own car with the hood up: "Why is my hood open? I brought it in for tires." Nothing dishonest happened — the shop inspects every car — but the sequence failed: nobody wrapped the inspection inside the customer's own plan, so the open hood reads as the upsell starting. A sequence failure creates the exact resistance the DVI exists to remove.

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS
Never book with the DVI.	The appointment is booked on the customer's concern, full stop. The inspection is never the reason to come in and never a selling point on the booking call.
Present the DVI only after the concern is addressed or the first approval is secured.	The customer's yes to their own concern comes first. The inspection rides in afterward, wrapped in a waiting window.
Wrap it in a waiting window.	"And obviously while we're knocking out the tires, we'll give the car a good look over and make sure everything else is in tip top shape. I'll call you with any additional concerns that are found." Other permission wrappers: while we wait on parts, while the technician finishes another job, while you get a ride home.
Or introduce it subliminally.	The shop introduction video carries it without the advisor ever pitching: "Every car that comes through our facility receives a comprehensive complimentary inspection to ensure we deliver a safe and reliable vehicle back to you."

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY THE WAITING WINDOW WORKS

The waiting window makes the inspection a free bonus that happens **INSIDE** time the customer has already surrendered. "While we're knocking out the tires" attaches the look-over to work the customer chose, so it lands as diligence, not a pitch. The same inspection announced up front lands as the reason their hood is open. Identical inspection, identical shop, opposite meaning — the only variable is when it entered the conversation.

COACH'S CORNER · AUDIT WHEN THE DVI IS INTRODUCED, NOT JUST WHETHER

Most coaches audit whether the inspection happened. HAB coaches audit **WHEN** it was introduced. Pull one booking call and one intake per advisor per week and mark the moment the inspection first entered the conversation: if it came before the customer's concern was booked, or before the first approval, that is a sequence failure — coach it exactly like a missed close. The DVI is never the problem. The timing is.

The Vehicle Health Dashboard — Green / Yellow / Red

Within the DVI, every finding gets classified against one question. The answer drives the color, and the color drives the conversation.

THE DECISION QUESTION · "Does it operate within manufacturer specifications?"

GREEN · HEALTHY	YELLOW · WATCH	RED · REPAIR
YES — IN SPEC	YES — BUT FLAG	NO — OUT OF SPEC
• Functioning normally • All readings in range • No concerns	• Looks off, but still in spec • Approaching service interval • Preventative opportunity	• Out of manufacturer spec • Regardless of component (stereo button or brake pad — same rule)
WHAT TO DO <i>Notify the customer it's healthy. This primes Good-Good-Bad — the customer hears what's RIGHT before what's wrong.</i>	WHAT TO DO <i>Watch at next visit, or schedule maintenance proactively. Soft conversation — not an ask, an offer.</i>	WHAT TO DO <i>PRS it, then strategize: sell on 1st, 2nd, or 3rd base. Must address.</i>

Figure 4.1 · One question, three answers, three different conversations. The rule is binary on the **spec question**, not on perceived severity — never soften a Red into a Yellow because you don't want to push.

PRO TIP · YELLOW IS NOT A SALE — IT'S A FLAG

Yellow items are not presented as a sales opportunity today. They're documented for re-inspection at the next visit, or rolled into a scheduled-maintenance conversation on 3rd base if they're approaching an interval. Treating Yellow as a sale erodes the "we'll tell you what we see" trust we earned in Module 2. Treat Yellow as a watch — the customer will trust you more for it.

PRO TIP · RED IS A FINDING, NOT A BASE ASSIGNMENT

Red means exactly one thing: the item is out of manufacturer specification. It does not automatically mean "sell it on 1st base." 1st base belongs to the customer's original concern — or an immediate safety threat if they came in with no concern. Every other Red finding gets carried into Build & Strategize (Chapter 5) and plugged into the base plan: a discovery beyond the original concern is a 2nd-base expansion; a Red item that fits the maintenance picture can ride on 3rd base. **Sort the finding by spec. Sell it by strategy.**

How Inspection Creates Trust — The Reciprocity of Effort

When a customer sees that we spent an hour inspecting, photographing, video-recording, and documenting their vehicle — before we ever asked them for a dollar — the brain registers a debt. The customer's subconscious thought: "these people did all that for me before I authorized anything — the least I can do is hear them out." That is reciprocity at industrial scale.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY A THOROUGH DVI SHORTENS OBJECTIONS

An objection like "the price seems high" is almost always shorthand for "I'm not sure this is real." A DVI with photos, video, and tech notes destroys the "not real" doubt before the objection forms. Shops with DVI-completion rates above 95% report dramatically lower price-objection rates — not because their prices are lower, but because their evidence is higher.

The Camera Is a Stage — Recording for the Remote Customer

Who the inspection media is for (the customer) also decides how it gets performed — and there are two performance modes (Chapter 0.5). If the customer is standing in the shop, the finding is presented in **counter mode**: quieter, calmer, more direct, pointing at the physical evidence. But most DVI video is watched by a customer who is somewhere else, on a phone, one thumb-flick away from the rest of their day. That video is **stage mode — theater**. You are on stage playing to the back row: exaggerate the expression, the vocal energy, and the tone. Point, gesture, name what the camera is seeing, and keep the energy up to the last second.

CUSTOMER IN THE SHOP → COUNTER MODE	CUSTOMER REMOTE → STAGE MODE
Lower volume, slower pace, direct language. Calm is the authority signal when the evidence is physically present.	Expression up, energy up, tone bigger than feels natural. The screen flattens half of it; what arrives is "engaging," never "too much."

PRO TIP · REVIEW YOUR OWN VIDEOS ON A PHONE

Never judge your inspection video on the shop monitor. Watch it where the customer will — on a phone. If your energy doesn't reach through that screen, re-shoot it in stage mode. Drill 0.C (Back-Row Reps) builds this fast.

Tech-Advisor Communication — The Walk-the-Bay Hand-Off

The tech sees the car. The advisor sells the car. If they don't sync, the customer hears guesses. The hand-off protocol, in order:

1. **Walk the bay.** Advisor physically meets the tech at the vehicle within 15 minutes of DVI completion.
2. **Listen first.** Tech explains the finding. Advisor takes notes. No interruptions.
3. **Translate.** Advisor reflects the tech's language back in customer-friendly terms. Tech corrects anything that's off.
4. **Confirm PRS.** Together: Problem, Risk, Solution, Investment, Warranty.
5. **Sign off.** Both initial the RO so accountability is shared.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 4 — INSPECTION MASTERY

- ☐ DVI completed bumper-to-bumper, every section.
- ☐ Every Yellow and Red finding has at least one photo or video.
- ☐ Tech walk-the-bay completed within 15 minutes of DVI completion.
- ☐ Customer sent the DVI via text/email and viewed it (confirmed) before the presentation call.
- ☐ PRS drafted for every Red and Yellow finding before any callback.
- ☐ Remote-customer videos recorded in stage mode: expression and vocal energy played to the back row, attention held to the end.

COACH'S CORNER · TWO DVIS PER ADVISOR PER WEEK GET AUDITED

The coach opens the DVI as if they were the customer. Could they understand the finding from the photos and notes alone? Is any finding missing media? Most failures here are caught and corrected inside one cycle. Note for coaches: if DVI w/ Media is red, coach the techs, not just the advisors.

KPIs

DVI Completion %

100%

% of vehicles in the bay that get a full DVI before any callback.

DVI w/ Media %

≥ 95%

% of Yellow/Red findings with photo or video evidence.

DVI View-Rate

≥ 75%

% of customers who open the DVI before the presentation call. Strong leading indicator of authorization.

Build & Strategize — Run the Bases

Mission: Sequence the conversation so the customer experiences clarity, not overwhelm. Isolate → expand → save → protect → reinforce.

This step removes the uncertainty: **"What should I actually do, and in what order?"**

OBJECTIVE	FRAMEWORK	PRIMARY KPI	FAILURE MODE
SEQUENCE THE CALL	BASEBALL DIAMOND	BASE ORDER %	KITCHEN-SINKING

The Baseball Diamond — Why Order Wins

The single most common reason a customer says "let me think about it" is not price — it's **overwhelm**. When an advisor presents the safety concern, the maintenance items, the upsells, and the recovery item in one breath, the customer's brain freezes. The Baseball Diamond is the discipline that prevents this: one base at a time, in order, with authorization at each base before advancing. This step is invisible to the customer, but it's where the deal is built.

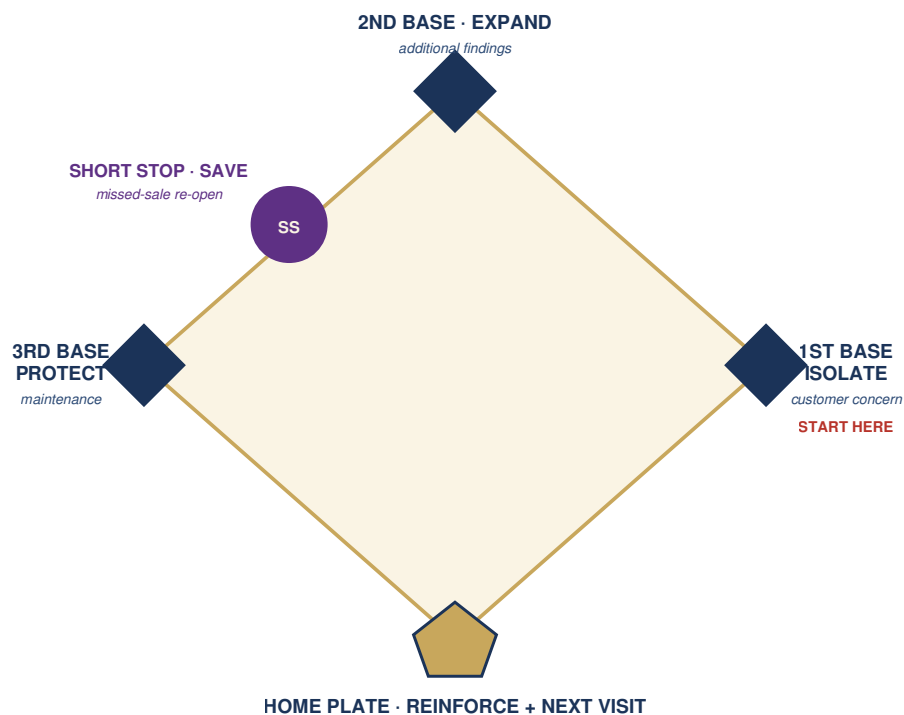


Figure 5.1 · The Base-Selling Diamond — start at 1st (right), touch every base in order, never skip. Home plate points up toward the pitcher.

BASE	TOPIC	GOAL	TONE	AUTHORIZATION BEFORE ADVANCING?
1st Base — ISOLATE	The customer's original concern (or safety if no concern)	Solve what they came for	Confident, focused	YES
2nd Base — EXPAND	Additional inspection findings (Red items, most safety-critical first)	Bundle with 1st-base authorization	Assumptive, calm	YES
Short Stop — SAVE	Re-open a missed safety sale (fresh voice)	Save the unsafe car	Concerned, not pushy	YES (or schedule)
3rd Base — PROTECT	Scheduled maintenance due now or within 10k (Yellow items)	Long-term ownership protection	Soft, no urgency stacking	YES (or schedule)
Home Plate — REINFORCE	Final invoice review	Reinforce value, set up next visit	Warm, complete	N/A (closing summary)

The Two Frameworks Inside Every Base

Framework A · Good · Good · Bad

Two positives prime the brain into a receptive state. The third statement (the cost or concern) then lands inside an open mind instead of a defensive one. Lead with bad news and you trigger fight-or-flight before the customer hears a single solution.

Example: "Good news: I have great DVI documentation. Good news: we identified the cause. The finding: the water pump is leaking."

Framework B · P · R · S

Problem · Risk · Solution. Every finding gets stated in this exact order, no skipping. The Risk step is the one most advisors omit — and it's the one that converts information into urgency. Without Risk, the customer doesn't know why to act now.

Follow PRS with the Total Investment, then the Coverage (warranty), then a tee-up sentence.

STOP · DO NOT MIX BASES ON THE SAME CALL

Kitchen-sinking is the practice of dumping every finding — safety + maintenance + recovery + upsell — into one call. It feels efficient. It destroys trust. The customer hears a list of expenses and concludes "they're trying to get me." Each base is its own micro-conversation, with its own authorization, **hung up between bases**. Re-call for the next base. Slower per call — and a meaningfully higher close rate.

Scripts — First Base: Isolate the Customer Concern

Each base call appears clean first, then taught. Read the clean version straight through before you study the beats.

CLEAN SCRIPT · THE FIRST BASE CALL

Advisor: "Hi [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] with [Shop]. Is now a good time to review our findings?"

Customer: "Sure, go ahead."

Advisor: "You brought your vehicle in for [customer concern] and I reviewed the findings personally with the technician to ensure accuracy. Good news is I was able to capture a good video of what is going on. Did you receive the DVI findings I sent via text?"

Customer: "Yes, I saw them."

Advisor: "Awesome. More good news. We've identified the cause of your concern. The problem is [Problem]. If it's left as it is, [Risk]. The proper solution is [Solution]. The total investment to take care of this today is \$[XXX], and everything is covered by our 3-year, 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on parts and labor."

Customer: "Okay, let's take care of it."

Advisor: "Awesome. I'll go ahead and get those parts ordered so we can keep moving forward, and while we're waiting on the parts we'll complete the bumper to bumper inspection and I'll reach out with any additional concerns. Is this still the best number to reach you?"

Customer: "Yes it is."

Advisor: "Great."

SCRIPT · 1ST BASE · STEP 1 — PERMISSION TO SPEAK

You: "Hi [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] with [Shop]. Is now a good time to review our findings?"

SCRIPT · 1ST BASE · STEP 2 — GOOD-GOOD-BAD

"You brought your vehicle in for [customer concern] and I reviewed the findings personally with the technician to ensure accuracy."

"Good news is I was able to capture a good video of what is going on. Did you receive the DVI findings I sent via text/email?" (*Do not continue without confirmation.*)

"Awesome. More good news. We've identified the cause of your concern." (*Acknowledge the customer's yes first — the single word "Awesome." — then deliver the discovery. "More good news" fired straight after their answer, with no acknowledgment, lands as a script rolling over them.*)

SCRIPT · 1ST BASE · STEP 3 — PROBLEM · RISK · SOLUTION

Speak confidently, in this order:

- State the **Problem** in full.
- State the **Risk** associated with the problem.
- State the proper **Solution** to the problem.
- State the **Total Investment** for the problem to be solved.
- State the **Coverage** we provide on the solution (warranty info) — in the same breath.

Then stop. The bumper-to-bumper line has moved: it now lives in the close, **AFTER** the customer authorizes (Step 5). The presentation ends on Coverage.

SCRIPT · 1ST BASE · STEPS 4 AND 5

Step 4: Answer questions. Overcome objections (Chapter 7).

Step 5: Obtain authorization, then seal it by assuming the sale and introducing the bumper-to-bumper in the same breath: "Awesome. I'll go ahead and get those parts ordered so we can keep moving forward, and while we're waiting on the parts we'll complete the bumper to bumper inspection and I'll reach out with any additional concerns. Is this still the best number to reach you?"

The close is also the natural introduction of the full inspection: it arrives inside a waiting window (parts on order), after the approval — exactly where the DVI belongs (Ch 4: Selling the Inspection Too Early).

STOP · FIRST BASE SAFETY VARIANT

Has the customer concern already been addressed? If yes, 1st base shifts to isolating **safety concerns** — items that must be handled to keep the vehicle safe and reliable. Run the same five steps with the safety framing: "We have completed our initial inspection and we did identify a safety concern that requires your immediate attention." Include the price of the customer concern in the total. Authorize before advancing. **No exceptions.**

PRO TIP · FIRST-BASE STRATEGY: ISOLATE

First base is always isolation. The priority is the customer's original concern — the specific reason they brought the vehicle in. At this stage, nothing else gets discussed. We do not mix in items that could, might, or should be done alongside critical concerns.

Scripts — Second Base: Additional Concern Presentation

CLEAN SCRIPT · THE SECOND BASE CALL

Advisor: "Hey [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] at [Shop]. We've completed the service inspection and we're in progress on everything we've already talked about. Plus, we've completed the full vehicle inspection and we have a couple of additional concerns that require your attention. Is now a good time to review the inspection findings?"

Customer: "Sure."

Advisor: "Did you have a chance to review the pictures and videos I sent over? I refreshed the report, so there's more on there now."

Customer: "I did."

Advisor: "Good news is your vehicle's overall health is in EXCELLENT condition! The suspension system is operating properly. However, the axle boot is leaking grease. It's not an immediate failure, but left unaddressed it can damage the joint. The proper repair is to replace the CV axle to ensure proper lubrication and protection. To address all the additional concerns, the updated total investment is \$[XXX], and obviously everything is covered by our 3-year, 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on both parts and labor. With the [safety or customer concern] in progress, I can go ahead and order these parts and have the technician take care of everything at once. I'll call you with an updated ETA when the parts arrive."

Customer: "Okay, that works."

Advisor: "Great, we'll get the parts ordered right now. The last thing I'm going to do is check for any upcoming scheduled maintenance and call you back with the maintenance plan to protect this investment, so work doesn't build up like this again, and you know what to anticipate for your next visit!"

SCRIPT · 2ND BASE · STEPS 1–3

Step 1 — Reassurance, then permission: "Hey [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] at [Shop]. We've completed the service inspection and we're in progress on everything we've already talked about. Plus, we've completed the full vehicle inspection and we have a couple of additional concerns that require your attention. Is now a good time to review the inspection findings?" By this call, two or three conversations and approvals have already happened — open by confirming the approved work is moving before presenting anything new. *(When the app generates this script, it reads the repair order for the approved work and builds the reassurance line from it.)*

Step 2 — Media verification: "Did you have a chance to review the pictures and videos I sent over? I refreshed the report, so there's more on there now." If yes: continue. If no: ask permission to summarize, or wait for media confirmation.

Step 3 — Good-Good-Bad: "Good news is your vehicle's overall health is in EXCELLENT condition!" "The suspension system is operating properly. However, [state Problem, Risk, Solution], the axle boot is leaking grease. It's not an immediate failure, but left unaddressed it can damage the joint. The proper repair is to replace the CV axle to ensure proper lubrication and protection." *Repeat until all Problems, Risks, and Solutions have been presented.*

SCRIPT · 2ND BASE · STEPS 4-8

Step 4 — Updated total investment: "To address all the additional concerns, the updated total investment is \$____. And obviously everything is covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on both parts and labor." (*The total includes everything already sold.*)

Step 5 — Assume the sale: "With the [safety or customer concern] in progress, I can go ahead and order these parts and have the technician take care of everything at once. I'll call you with an updated ETA when the parts arrive."

Step 6: Answer questions, overcome objections. **Step 7:** Obtain authorization. **Step 8 — Tee up 3rd base:** "Great, we'll get the parts ordered right now. The last thing I'm going to do is check for any upcoming scheduled maintenance and call you back with the maintenance plan to protect this investment, so work doesn't build up like this again, and you know what to anticipate for your next visit!"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · REASSURE FIRST, AND EVERYTHING IS "ADDITIONAL"

The second-base call lands after the customer has already said yes at least once, and their first fear on picking up is that something went wrong with what they approved. The opening kills that fear in one breath: the approved work is in progress. Only then does anything new get presented — and every finding at this stage is labeled ADDITIONAL, because the immediate-attention items were already sold at first base. "Additional concerns" tells the customer the story is growing at the edges, not being rewritten.

STOP

Don't roll into 3rd base on the same call. Hang up. Reset. Re-call. Earn the next conversation.

Scripts — Short Stop: The Missed-Sale Re-Open

CLEAN SCRIPT · THE SHORT STOP RE-OPEN

[Fresh voice, not the original advisor. Tone: concerned, never pushy.]

Advisor: "Hi [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] from [Shop]. I understand you've been working with [first advisor]. Do you have a second for me?"

Customer: "Sure, what's this about?"

Advisor: "Great. I'm just calling about [the item that must be handled to keep this car safe and reliable]. I know [first advisor] called to review the concern with you, and he's informed me that you didn't want to proceed with the repair. Is that accurate?"

Customer: "Yeah, it's just not in the budget right now."

Advisor: "I see, and that brings me to the reason I'm calling. I wanted to ensure we effectively communicated the severity of the concern. [Simple Problem]. [Simple Risk]. [Minimum viable Solution]. If budget is the main concern, we have flexible payment options that can take care of the safety issue today. Can I get that set up for you?"

SCRIPT · SHORT STOP — TONE: CONCERNED, FRESH VOICE

"Hi [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] from [Shop]. I understand you've been working with [advisor who struck out]. Do you... have a second for me?"

"Great, I'm just calling about [whatever must be sold to keep this car safe and reliable]. I know [advisor] called to review the concern with you, and he's informed me that you didn't want to proceed with the repair. Is that accurate?"

The customer will either confirm or state the true objection. If objection: overcome it (Chapter 7). If confirmation:

"I see, that brings me to the reason I'm calling. I wanted to ensure we effectively communicated the severity of the concern: [simple Problem, simple Risk, minimum viable Solution]."

Overcome objections. CLOSE.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY A FRESH VOICE WINS THE SAVE

The customer has already said "no" once and emotionally committed to that no. A new voice resets the social contract — they don't feel like they're flip-flopping, they feel like they're hearing it fresh from someone who genuinely cares about their safety.

Scripts — Third Base: Scheduled Maintenance

CLEAN SCRIPT · THE THIRD BASE CALL

Advisor: "Hi [Customer Name], this is [Your Name] with [Shop]. Everything we've talked about is in progress and moving right along. I'm calling back with that maintenance plan, a few additional maintenance items to review. Is now a good time?"

Customer: "Sure."

Advisor: "The remaining items fall into preventative maintenance. Your transmission and differential fluids are overdue or coming due within the next 10,000 miles based on mileage, so ideally we should address those two services today while we have the car. Addressing them now keeps the systems up to date and maintains the lifetime protection plan, leaving the only services due next visit [services due within 10k], and the service after that will be the [plan]. Addressing the items due will move your total investment for today's work from \$[XXX] to \$[XXXX]. These services are covered by the lifetime protection plan that keeps major system components like the [expensive part] covered for unlimited miles, so long as the services don't go overdue. Can I have the tech get everything fully up to date while it's in the shop?"

SCRIPT · THE 3RD-BASE PITCH

You: "The remaining items fall into preventative maintenance. Your transmission and differential fluids are overdue or coming due within the next 10k based on mileage, so ideally we should address those two services today while we have the car. Addressing them now keeps the systems up to date and maintains the lifetime protection plan, leaving the only services due next visit [services due within 10k], and the service after that will be the [plan].

Addressing the items due will move your total investment for today's work from \$XXX to \$XXXX. These services are covered by the lifetime protection plan that keeps major system components like the [expensive part] covered for unlimited miles, so long as the services don't go overdue.

Can I have the tech get everything fully up to date while it's in the shop?"

PRO TIP · THIRD-BASE STRATEGY

This is a soft sell and should not feel high-pressure. If you get an objection, let the customer know we can always schedule the services for the next visit. Calm tone. No urgency stacking. Long-term ownership framing. And open the same way second base did: by this call, three or four conversations have already happened, so the first sentence reassures ("everything we've talked about is in progress") before any new item is raised — and everything raised here is additional maintenance, never a rewrite of what was sold.

PRO TIP · BASE-SELLING POWER-UPS

Re-engage the conversation every 60–90 seconds. Never rush the price. DO NOT pause after Investment — keep flowing to Coverage. Close confidently: you did not cause the problem, you have the SOLUTION.

Scripts — The Manager Re-Open (Missed Safety Sale)

CLEAN SCRIPT · THE MANAGER RE-OPEN

Advisor: "Hi [Mr./Mrs. Customer], this is [Manager Name] with [Shop]. I just wanted to personally thank you for your visit and check in on your vehicle. Did I catch you at a good time?" *[Pause]*

Customer: "Sure."

Advisor: "One reason I'm calling: there was a safety concern discussed during your visit. I reviewed it myself, and I just want to make sure you have a plan to address it, whether that's with us or elsewhere. My goal is simply to make sure you and your family are protected."

Customer: "We haven't really figured it out yet."

Advisor: "If there's anything we can do, scheduling, transportation, payment options, we have availability. Would you like us to take care of that for you?"

SCRIPT · MANAGER RE-OPEN

"Hi [Mr./Mrs. Customer], this is [Manager Name] with [Shop]. I just wanted to personally thank you for your visit and check in on your vehicle. Did I catch you at a good time?" *[Pause]*

"One reason I'm calling, there was a safety concern discussed during your visit. I reviewed it myself, and I just want to make sure you have a plan to address it, whether that's with us or elsewhere."

"My goal is simply to make sure you and your family are protected."

"If there's anything we can do, scheduling, transportation, payment options, we have availability. Would you like us to take care of that for you?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY "WHETHER WITH US OR ELSEWHERE" CLOSES

By giving the customer permission to leave, you remove the salesperson energy entirely. They lower their guard. Now they are deciding based on safety, not on whether you're trying to extract money. Almost every time, the answer becomes "yeah, just do it."

DRILL 5.A · THE BASE-ORDER RE-SCRIPT

Setup: coach pulls one recorded "everything" call (more than one base presented in a single call). Replay it together. You re-script it aloud as separate base calls, with the hang-up points marked.

Goal: zero same-call mixing for two consecutive weeks. This single intervention has driven more close-rate improvement than any other coaching move in the playbook.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 5 — BASE-SELLING MASTERY

- ☐ Ran the bases in correct order on every workflow (1st → 2nd → Short Stop if needed → 3rd → Home).
- ☐ Used Good-Good-Bad framing on every base.
- ☐ Stated full PRS on every finding — never skipped Risk.
- ☐ Did not kitchen-sink. Hung up between bases. Re-called for the next base.
- ☐ Tied total investment to coverage (warranty) without a pause.

COACH'S CORNER · LISTENING FOR THE "EVERYTHING" CALL

The coach pulls one recorded call per advisor per week. If more than one base was presented in a single call, it gets flagged and replayed together, then re-scripted as separate base calls. Most low-ARO shops are 3rd-basing maintenance items they should be 2nd-basing — the coach audits Diamond order in the strategize step, before the call ever happens.

KPIs

Base-Order Compliance ≥ 90% % of workflows that ran the bases in proper order.	PRS Completeness 100% % of findings that included all three: Problem, Risk, Solution.
Same-Call Mixing ≤ 5% % of calls where more than one base was presented.	

Present — Educate Into Certainty

Mission: Convert findings into customer understanding. An educated customer authorizes; a confused one defers.

This step removes the uncertainty: **"Why this, why now, what's it cost?"**

OBJECTIVE EDUCATE	PACE RE-ENGAGE 60–90s	PRIMARY KPI PRESENT → AUTH %	FAILURE MODE MONOLOGUE
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The Communication Map — Customer Confidence Across the Call

A structured presentation moves the customer up the confidence curve, one micro-commitment at a time: permission → good-good-bad → PRS + photo → investment + warranty → authorization. A monologue — even a technically correct one — flatlines them in anxiety. Structure is the difference.

Re-Engagement Loops — The 60-to-90-Second Rule

Human attention on a phone call is measured in tens of seconds. Long monologues lose the customer even when the content is correct. The discipline: every 60–90 seconds, insert a micro-question that re-engages the customer's mind and confirms they're still tracking.

CLEAN SCRIPT · RE-ENGAGEMENT MICRO-QUESTIONS

Advisor: "Does that make sense so far?"

Advisor: "Were you able to see that in the photo I sent?"

Advisor: "Any questions on what we've covered so far?"

Advisor: "Any other concerns you'd like to share?"

Advisor: "Is this still the best number to reach you?"

SCRIPT · RE-ENGAGEMENT MICRO-QUESTIONS

"Does that make sense so far?"

"Were you able to see that in the photo I sent?"

"Any questions on what we've covered so far?" / "Any other concerns you'd like to share?"

"Is this still the best number to reach you?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY MICRO-QUESTIONS MULTIPLY CLOSE RATE

Every "yes" the customer gives during the presentation is a small commitment that compounds toward the authorization "yes" at the end. By the time you ask for the work, the customer has already said yes a half-dozen times. The final yes is just one more small step instead of a big leap.

The 10-Step ISO Presentation Structure

Investment-Solution-Outcome, run in this exact sequence on any 1st-base safety call. The structure never changes; only the technical content does.

#	BEAT	WHAT IT DOES
1	Greeting + frame (warm opening & time check)	Re-establishes rapport; "is now a good time?" gives agency and reduces resistance.
2	Recap the concern (advisor co-review)	"I personally reviewed" scores Competence + Trustworthy in one sentence.
3	Media confirmation	Locks in the DVI evidence before delivering the finding.
4	Vehicle health overview	Permission frame; honors the original reason for the visit. Good-Good-Bad order begins.
5	Walk the green (good news)	First positive — what's healthy. Primes receptivity.
6	Walk the yellow / more good news	Second positive. Reframes a discovery as a save: "caught it early" = competence + caring.
7	Walk the red — PRS each finding	Full Problem · Risk · Solution. Risk named explicitly — the urgency engine.
8	Investment	Single number, parts and labor. No itemization (that's Boss Battle 8 territory).
9	Coverage	Warranty, what's included, financing, value reframe — NO PAUSE between 8 and 9.
10	Direction question / tee-up & callback	Assumptive close; sets up the next base; confirms contact (commitment).

STOP · NEVER PAUSE BETWEEN INVESTMENT AND COVERAGE

The pause after stating the price is read by the customer as "wait for my reaction" — it's empty air they fill with doubt, and it's where the deal dies. Coverage must follow Investment in the same breath, every time: "...the investment for that today is \$X, and here's everything that covers it..." Rehearse until this is one thought, not two.

Worked Example — The Gold-Standard 1st-Base ISO Safety Presentation

The water-pump-leak example is the canonical reference template for any 1st-base safety call. Every sentence maps to a deliberate move.

Clean first. The complete call, straight through, exactly as the customer hears it. The anatomized teaching version follows.

C L E A N S C R I P T · T H E 1 0 - S T E P I S O P R E S E N T A T I O N (W A T E R P U M P)

Advisor: "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Thanks for your patience. Is now a good time to go over your vehicle?"

Customer: "Yes, now works."

Advisor: "I personally reviewed your vehicle with our certified technician so I could give you a clear picture of what's going on. Were you able to view the photos, videos, or the digital inspection report we sent over?"

Customer: "I did, yes."

Advisor: "You brought your vehicle in for an oil change. We've completed the initial inspection and I wanted to review what we found. The good news is your digital inspection report clearly documents everything with photos and notes so you can see exactly what we're seeing, and we caught this early, before it turned into a bigger issue. More good news: during our inspection we found that your water pump is leaking, which is separate from your original visit and something we can take care of now before it leads to further damage. If left as is, a leaking water pump can lead to engine overheating, coolant loss, and eventually major engine damage. The proper repair is to remove and replace the water pump and complete a full cooling system service so everything is clean, sealed, and operating at the correct temperature. The total investment for today's work, including the oil service you already approved, is \$1,695.46, parts and labor included, and this work is covered by our 3-year, 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on parts and labor."

Customer: "Alright, let's go ahead and do it."

Advisor: "Okay, great. I'll get the parts ordered, and while we're waiting on those we'll finish the bumper to bumper digital inspection and I'll reach out if anything else needs attention. Is this still the best number to reach you?"

Customer: "Yes, that number is best."

Advisor: "Perfect. I'll get everything moving and call you with an update."

WORKED EXAMPLE · BASE-1 ISO SAFETY PRESENTATION — WATER PUMP LEAK

1 · Warm Opening & Time Check. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Thanks for your patience, is now a good time to go over your vehicle?"

2 · Advisor Co-Review (Credibility). "I personally reviewed your vehicle with our certified technician so I could give you a clear picture of what's going on."

3 · Media Confirmation. "Were you able to view the photos, videos, or the digital inspection report we sent over?"

4 · Concern & Inspection. "You brought your vehicle in for an oil change. We've completed the initial inspection and I wanted to review what we found."

5 · Good News (positives). "The good news is your digital inspection report clearly documents everything with photos and notes so you can see exactly what we're seeing, and we caught this early, before it turned into a bigger issue."

6 · More Good News (discovery). "More good news, during our inspection we found that your water pump is leaking, which is separate from your original visit and something we can take care of now before it leads to further damage."

7 · Risk → Solution. "If left as-is, a leaking water pump can lead to engine overheating, coolant loss, and eventually major engine damage. The proper repair is to remove and replace the water pump and complete a full cooling system service so everything is clean, sealed, and operating at the correct temperature."

8 · Total Investment. "The total investment for today's work, including the oil service you already approved, is \$1,695.46, parts and labor included."

9 · Coverage. "This work is covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty, parts and labor."

10 · Tee-Up & Callback. After the customer agrees: "Okay, great. I'll get the parts ordered, and while we're waiting on those we'll finish the bumper to bumper digital inspection and I'll reach out if anything else needs attention. Is this still the best number to reach you?" Then: "Perfect. I'll get everything moving and call you with an update." The seal assumes the sale and delivers the bumper-to-bumper inside the parts waiting window.

STOP · "INCLUDING" POINTS BACKWARD, NEVER FORWARD

In the ISO total, "including" may only reference work the customer has ALREADY approved ("including the oil service you already approved"). Never attach it to the repair being presented ("including the cooling system service") — that frames part of the presented repair as an extra bolted onto the price, and extras read as padding. The presented repair is one comprehensive, inherent solution with one number; the "including" clause exists to remind the customer their earlier yes is already inside it.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE ANATOMY IN ONE LINE PER BEAT

Beats 1–3 re-run Steps 1, 2, and 4 of the sales process in miniature — rapport, credibility, evidence. Beats 5–6 are Good-Good-Bad. Beat 7 is the full PRS with the Risk explicit. Beats 8–9 are one breath. Beat 10 sets up 2nd base before this call is even over. Once the pattern is automatic, you only have to think about the repair — the structure carries itself.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 6 — PRESENTATION MASTERY

- ☐ Asked permission to speak before delivering findings.
- ☐ Confirmed the DVI was viewed (or summarized with permission).
- ☐ Used Good-Good-Bad and full PRS on every finding.
- ☐ Investment immediately followed by Coverage — no pause.
- ☐ Re-engaged at least every 90 seconds with a micro-question.
- ☐ Ended with a tee-up sentence for the next base.

COACH'S CORNER · ONE PRESENTATION CALL PER WEEK, SCORED AGAINST THE 10 BEATS

The coach uses the anatomy table as a scorecard — each numbered beat marked Present / Partial / Missing — and coaches the missing items one at a time. The two most common gaps: skipping Risk (beat 7), and pausing between Investment and Coverage (beats 8/9).

KPIs

Present → Auth %

≥ 70%

% of presentations that end in authorization.

PRS Completeness

100%

% of findings with Problem, Risk, Solution stated in order.

DVI View Before Call

≥ 75%

Strong leading indicator of authorization.

Overcome Objections — The 9 Boss Battles

Mission: Convert hesitation into clarity. Objections are not rejection — they are uncertainty wearing a costume.

This step removes: **the customer's remaining specific doubts.**

OBJECTIVE RESOLVE HESITATION	FRAMEWORK 9 BOSS BATTLES	PRIMARY KPI 1ST-OBJ CLOSE %	FAILURE MODE ARGUING
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The Objection Translation Matrix

Objections are never literal. They are always a stand-in for a deeper uncertainty the customer either can't name or doesn't want to admit. Your job is to translate the surface objection into the real one — then respond to that.

WHAT THE CUSTOMER SAYS	WHAT THEY ACTUALLY MEAN	YOUR OBJECTIVE	THE MOVE
"I'm going to sell the car"	"This feels like throwing money at a sinking ship"	Reframe the alternative	Boss 1 — cost-of-replacement math
"Price is too high"	"I'm not sure this is real value"	Anchor to what they're actually buying	Boss 2 — Anti-Lowest-Price Brag
"Don't have the money"	"Not today — but I might if there's a way"	Reframe from cost to timing	Boss 3 — Money Reframe / financing pivot
"Talk to my spouse"	"I need backup / a delay"	Get the spouse on the same call	Boss 4 — Three-Way Bypass
"I'll wait"	"I'm unsure of urgency"	Clarify safety vs. maintenance	Boss 5 — risk reframe
"You're always selling"	"I don't fully trust you"	Shift from salesperson to fiduciary	Boss 6 — Pro Obligation Frame
"I need my car today"	"Logistics fear"	Solve logistics first, then return to the repair	Boss 7 — transport offer
"Parts and labor breakdown?"	"I want to comparison-shop"	Refuse the apples-to-apples frame	Boss 8 — protection-program reframe
"I want a second opinion / I can get it cheaper"	"I'm not sure this price is honest, and I'm afraid of overpaying"	Reinforce the finding, then problem-solve the price together	Boss 9 — Honest Disarm + Short Stop + Repair Plan

The Five Universal Rules of Objection Handling

1. **Never argue.** Arguing tells the customer they were wrong to feel the way they feel. Even if you win the argument, you've lost the relationship.
2. **Acknowledge first, always.** "I completely understand" / "I hear you" / "Fair enough." This is not concession — it's permission to be heard.
3. **Find the real concern.** Clarifying questions: "Is it more than you expected, or are you comparing it to another estimate?" Information beats persuasion.
4. **Pivot to value or risk, never to discount.** The instant you discount in response to an objection, you have trained the customer to objection-shop you forever.
5. **Re-ask for the close.** Every objection-handled exchange must end with another move toward authorization. Otherwise you've just had a conversation.

Mirror the emotion, name the underlying concern, then bridge to the script. Never use "but."

Boss 1 — "I'm Selling the Car"

C L E A N S C R I P T · B O S S 1

Customer: "I appreciate everything, but I'm probably just going to sell it. I don't want to put more money into it."

Advisor: "I completely understand. Big repairs can make you step back and rethink things. Out of curiosity, are you planning to replace it with something newer or used?"

Customer: "Probably used. I don't want another big payment."

Advisor: "That makes sense. Let me give you something to consider. Most used vehicles today are still a major investment, and you're inheriting someone else's maintenance history. With your vehicle, we know exactly what condition it's in because we just inspected it bumper to bumper. Based on what we saw, this vehicle still has strong life left in it. Let me ask you this: if you could purchase this exact vehicle, knowing the major systems have just been inspected and repaired, for a fraction of the cost of another vehicle, would that make sense?"

Customer: "I didn't think about it that way."

Advisor: "Right now you're not throwing money at an old car. You're making a smart investment in a vehicle you already own and understand. The average used car today runs up to \$25,000, and the insurance rates are outrageous. To get this vehicle back to safe and reliable, we're talking about [total investment]. I completely understand if you're simply in the market for a new car, but if you're looking to make a smart financial decision, my professional advice would be to repair the car instead of buying a used car that may need the same in repairs, or more."

SCRIPT · BOSS 1 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "I appreciate everything, but I'm probably just going to sell it. I don't want to put more money into it."

You: "I completely understand. Big repairs can make you step back and rethink things. Out of curiosity, are you planning to replace it with something newer or used?"

Customer: "Probably used. I don't want another big payment."

You: "That makes sense. Let me give you something to consider. Most used vehicles today are still a major investment, and you're inheriting someone else's maintenance history. With your vehicle, we know exactly what condition it's in because we just inspected it bumper to bumper. Based on what we saw, this vehicle still has strong life left in it. Let me ask you this, if you could purchase this exact vehicle, knowing the major systems have just been inspected and repaired, for a fraction of the cost of another vehicle... would that make sense?"

Customer: "I didn't think about it that way."

You: "Right now you're not throwing money at an old car, you're making a smart investment in a vehicle you already own and understand. The average used car today runs up to \$25,000, and the insurance rates are outrageous. To get this vehicle back to safe and reliable, we're talking about [state total investment]. I completely understand if you're simply in the market for a new car, but if you're looking to make a smart financial decision, my professional advice would be to repair the car instead of buying a used car that may need the same in repairs, or more."

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · REFRAMING BUY VS. REPAIR

The customer is comparing repair cost to \$0. You reframe it against the real alternative — the cost, risk, and unknown history of another vehicle. Once that frame lands, your repair becomes the cheap option.

Boss 2 — "The Price Is Too High"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 2

Customer: "That just seems like a lot."

Advisor: "I hear you. Let me ask, is it more than you expected, or are you comparing it to another estimate?"

Customer: "It just feels high."

Advisor: "Fair enough. We're not positioned as the lowest-priced option in town, and that's intentional. We invest in experienced, certified technicians. We back our work with a 3-year, 36,000-mile nationwide warranty. And we stand behind it with real support if something ever comes up. You're paying for the parts, the certified installation, the warranty that protects them, and a shop that stands behind the work. You're investing in doing it correctly the first time. Have you ever gone with the cheaper option before and ended up paying for it twice?"

Customer: "Yeah, I suppose."

Advisor: "That's exactly what we're helping you avoid. Let's go ahead and get this handled properly so you don't have to revisit it again. I'll get it moving and keep you updated. Is this still the best number?"

SCRIPT · BOSS 2 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "That just seems like a lot."

You: "I hear you. Let me ask, is it more than you expected, or are you comparing it to another estimate?"

Customer: "It just feels high."

You: "Fair enough. We're not positioned as the lowest-priced option in town, and that's intentional. We invest in experienced, certified technicians. We back our work with a 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty. And we stand behind it with real support if something ever comes up. You're paying for the parts, the certified installation, the warranty that protects them, and a shop that stands behind the work. You're investing in doing it correctly the first time. Have you ever gone with the cheaper option before and ended up paying for it twice?"

Customer: "Yeah... I suppose."

You: "That's exactly what we're helping you avoid. Let's go ahead and get this handled properly so you don't have to revisit it again. I'll get it moving and keep you updated. Is this still the best number?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE ANTI-LOWEST-PRICE BRAG

Saying out loud "we are not the cheapest, and that's intentional" is a confidence move. Most shops apologize for price. Owning it makes the customer respect the price tag instead of fighting it. Never apologize for price — and never disparage the competitor; raise your own bar instead.

Boss 3 — "I Don't Have the Money Right Now"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 3

Customer: "I just don't have the money today."

Advisor: "I completely understand. Auto repairs rarely show up at a convenient time. Always after a big expense, or when you least expect it. Something a lot of our customers LOVE to take advantage of is our flexible payment options. If I can take care of the repair now and let you pay me back with no interest, can I get the parts ordered and move forward?"

Customer: "Yes!"

Advisor: "I just sent you a link to fill out a form with one of our payment partners. Once it's complete I'll see it come through on my side and we can go from there! Did you receive the link?"

SCRIPT · BOSS 3 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "I just don't have the money today."

You: "I completely understand. Auto repairs rarely show up at a convenient time, always after a big expense, or when you least expect it. Something a lot of our customers LOVE to take advantage of is our flexible payment options. If I can take care of the repair now and let you pay me back with no interest, can I get the parts ordered and move forward?"

Customer: "YES!?" *(They laugh, you laugh... send them the link.)*

You: "I just sent you a link to fill out a form with one of our payment partners. Once it's complete I'll see it come through on my side and we can go from there! Did you receive the link?"

PRO TIP · BOSS 3

Stay on the phone with them as they fill out the form, so you can close the moment the approved application comes through.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE MONEY REFRAME

Customers say "I don't have the money" when they mean "I don't have the money TODAY." You are no longer selling the repair — you are selling the option of solving the problem now and paying later. Almost no one declines that.

Boss 4 — "I Need to Talk to My Spouse"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 4

Customer: "I need to run this by my spouse first."

Advisor: "I completely understand. Decisions like this are definitely best made together. To make sure both you and your spouse have all the correct information at the same time, the most efficient way to proceed is a brief three-way call. I can review everything I just covered, you'll both be fully informed, and you can make the best decision for your situation. Is your spouse available to join us now, or should I reach out to them to review this information and call you back?"

Customer: "Let me try to get them on the phone."

SCRIPT · BOSS 4 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "I need to run this by my spouse first."

You: "I completely understand, decisions like this are definitely best made together. To make sure both you and your spouse have all the correct information at the same time, the most efficient way to proceed is a brief three-way call. I can review everything I just covered, you'll both be fully informed, and you can make the best decision for your situation. Is your spouse available to join us now, or should I reach out to them to review this information and call you back?"

Customer: "Let me try to get them on the phone."

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE THREE-WAY BYPASS

Most "talk to my spouse" objections die in the parking lot. The decision never gets a fair hearing because the customer repeats it second-hand. By offering to be on the call yourself, you ensure the spouse hears the same PRS and warranty story that built trust in the first place.

Boss 5 — "I'm Going to Wait"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 5

VERSION 1 · SAFETY CONCERN

Customer: "I think I'll wait on that."

Advisor: "I understand. I do want to be transparent. This one falls into a safety category. Right now the brakes are past normal wear and into potential damage. That can affect stopping distance and control. Are you planning to drive it?"

Customer: "Yes, just around town."

Advisor: "Even short trips carry risk in this condition. My job is to protect you, not pressure you. If budget is the concern, we can look at payment options, but I don't recommend postponing something that affects safety."

VERSION 2 · PREVENTATIVE MAINTENANCE

Customer: "I'll just wait on the fluid services."

Advisor: "No worries, they're not urgent today. What we're seeing in those systems is buildup that doesn't show symptoms until damage starts. Doing them now protects the components while everything is accessible. If we skip them today, are you planning to schedule it soon, or wait until something starts acting up?"

Customer: "Probably the next oil change."

Advisor: "Understood. Just keep in mind preventative service is always less expensive than corrective repair. If it makes sense to bundle it while it's already here, we can space out the cost as well."

PRO TIP · BOSS 5 STRATEGY

This usually means one of two things: they're unsure about urgency, or they're avoiding committing. Your job: clarify risk if it's a safety concern; reframe value if it's maintenance. If it's the "just do the safety stuff, skip the rest" version — agree, defer, and **schedule the deferred items** so they leave with an appointment for the rest.

SCRIPT · BOSS 5 · EXAMPLE 1 — SAFETY CONCERN

Customer: "I think I'll wait on that."

You: "I understand. I do want to be transparent, this one falls into a safety category. Right now the brakes are past normal wear and into potential damage. That can affect stopping distance and control. Are you planning to drive it?"

Customer: "Yes, just around town."

You: "Even short trips carry risk in this condition. My job is to protect you, not pressure you. If budget is the concern, we can look at payment options, but I don't recommend postponing something that affects safety."

SCRIPT · BOSS 5 · EXAMPLE 2 — PREVENTATIVE MAINTENANCE

Customer: "I'll just wait on the fluid services."

You: "No worries, they're not urgent today. What we're seeing in those systems is buildup that doesn't show symptoms until damage starts. Doing them now protects the components while everything is accessible. If we skip them today, are you planning to schedule it soon, or wait until something starts acting up?"

Customer: "Probably the next oil change."

You: "Understood. Just keep in mind preventative service is always less expensive than corrective repair. If it makes sense to bundle it while it's already here, we can space out the cost as well."

Boss 6 — "You're Always Trying to Sell Me"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 6

Customer: "Every time I come in, you try to sell me something."

Advisor: "I appreciate you saying that. My goal isn't to sell you. It's to inspect your vehicle thoroughly and give you accurate information. Every car that comes through our shop receives a full digital inspection. That means checking safety components, wear items, and potential issues before they become problems. You're never obligated to approve anything. But it's my Professional Obligation to make sure you know what we see. Would you like me to walk you through today's inspection results so you can decide what makes sense?"

SCRIPT · BOSS 6 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "Every time I come in, you try to sell me something."

You: "I appreciate you saying that. My goal isn't to sell you, it's to inspect your vehicle thoroughly and give you accurate information. Every car that comes through our shop receives a full digital inspection. That means checking safety components, wear items, and potential issues before they become problems. You're never obligated to approve anything. But it's my Professional Obligation to make sure you know what we see. Would you like me to walk you through today's inspection results so you can decide what makes sense?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE PRO OBLIGATION FRAME

Calling out your "Professional Obligation" shifts you from salesperson to fiduciary. The customer's defenses drop because you just told them they are in control.

Boss 7 — "I Need My Car Today"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 7

Customer: "I really need my car today."

Advisor: "I understand. Let's solve the transportation side first. We have loaner vehicles, Uber rides, and pickup and drop-off options. Would one of those help make this easier for you?"

Customer: "An Uber ride would help."

Advisor: "Perfect. I'll get that arranged so we can repair your vehicle properly without rushing anything. Once it's complete, I'll give you a call. Still the best number?"

PRO TIP · BOSS 7 STRATEGY

Two possibilities: a real logistical need, or avoiding the decision. First solve transportation. Then return to the repair.

SCRIPT · BOSS 7 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "I really need my car today."

You: "I understand. Let's solve the transportation side first. We have loaner vehicles, Uber rides, and pickup/drop-off options. Would one of those help make this easier for you?"

Customer: "An Uber ride would help."

You: "Perfect. I'll get that arranged so we can repair your vehicle properly without rushing anything. Once it's complete, I'll give you a call. Still the best number?"

Boss 8 — "Can I Get a Parts and Labor Breakdown?"

CLEAN SCRIPT · BOSS 8

Customer: "Can you break down parts and labor?"

Advisor: "I can absolutely review the estimate with you. Just to clarify, we're not structured as a parts-and-labor shop. We're structured around protection and execution. You're paying for certified technicians, proper procedures, warranty coverage, and post-repair support, and the components come backed by all of it. We also include a 3-year, 36,000-mile nationwide warranty, roadside assistance, a quality-control inspection, and digital documentation. That's why it doesn't break down into a simple commodity model. Does that help clarify where the value is?"

SCRIPT · BOSS 8 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "Can you break down parts and labor?"

You: "I can absolutely review the estimate with you. Just to clarify, we're not structured as a parts-and-labor shop. We're structured around protection and execution. You're paying for certified technicians, proper procedures, warranty coverage, and post-repair support, and the components come backed by all of it. We also include: a 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty, roadside assistance, a quality-control inspection, and digital documentation. That's why it doesn't break down into a simple commodity model. Does that help clarify where the value is?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · DON'T TRADE APPLES FOR APPLES

Once you let the customer compare your line items to a competitor's line items, you have lost. You sell a complete protection program, not parts and minutes. Keep the conversation in that frame. If the customer asks for a repair "without the part" — same family of objection — use the Pro Obligation frame: "I can't ethically do it that way and still warrant the work, but here's what we can do..."

Boss 9 — "I Want a Second Opinion / I Can Get It Done Cheaper"

This is a post-inspection battle. The vehicle has been in, the DVI exists, the PRS has been delivered. That changes the rules: the evidence exists, so education is not only allowed here — it is the weapon. Boss 9 opens on the same train of thought as the price bosses: empathize first, anchor with the paid-twice question, then agree with the customer (the Honest Disarm). What wins the battle is what comes next: the huddle, the Short Stop, and a repair plan built WITH the customer — because the prize of this battle is not this repair. The prize is a customer for life.

Customer: "I appreciate you walking me through everything, but honestly, your price seems high. I think I want to get a second opinion and shop around, see if I can get it done cheaper."

Advisor: "I completely understand, and that's a fair thing to want. Let me ask you this first: have you ever paid for something twice and not got it done?"

Customer: "Yeah, actually. That's part of what I'm worried about."

Advisor: "That's exactly what I want to protect you from. And I'll be straight with you: the reality is we are able to do this cheaper. I don't want you to think that this is set in stone and this has to be done. This is the proper repair. This is the most comprehensive solution to solve the problem and ensure that we don't have problems anymore. We can definitely shop some cheaper parts, and that's going to reduce the price, but it might also reduce the warranty."

Customer: "Okay. I'd still like to see what it would run somewhere else."

Advisor: "Before you do that, give me two minutes. Let me grab the technician who had his hands on your vehicle today, we talk to him, and we find out if there's a smarter way to get this done. You'll be getting your second opinion from the person who actually inspected it. Give me one second."

[Huddle with the technician away from the customer first. Then the Short Stop joins the customer with the DVI open. Ideally the Short Stop IS the technician; realistically it is whoever the shop trusts to run this play. Hard rule: the Short Stop never contradicts the advisor.]

Short Stop: "Hi [Customer Name], I'm [Name]. I went through your vehicle today, and I want to start by confirming what [Advisor Name] walked you through, exactly as he presented it. Here's the photo of [the finding]. If it's left as it is, [Risk]. The repair he presented is the proper repair and the right way to solve this. Nobody here is making anything up."

Customer: "I believe you. It's just more than I can do right now."

Advisor: "Then let's solve that together. Can we create a repair plan where we take care of a portion of it today and move on?"

Short Stop: "And while we build that plan, we can look at every option we've got. We have flexible payment options that can spread the investment out, and [Advisor Name] can talk with the owner about the labor time and about taking care of the [accompanying service] that goes with this job. The goal is a number that makes sense for you and still fixes this the right way."

Customer: "Okay. If we can get to a number that works, I'd rather just have you guys do it."

THE CUSTOMER-FOR-LIFE CLOSE

Advisor: "That's exactly what we want. Thank you for working through this with us instead of driving across town. We'll find the middle ground that makes sense for everyone. And from here on out, whenever this car needs anything, you'll never have to wonder where to take it."

SCRIPT · BOSS 9 · THE EXCHANGE

Customer: "Honestly, your price seems high. I want to get a second opinion and see if I can get it done cheaper."

You: "I completely understand, and that's a fair thing to want. Let me ask you this first: have you ever paid for something twice and not got it done?"

Customer: "Yeah, actually. That's part of what I'm worried about."

You: "That's exactly what I want to protect you from. And I'll be straight with you: the reality is we are able to do this cheaper. I don't want you to think that this is set in stone and this has to be done. This is the proper repair. This is the most comprehensive solution to solve the problem and ensure that we don't have problems anymore. We can definitely shop some cheaper parts, and that's going to reduce the price, but it might also reduce the warranty."

Customer: "Okay. I'd still like to see what it would run somewhere else."

You: "Before you do that, give me two minutes. Let me grab the technician who had his hands on your vehicle today, and we find out if there's a smarter way to get this done." [Huddle with the technician away from the counter first: can it really take the booked hours, or can we work smarter to reduce the cost? Then the Short Stop joins the customer, DVI open. He reinforces the finding, the risk, and the recommendation exactly as the advisor presented them — never contradicts — and only then opens the problem-solving: "Can we create a repair plan where we take care of a portion of it today and move on?" Work the levers to a middle ground and land the Customer-for-Life Close.]

STOP · THE REINFORCEMENT RULE — THE SHORT STOP NEVER CONTRADICTS THE ADVISOR

The Short Stop must NEVER contradict what the advisor already told the customer. Not on the finding, not on the risk, not on the recommendation. The moment the second voice disagrees with the first, the customer hears one thing: this shop is making things up — and the advisor's trustworthiness, the asset every future visit depends on, is destroyed on the spot. The Short Stop REINFORCES first: the presented repair is the proper solution, exactly as presented. A second voice confirming the same story is what proves nobody is making anything up. Only after the reinforcement lands does the collaborative problem-solving open — showing the customer we're willing to work with them, not a hard take-it-or-leave-it wall. Reinforce first. Problem-solve second. No exceptions.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE HONEST DISARM

"Second opinion" is not a price objection — it is a trust objection wearing a price costume. The customer is braced for you to defend the number, because a shop that defends its number sounds like a shop hiding its margin. So you do the last thing they expect: you agree. "We are able to do this cheaper" is true, disarming, and instantly re-classifies you as the honest party in the conversation — which is exactly what the customer was about to drive across town looking for. The honesty comes packaged with the tradeoff, stated plainly: cheaper parts reduce the price AND may reduce the warranty. Never sell the cheaper tier silently; the customer chooses it with eyes open or not at all.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE SHORT STOP, LIVE

This is the Short Stop run live, while the objection is still on the table, instead of a fresh voice re-opening a missed sale by phone tomorrow. Ideally the Short Stop IS the technician — the highest technical authority in the building, the person whose hands were physically on the vehicle. Realistically, it is whoever the shop trusts to run the play: a lead tech, a second advisor, the manager. What matters is the mechanism, not the job title: a second trusted voice joins the same call or visit, confirms the finding and the risk against the DVI evidence, and proves nobody is making anything up. The customer wanted a second opinion; the second opinion just walked in. Then — and only then — the conversation turns to solving the price together.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE REPAIR PLAN

"Can we create a repair plan where we take care of a portion of it today and move on?" is the pivot from wall to workbench. A flat "this is the price" is a take-it-or-leave-it wall, and walls get walked away from. The repair plan says the opposite: we are willing to work with you. Before it is offered, the advisor huddles with the technician away from the counter — can this really take the booked hours, or can we work smarter and bring the cost down? Then the shop works the levers, in the open, with the customer: flexible payment options that spread the investment; a conversation with the advisor or the owner about comping some labor time or comping the accompanying oil service; whatever gets to a price point that makes sense. The destination is a middle ground that makes sense for everyone.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · MINIMUM VIABLE REPAIR

Naming the true floor — the absolute minimum of what needs to be replaced — proves the recommendation was never padded. The customer's fear is that "comprehensive" is code for "loaded up." When the Short Stop states the minimum out loud, the estimate stops being one suspicious number and becomes a ladder of protection: minimum, better, comprehensive, with the warranty difference explicit at every rung. Use it as a lever inside the problem-solving phase wherever the repair genuinely can be tiered — and know its limit: when the components all touch (see the engine reseat below), piecing the job out is not the proper repair, and the honest lever is the repair plan, not a false tier.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · EARNING A CUSTOMER FOR LIFE (THE REAL PRIZE)

Reframe the whole battle: the goal is not to win this repair. The goal is to EARN A CUSTOMER FOR LIFE — to program one sentence into the customer's mind: "If I have a problem with my car, it goes to this shop." A customer who just watched the shop confirm its own honesty with a second voice, open its options, and build a plan around their budget doesn't shop around next time; there is nothing left to shop for. That is why the battle ends on the named Customer-for-Life Close: thank them for working through it with us, promise the middle ground, and tell them they will never have to wonder where to take the car. Win the customer, and this repair — and every repair after it — follows.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · THE MARGIN MATH AND THE MIDDLE
GROUND (ADVISOR-FACING ONLY — NEVER DIALOGUE)

Know the room you are negotiating in. A labor-heavy job like the full engine reseat below runs roughly 93 percent gross profit at \$7,000 — there is real room to wiggle before the shop feels it. That is why comping some labor time or comping the accompanying oil service is a lever, not a loss. But the middle ground has a second wall: do not cater so far that a technician ties up a lift for 33 hours that could have served other high-dollar repairs. Middle ground means the plan works for the customer AND the shop — the price point on one side, bay time and opportunity cost on the other. These numbers are decoder material. They never, under any circumstances, reach the customer's ear.

WORKED EXAMPLE · THE FULL ENGINE RESEAL REPAIR PLAN

The setup: the customer brings the vehicle in expecting an upper and lower oil pan reseal, budgeted \$1,500 to \$2,000 tops. The inspection shows the upper pan, lower pan, timing cover, and both valve covers all leaking. The components all touch, so the proper repair is a full engine reseal — 33 hours of book time, quoted at about \$7,000. The customer is in good standing and threatens to take it to another shop. It is purely price.

Customer: "I came in for the oil pan reseal. I budgeted maybe two thousand dollars for this. Now you're telling me seven thousand. I think I'll just take it to another shop."

Advisor: "I completely understand. You planned for one number and heard a very different one. Let me ask you this first: have you ever paid for something twice and not got it done?"

Customer: "That's exactly what I'm trying to avoid."

Advisor: "Me too. So let me be straight with you. The pans you came in for are leaking, and so are the timing cover and both valve covers. All of those seals touch each other. If we only reseal the pans today, we're opening up an engine we know is leaking in three other places, and that's not the proper repair. The proper repair is to reseal the engine as one job. Before you go anywhere, give me two minutes with my technician."

[The huddle, away from the counter: "Does this really take 33 hours, or can we work smarter and bring the cost down?" Then the Short Stop joins the customer with the DVI open. Reinforce first. Problem-solve second.]

Short Stop: "Hi [Customer Name], I'm [Name]. I went through your engine today, and I want to confirm what [Advisor Name] told you, exactly as he presented it. The upper pan, the lower pan, the timing cover, and both valve covers are all leaking. Here are the photos. They all touch each other, so the proper repair is a full engine reseal. Nobody here is making anything up, and if this could be done properly for two thousand dollars, I would tell you."

Customer: "I believe you. I just can't do seven thousand dollars right now."

Advisor: "Then let's not make it seven thousand dollars today. Can we create a repair plan where we take care of a portion of it today and move on?"

Short Stop: "And we've got real options to work with. We have flexible payment options that can spread this out. [Advisor Name] can talk with the owner about the labor time, and about taking care of the oil service that goes along with this job. Between the plan and those options, we can get this to a number that makes sense."

Customer: "If you can get it somewhere I can manage, I'd rather keep it here. You guys have always taken care of me."

Advisor: "And we always will. Thank you for working through this with us instead of driving across town. We'll build the plan, I'll make those calls, and I'll have real numbers for you before anything moves forward. From here on out, whenever this car needs anything, you'll never have to wonder where to take it."

The middle ground has to make sense for everyone: the customer gets a price point that works, and the shop keeps the repair, the relationship, and every visit after it.

PRO TIP · BOSS 9 STRATEGY

Three rules make this battle safe. One: never run it before the inspection — without evidence it collapses into phone pre-education, which is banned. Two: the Reinforcement Rule — the Short Stop backs the advisor completely before any problem-solving begins. Three: collaboration has boundaries — every option on the table (repair plan, payment options, comped labor time, comped oil service, cheaper parts with the warranty tradeoff stated out loud) must still genuinely solve the problem or move the customer toward the proper repair. End on the Customer-for-Life Close, never on a take-it-or-leave-it.

DRILL 7.A · THE BOSS RUSH

Setup: 15-minute team standup, all hands, standing. Coach throws random Boss lines; advisors counter in turn, no notes. In the app, the AI plays each persona and scores your counter in real time.

Score: 1–3 per counter. Leaderboard posted.

Goal: clear all nine in live calls within 30 days. Run it every single morning of rollout Phase 2 — by week 8 you'll have heard every Boss 40+ times in drill and you will counter them in your sleep. For Boss 9, a second advisor (or the coach) plays the Short Stop so the tag-in gets drilled as a two-person move, not just words. The scoring gate on every Boss 9 rep: the Short Stop must reinforce the advisor's presentation before any problem-solving starts — a contradiction fails the rep.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 4 — BOSS RUSH MASTERY

- ☐ Boss 1 — Selling the Car
- ☐ Boss 2 — Price Too High
- ☐ Boss 3 — No Money Right Now
- ☐ Boss 4 — Talk to My Spouse
- ☐ Boss 5 — I'm Going to Wait
- ☐ Boss 6 — You're Always Selling
- ☐ Boss 7 — I Need My Car Today
- ☐ Boss 8 — Parts & Labor Breakdown
- ☐ Boss 9 — Second Opinion / Shop Around

Defeat all 9 in live calls within 30 days → Level 4 cleared. You are now a PRO.

COACH'S CORNER · THE WEEKLY BOSS RUSH

The coach tracks who has cleared all nine in live calls within 30 days and posts the leaderboard. This is the fastest path to Level 4 (Pro). When 1st-Objection Close stalls below 40%, the pattern is almost always arguing instead of listening — the coach will be listening for the word "but." On Boss 9 reps the coach also scores the Reinforcement Rule (the Short Stop never contradicts the advisor) and scores the close on the customer-for-life lens: did the customer leave programmed with "if I have a problem with my car, it goes to this shop"?

KPIs

1st-Objection Close % ≥ 60% % of presentations where authorization happens after the first objection counter. The single most coachable KPI.	Missed-Sale Recovered % ≥ 25% % of declined safety items reopened and authorized within 7 days.
Boss Coverage 9/9 Each advisor has defeated all 9 bosses in live calls.	

Execute — The Close

Mission: Deliver commitment. Make the "yes" the path of least resistance.

This step removes: **the decision moment itself.**

OBJECTIVE	CORE MOVE	PRIMARY KPI	FAILURE MODE
AUTHORIZED WORK	ASSUMPTIVE CLOSE	AUTHORIZATION RATE	ASKING PERMISSION

The Closing Principle — Closing Starts at Hello

The biggest myth in service writing is that "the close" happens at the end. It doesn't. The close is the cumulative result of seven correctly executed prior steps. By the time you reach Step 8, the close is already either won or lost. Step 8 is about **not breaking it**. When authorization rate is low, the failure is almost always upstream — not in the close itself.

Customers don't follow conviction. Customers follow certainty.

Your job is to be the most certain person in the conversation.

The Momentum Funnel

Trust flows downward through the funnel. By the funnel mouth, the close is gravity.



Figure 8.1 · Trust flows down. By the funnel mouth, the close is gravity.

The Three Families of Close

FAMILY	HOW IT WORKS	THE WORDS
1 · Assumptive	Skip the decision. Move to logistics. The customer would have to stop motion to say no — far harder than just saying yes.	"I'll go ahead and get the parts ordered." · "While your car is here, we'll..." · "The parts will take a few hours to get here so long as I can hang up and place the order now!"
2 · Choice (Binary)	Collapse infinity to two options. The binary close is East-West applied to any decision.	"Would you prefer option A or option B?" · "Should we pick it up at 9:15 or 10:45?" · "Pickup tonight, or first thing tomorrow?"
3 · Logistical	The brain has to engage with parking, not price. By the time it's engaged, the price is silently accepted.	"Which direction would you like your vehicle facing when we bring it up?"

CLEAN SCRIPT · ASSUMPTIVE CLOSE LINES

Advisor: "I'll go ahead and move forward with that!"

Advisor: "The parts will take a few hours to get here so long as I can hang up and place the order now!"

Advisor: "Would you prefer option A or option B?"

Advisor: "Anything else you'd like to add before we move forward?"

Advisor: "We really need to fix this problem. Do you need any more information from me?"

SCRIPT · ASSUMPTIVE CLOSE LINES — LAND THESE WITHOUT HESITATION

"I'll go ahead and move forward with that!"

"The parts will take a few hours to get here so long as I can hang up and place the order now!"

"Would you prefer option A or option B?"

"Anything else you'd like to add before we move forward?"

"We really need to fix this problem, do you need any more information from me?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY "WHICH DIRECTION FACING?" IS THE MOST QUIETLY POWERFUL CLOSE IN THE BOOK

The brain processes "which direction?" as a logistics problem. Logistics problems are answered on autopilot — the way the brain answers "cream and sugar?" By engaging with logistics, the customer's subconscious has just confirmed the transaction is complete. There is no longer anything to negotiate. The price has been silently accepted.

Home Plate — The Final Invoice Review

Home Plate is not the end of the sale — it's the start of the next one. Done well, it's where the customer becomes a repeat customer for life. Confirm the work, reinforce the value, set the next appointment, close the loop. This is where retention is built.

CLEAN SCRIPT · HOME PLATE + BOOKING THE NEXT VISIT

Advisor: "[Mr./Mrs. Customer], thank you again for trusting us with your vehicle today. Here's what we completed: [services]. Everything is digitally documented in your invoice. Your total investment today is \$ [XXX]. Which direction would you like your vehicle facing when we bring it up?"

Customer: "Facing out would be great."

Advisor: "You got it. Before you head out, a few benefits included with today's service: our 3-year, 36,000-mile nationwide warranty, 365-day roadside assistance, a post-repair inspection, and maintenance reminders. Looking at your maintenance schedule, your next service will be due around [date or mileage]. Let's get that on the books now so it's one less thing to think about. Does a morning or an afternoon usually work better for you?"

Customer: "Mornings, usually."

Advisor: "Perfect, I have a 9:15 on [date]. I'll put you down and send you a reminder as it gets closer. We appreciate your business, [Customer Name], and we'll be here whenever you need us!"

SCRIPT · HOME PLATE · FINAL INVOICE REVIEW

"[Mr./Mrs. Customer], thank you again for trusting us with your vehicle today. Here's what we completed: [services, e.g., replaced brake pads and rotors, repaired the axle, updated your maintenance services]. Everything is digitally documented in your invoice. Your total investment today is \$____. **Which direction would you like your vehicle facing when we bring it up?**

Before you head out, a few benefits included with today's service: 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty · 365-day roadside assistance · post-repair inspection · maintenance reminders · lifetime protection enrollment if applicable. We just want vehicle ownership to feel easy and predictable. We appreciate your business and we'll be here whenever you need us."

PRO TIP · THE THREE-WAY BYPASS BELONGS HERE TOO

When the close stalls on "I need to talk to my spouse," don't wait for the parking-lot retelling — offer to call the spouse with the customer on the line, so the conversation happens in a context where uncertainty can still be reduced. (Full script: Boss 4, Chapter 7.)

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 8 — CLOSE MASTERY

- ☐ Used at least one assumptive close line in every workflow.
- ☐ Investment stated as a single number; warranty followed immediately, no pause.
- ☐ Closed Home Plate with "which direction facing?"
- ☐ Re-enrolled the customer in lifetime protection or a maintenance plan where applicable.
- ☐ Asked for the next visit / review before the customer left the lobby.

COACH'S CORNER · WHEN AUTHORIZATION RATE IS RED, LOOK UPSTREAM FIRST

If PRS Completeness and 1st-Objection Close are green, the coach drills M6 (no-pause Investment-Coverage). If those are also green, then — and only then — the close itself gets work. The close is rarely the problem; the coach's rule is "never coach a downstream symptom when an upstream metric is also red."

KPIs

Authorization Rate

≥ 75%

Authorized \$ ÷ presented \$ across all bases.

ARO (Avg Repair Order)

Shop benchmark

Track per-advisor. Variance flags a coaching opportunity. Tied to PRS completeness and base order.

5-Star Review %

≥ 80%

Customers asked at Home Plate for a review — conversion to 5-star. Cumulative across all modules.

L.A.S.T. — Turn Complaints Into Loyalty

Mission: An upset customer is a gift. Recover well and they become more loyal than a customer who never had a problem at all.

This module handles: **any complaint, comeback, or recovered-customer interaction.**

OBJECTIVE RECOVER & RETAIN	FRAMEWORK L.A.S.T.	PRIMARY KPI RETAINED %	FAILURE MODE DEFENDING FIRST
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Mission Brief

Every shop will have failures. A part won't arrive on time. A noise will come back. A bill will land higher than the estimate. A tech will leave a smudge on the seat. **Failure is a constant. What is variable is the recovery.** The L.A.S.T. method — Listen, Acknowledge, Solve, Thank — is the four-beat combo that turns a hot counter into a retained customer, at the exact moment the customer is most ready to either leave or deepen the relationship.

A customer who complains and is heard becomes more loyal than one who never had a problem at all. The complaint is the opening. The recovery is the bond.

The Psychology — Why Recovery Outperforms Smooth Service

The human brain has a negativity bias: bad experiences imprint roughly 2–4× stronger than good ones. That sounds like terrible news for a shop with a complaint — but it's the unlock. Because the imprint is so strong, when you reverse the experience with a great recovery, **the recovery itself imprints with the same intensity.** The customer no longer remembers the failure as a standalone event — they remember the recovery as the defining moment. This is the documented **Service Recovery Paradox**: customers whose problems are well-handled report higher loyalty and referral rates than customers who never had a problem at all.

MECHANISM	HOW IT WORKS
Validation Need	An upset customer's primary need is not the fix — it's the feeling of being heard. Jump to the fix and you skip the only step that actually resolves the emotion.
Effort Asymmetry	The customer expects the bare minimum. When you do meaningfully more — or even visibly try — the gap registers as care, and care is what loyalty is made of.
Story Conversion	Every customer will tell a story about this interaction. L.A.S.T. gives them a hero arc ("there was a problem, but they fixed it like champs") instead of a tragedy ("don't go there"). The story is your future business.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY THIS ISN'T AN EXCUSE TO CAUSE PROBLEMS

The Recovery Paradox is not permission to fail on purpose. The lift is real, but it only applies to well-handled recoveries — and only sometimes outperforms baseline. The takeaway is not "create complaints." It's "treat every complaint as the highest-leverage moment of the relationship" — because that is exactly what it is.

The Four Beats — In Order, Every Time

L.A.S.T. is a sequence, not a menu. Reorder it and it stops working. Skip a beat and the customer feels unheard. The most common failure is racing to S (Solve) without doing L and A — that's the move that makes customers escalate to Yelp.

BEAT	WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY DOING	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE	MOST COMMON MISTAKE
L — Listen silence is medicine	Letting cortisol drain. The customer can't hear a solution while their alarm brain is firing. They talk until they stop — most complaints lose 60% of their charge when the customer finishes uninterrupted.	"Okay." "I understand." "Go ahead, I'm listening."	Interrupting to defend or explain. This single move makes everything worse.
A — Acknowledge emotion first, no "but"	Mirroring the emotion before the facts. You don't have to agree the shop was wrong — you have to validate that the feeling makes sense.	"I can understand why that would be frustrating." "Thank you for bringing this to me." Use "and," never "but": "I hear that you're frustrated, AND here's what I'm going to do."	Conditional acknowledgment: "I understand, BUT..." The word "but" deletes everything before it.
S — Solve specific & time-bound	Owning a specific next step. Time-bound. Concrete. Yours — "I will," even if a tech does the work.	"Here's what I can do for you..." "I will call you personally by 3pm with the answer."	Vague promises: "we'll look into it." A non-answer that ages into a Yelp review.
T — Thank complaint = gift	Reframing the complaint as a gift. This is the move that imprints the recovery as the defining memory and creates the Recovery Paradox.	"Thank you for giving us the chance to make this right." "We'd much rather hear this from you than read about it later."	Skipping it because the conversation feels done. The Thank is what locks loyalty in.

The 24-Hour Recovery Window

The Recovery Paradox has a hard expiration date. The longer a complaint sits, the more the customer rehearses it — to their spouse, their friends, themselves. Every rehearsal cements "they did me wrong."

RECOVERY ZONE · < 1 HOUR	FADING ZONE · 1–24 HOURS	REVIEW ZONE · > 24 HOURS
Paradox engaged — the customer often becomes MORE loyal.	Damage spreading — the customer is rehearsing the story.	Public post likely — recovery now only stops the bleeding.

Any unresolved complaint must have a status update to the customer within 24 hours, even if the resolution isn't ready. Silence past 24 hours doubles the loyalty damage. The first hour is worth ten of the next day.

The 5 Recovery-Killers

#	KILLER	BEAT IT BREAKS	WHAT TO DO INSTEAD
1	Defending the shop / explaining what happened.	L — Listen	Silence. Let them finish. Acknowledge before you explain — or don't explain at all.
2	"I understand, BUT..."	A — Acknowledge	"I understand." Full stop. Pause. Then "Here's what I can do."
3	Vague fix: "we'll look into it."	S — Solve	Specific, time-bound, owned: "I'll personally call you back by 3pm with the resolution."
4	Discounting on instinct to make it go away.	S — Solve (collapsed)	Solve the actual problem first. A discount that doesn't resolve the complaint costs you twice.
5	Skipping the Thank because "they're still upset."	T — Thank	The Thank is exactly what shifts them from upset to invested. Always close the loop.

Scripts — The Four Most Common Hot Counters

Clean versions first: pure dialogue, straight through. The taught versions with the L.A.S.T. beats labeled follow.

HOT COUNTER 1 · NO CALLBACK FOR TWO DAYS

Customer: "My car's been here for two days and no one called me!"

Advisor: "Okay, walk me through it. When did you drop it off, and what were you expecting to hear?"

[Listen. No interrupting.]

Advisor: "I completely understand. Not hearing back when you're waiting on your car is one of the most frustrating things, and that's on us to do better. Here's what I'm going to do. I'm pulling your RO right now. I'll get you the current status, a real ETA, and I'll call you back personally within 30 minutes whether the news is good or not. Thank you for letting me know. We'd much rather hear this from you than read about it later."

HOT COUNTER 2 · THE BILL IS HIGHER THAN THE QUOTE

Customer: "The bill is way more than what you quoted!"

Advisor: "Tell me what number you were expecting and what number you're seeing." *[Listen fully.]*

Advisor: "That's a fair concern. If you were planning on one number and the bill comes in higher, that breaks trust, and I get why you're frustrated. Let me pull the estimate and the final invoice side by side. I'll walk you line by line through what changed, and if any of that wasn't properly authorized, I'll make it right today. I appreciate you raising this instead of just walking away unhappy. Let's figure it out."

HOT COUNTER 3 · THE NOISE CAME BACK

Customer: "I just paid for this last month and the same noise is back!"

Advisor: "Tell me about the noise. When does it happen, is it exactly the same, did it ever fully go away?"

[Listen fully.]

Advisor: "That's exactly the kind of thing that should not be happening, and I understand why it feels like we let you down. Here's what we're going to do. We carry a 3-year, 36,000-mile warranty on parts and labor, so this is covered. I'm getting you on the schedule today or tomorrow, no charge, and we'll diagnose it personally. Can you bring it in this afternoon, or in the morning? And thank you for bringing it back to us instead of going somewhere else. We're going to make this right."

HOT COUNTER 4 · GREASE ON THE SEAT

Customer: "Your tech left grease on my seat."

Advisor: "Can you show me?" *[Walk to the car. Look. Do not minimize.]*

Advisor: "You're right, that's not what should happen. That's on us. Here's what we're going to do. We use seat covers on every job and that wasn't followed today. I'm going to get this professionally detailed at our cost and have your car back to you cleaner than when it came in. I'll arrange a loaner or an Uber so you're not without a ride. When works best? And thank you for telling me directly. This is how we get better, one customer at a time."

SCRIPT · HOT COUNTER 1 · "MY CAR'S BEEN HERE FOR TWO DAYS AND NO ONE CALLED ME."

L: "Okay, walk me through it, when did you drop it off and what were you expecting to hear?" *[Listen. No interrupting.]*

A: "I completely understand, not hearing back when you're waiting on your car is one of the most frustrating things, and that's on us to do better."

S: "Here's what I'm going to do. I'm pulling your RO right now. I'll get you the current status, a real ETA, and I'll call you back personally within 30 minutes whether the news is good or not."

T: "Thank you for letting me know. We'd much rather hear this from you than read about it later."

SCRIPT · HOT COUNTER 2 · "THE BILL IS WAY MORE THAN WHAT YOU QUOTED."

L: "Tell me what number you were expecting and what number you're seeing."

A: "That's a fair concern, if you were planning on one number and the bill comes in higher, that breaks trust, and I get why you're frustrated."

S: "Let me pull the estimate and the final invoice side by side. I'll walk you line by line through what changed, and if any of that wasn't properly authorized, I'll make it right today."

T: "I appreciate you raising this instead of just walking away unhappy. Let's figure it out."

SCRIPT · HOT COUNTER 3 · "I JUST PAID FOR THIS LAST MONTH AND THE SAME NOISE IS BACK!"

L: "Tell me about the noise, when does it happen, is it exactly the same, did it ever fully go away?"

A: "That's exactly the kind of thing that should not be happening, and I understand why it feels like we let you down."

S: "Here's what we're going to do. We carry a 3-year / 36,000-mile warranty on parts and labor, this is covered. I'm getting you on the schedule today or tomorrow, no charge, and we'll diagnose it personally. Can you bring it in this afternoon, or in the morning?"

T: "Thank you for bringing it back to us instead of going somewhere else. We're going to make this right."

SCRIPT · HOT COUNTER 4 · "YOUR TECH LEFT GREASE ON MY SEAT."

L: "Can you show me?" *[Walk to the car. Look. Do not minimize.]*

A: "You're right, that's not what should happen. That's on us."

S: "Here's what we're going to do. We use seat covers on every job and that wasn't followed today. I'm going to get this professionally detailed at our cost and have your car back to you cleaner than when it came in. I'll arrange a loaner or an Uber so you're not without a ride. When works best?"

T: "Thank you for telling me directly. This is how we get better, one customer at a time."

STOP · THE BANNED WORD IS "POLICY"

Never use the word "policy" during a recovery. It tells the customer "you don't matter, the rule does." If the policy must come up, name what it's for instead: "the way we handle this is..." or "our standard for situations like this is..." The shift is small. The trust difference is enormous.

STOP · NEVER OFFER A DISCOUNT AS THE FIRST MOVE

Discounting before listening teaches the customer that complaining is how they get cheaper service, and signals you're trying to make the problem go away rather than fix it. Solve the actual issue first. If goodwill comp is appropriate, it comes after the solve — as a gesture, not a payoff.

Drills — Build the Reflex

DRILL 9.A · SILENCE TOLERANCE (60-SECOND REPS)

Setup: partner plays an upset customer venting for 60 full seconds. Your only allowed words: "okay," "I understand," "go ahead." No interrupting.

Score: did you make the full 60 seconds without defending, explaining, or jumping to solve?

Goal: 5 consecutive clean reps. The single hardest recovery skill to acquire.

DRILL 9.B · THE BUT BUSTER

Setup: trainer reads a complaint. You acknowledge in 1–2 sentences without using "but," "however," or "although."

Score: clean acknowledgment? Emotion validated before any explanation?

Goal: 8/10 reps clean, then promote to the live floor.

DRILL 9.C · SPECIFICITY DRILL

Setup: trainer states a complaint. You respond with a solve that has three components: who owns it, what exact next step, by when.

Score: all three present? Time-bound? Owned by you, not "someone will"?

Goal: 10 consecutive reps with all three.

DRILL 9.D · THE FULL COMBO (HOT-COUNTER ROLEPLAY)

Setup: full live scenario, partner or AI in hot-customer mode — escalating, emotional, difficult. Run the complete L → A → S → T sequence.

Score (1–5 each beat): Listen quality + Acknowledge clarity + Solve specificity + Thank delivery. 16+/20 = mastery.

Goal: 3 consecutive scenarios scoring 16+. This is what coaches a Level-4 advisor into Level 5.

MASTERY CHECK · LEVEL 9 — RECOVERY MASTERY (GATE TO CHAMPION)

- ☐ Listened for at least 30 seconds without interrupting, defending, or explaining.
- ☐ Acknowledged the customer's emotion before stating any facts.
- ☐ Did not use the words "but," "however," or "policy."
- ☐ Offered a specific, time-bound, owned next step.
- ☐ Did not discount or comp before solving the actual problem.
- ☐ Ended with a sincere Thank that reframed the complaint as a gift.
- ☐ Customer left committed to a next step (return visit, callback, or resolution).

Pass all 7 across three live recoveries with documented retention → Level 5 (Champion) certified.

COACH'S CORNER · EVERY RECOVERY GETS AUDITED WITHIN 48 HOURS

Any time you handle a complaint, the coach has 48 hours to walk through the interaction with you — not punitive, coaching, using the Mastery Check as the scorecard. The coach (or manager) personally calls the recovered customer 5–7 days later to confirm satisfaction and ask for a review — well-recovered customers leave the best reviews you'll ever get. And the coach praises the Listen, not the Solve: the Listen is the skill 95% of advisors get wrong. **Red flag:** three or more complaints in 30 days tracing to the same root is a behavior pattern, not bad luck.

KPIs — The Recovery Scoreboard

Recovery Rate

≥ 90%

% of complaints where the customer returns for a future visit.
The most important loyalty KPI.

Time-to-Acknowledge

≤ 1 hr

From complaint received to first human response — inside the Recovery Zone.

Post-Recovery 5-Star

≥ 60%

% of recovered customers who leave a 5-star review after the follow-up ask. Counter-intuitively high.

Leave-Behind · Recovery After-Action Worksheet

RECOVERY AFTER-ACTION REPORT — FILE WITH THE RO

- ☐ Advisor: _____ · Customer / RO #: _____ · Date/time of complaint: _____
- ☐ Channel (counter / phone / text / review): _____
- ☐ Complaint in the customer's words: _____
- ☐ Root cause (not blame — cause): _____
- ☐ L score (1–5): ____ · A score: ____ · S score: ____ · T score: ____
- ☐ Specific solve delivered: _____
- ☐ Goodwill comp (if any) and reason: _____
- ☐ Customer state at end (recovered / cool / lost): _____
- ☐ Follow-up call scheduled for: _____
- ☐ Process change to prevent recurrence: _____

The Worked-Example Library

Mission: A memorized PRS template for the eight most common repair categories. Drill these and the structure becomes instinct.

How to Use This Library

Each example is built on the same 10-step ISO template anatomized in Chapter 6 (the water-pump example). The structure never changes — what changes is the technical content: the Problem, the Risk, the Solution, the Investment, and the warranty language, tuned to each category. Use it three ways: **(1) Drill material** — one example per morning standup in rollout Phase 2. **(2) Calibration reference** — when your coach scores a PRS, they compare against the matching example here. **(3) New-hire training** — deliver each one from memory before being released to live presentations.

PRO TIP · THE PATTERN STAYS CONSTANT

Every example follows the same 10 beats: Warm Open · Co-Review · Media Confirm · Concern · Good News · More Good News · Risk → Solution · Investment · Coverage · Tee-Up. Once the pattern is automatic, you only think about the repair — the structure carries itself.

1 · Brakes — Front Pads & Rotors (Safety)

Scenario: customer came in for a brake squeal. DVI confirms front pads at 2mm with rotor scoring.

BASE-1 ISO · FRONT BRAKES

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Thanks for your patience, is now a good time to go over your vehicle?"
2. "I personally walked the vehicle with our certified tech so I could give you a clear picture of what's going on with the braking system."
3. "Were you able to view the photos and the brake-measurement video on the digital inspection report I sent?"
4. "You brought the vehicle in because of the squealing when braking. We've fully inspected the system."
5. "The good news is the rear brakes still have plenty of life left, and the brake fluid tested clean."
6. "More good news, we caught the front brakes right at the safety threshold and not past it, which means we can replace the components without damage to the caliper or hydraulic system."
7. "If left as-is, the front pads are at 2 millimeters, that means metal-on-metal is the next stop, which destroys the rotors and can compromise stopping distance. The proper repair is to replace the front pads and rotors, perform a full brake system service including hardware and fluid bleed, and road-test under load to confirm."
8. "The total investment for today's work, parts and labor included, is \$[XXX]."
9. "This work is fully covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on both parts and labor."
10. "While your vehicle is here, we'll finish the full bumper-to-bumper inspection and I'll reach out if anything else needs attention. Is this still the best number to reach you?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY "METAL-ON-METAL" LANDS HARDER THAN "WORN OUT"

"Worn out" is abstract. "Metal-on-metal" is a vivid mental image the customer can hear in their head. Concrete sensory language activates the same brain regions as the actual event — which is why specific physical descriptions move customers to authorize faster than generic ones.

2 · Suspension — CV Axle Boot Leak (2nd-Base Discovery)

Scenario: customer came in for an oil change. DVI finds the CV axle boot torn with grease slung on inner suspension.

BASE - 2 ADDITIONAL CONCERN · CV AXLE

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. I have an update on the inspection, is now a good time?"
2. "I just finished walking the vehicle with our tech so I could explain exactly what we found."
3. "Did you have a chance to see the photos of the axle area on the report?"
4. "You came in for the oil change, that's done. During the inspection we identified an additional finding I want to walk you through."
5. "Good news is your suspension and steering components are otherwise in solid shape, ball joints, tie rods, and bushings all check out."
6. "More good news, we caught the axle boot leak before the joint itself failed. That's a meaningful difference in cost and complexity."
7. "If left as-is, the torn boot lets the lubricating grease escape and lets dirt and water in. Inside of a few thousand miles that will destroy the CV joint, which can fail under acceleration and leave you stranded. The proper repair is to replace the CV axle assembly, inspect the inner CV joint and surrounding components, and verify alignment."
8. "The total updated investment, including the oil change you already authorized, is \$[XXX]."
9. "Everything is covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty, parts and labor."
10. "With the axle work in progress I'll have the tech finish the remaining inspection items and loop back if anything else surfaces. Still the best number?"

PRO TIP · FOR 2ND-BASE FINDINGS, NAME WHAT'S ALREADY HEALTHY FIRST

Beat 5 on a 2nd-base call should always name healthy adjacent components. This prevents the customer from assuming "if this is bad, everything is bad." You're drawing a clean perimeter around the actual finding.

3 · Cooling — Thermostat Stuck Open

Scenario: customer reports the heater not getting hot. DVI confirms a stuck-open thermostat. (The water pump in Chapter 6 is the canonical cooling reference; this is a second pattern for the same system.)

BASE - 1 ISO · THERMOSTAT

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Is now a good time to walk through what we found?"
2. "I personally reviewed the cooling system with our tech so I could give you a complete picture."
3. "Did the report with the thermal-reading photos come through okay?"
4. "You brought it in because the heater isn't getting hot, that's the symptom. We've identified the cause."
5. "Good news is the water pump, radiator, and hoses all checked out clean, no leaks, no contamination."
6. "More good news, the cause is a single component, not a system-wide problem. That keeps the repair targeted."
7. "The thermostat is stuck in the open position, which means the engine never reaches proper operating temperature. Beyond no heat in the cabin, this causes excess fuel consumption, increased emissions, and accelerated engine wear over time. The proper repair is to replace the thermostat and gasket and complete a partial coolant service to refresh the system."
8. "The total investment for today is \$[XXX]."
9. "Covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on parts and labor."
10. "While we have the vehicle we'll wrap up the bumper-to-bumper inspection and I'll reach out with anything else. Still the best number?"

4 · Transmission — Fluid Service (3rd-Base Preventative)

Scenario: 75k miles, fluid never serviced. Maintenance recommendation on 3rd base after primary work is authorized.

3RD-BASE SOFT SELL · TRANSMISSION SERVICE

1. "Hi [Customer], one quick maintenance item I want to mention before we wrap, is now a good time?"
2. "I reviewed your service history with the tech, this isn't a problem today, this is a protect-your-investment item."
3. "You should see this in the maintenance section of the DVI, the transmission service status is highlighted yellow."
4. "Your vehicle has 75,000 miles and the transmission fluid hasn't been serviced since new. The manufacturer interval is 60k."
5. "Good news is the transmission is operating smoothly with no codes and no slippage, everything works."
6. "More good news, servicing the fluid now keeps your lifetime protection plan intact and prevents the most expensive repair on the vehicle."
7. "Old fluid loses its protective additives and starts depositing varnish on internal components. Left long enough, that leads to shifting issues and eventually transmission replacement, a multi-thousand-dollar repair. The service is a full fluid exchange with manufacturer-spec fluid and a filter replacement where serviceable."
8. "Adding this to today's work moves your total from \$[XXX] to \$[XXX]."
9. "The service is covered by warranty and keeps your lifetime protection plan active on the transmission."
10. "If today doesn't work for you, we can absolutely schedule it for next visit, I just want to make sure you know it's on the horizon. What would you like to do?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY 3RD BASE ENDS WITH A REAL OPT-OUT

Beat 10 on a 3rd-base call explicitly offers to defer. This isn't weakness — it's positioning. Maintenance items are not safety items, and pressuring a maintenance sale erodes the trust built on 1st base. Giving the customer the deferral option **increases** the same-day authorization rate because it removes the salesperson energy.

5 · Electrical — Battery + Alternator (Bundled Finding)

Scenario: customer reports slow crank. DVI: battery at 60% capacity, alternator output borderline at idle.

BASE-1 ISO · CHARGING SYSTEM

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Is now a good time to go over the diagnostic results?"
2. "I just reviewed the charging-system test results with our tech to make sure I can walk you through them accurately."
3. "Did you receive the digital report with the battery load-test and alternator-output numbers?"
4. "You came in because of the slow cranking. We've tested the full charging system and identified the cause."
5. "Good news is the starter motor itself is testing strong, that's a major component in good shape."
6. "More good news, we caught this before the vehicle stranded you. A no-start in a parking lot is a much worse day than this conversation."
7. "The battery is testing at 60% of its rated capacity, past serviceable life. And the alternator is producing output below the manufacturer threshold at idle, which is why the battery isn't being properly recharged on short drives. Left as-is, this is a no-start event waiting for the right cold morning. The proper repair is to replace the battery with a manufacturer-spec unit and replace the alternator, then re-test the full charging system under load."
8. "The total investment for today's work is \$[XXX], parts and labor."
9. "The battery comes with a manufacturer pro-rated warranty, and the alternator and labor are covered under our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty."
10. "We'll wrap the rest of the bumper-to-bumper while we're in there and loop back with anything else. Still the best number?"

6 · Tires — Replacement Set (Weather-Sensitive Framing)

Scenario: all four tires at 3/32. Customer in a wet-winter region.

BASE-1 ISO · TIRES

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Is now a good time to go over what we found?"
2. "I personally measured the tires with our tech and pulled the load-rating and date-code data so I could give you a complete picture."
3. "Were you able to see the tire-tread photos on the inspection report?"
4. "You came in for a check on the tires, we've fully inspected them."
5. "Good news is the wear pattern is even, which means your alignment is in good shape and we don't have a separate suspension issue contributing."
6. "More good news, we have manufacturer-quality tire options that fit your vehicle in a price range that protects both safety and budget."
7. "All four tires are at 3/32-inch tread depth. The legal minimum is 2/32, but real-world stopping distance on wet pavement degrades significantly below 4/32. With the rainy season ahead, the risk is meaningfully longer stopping distance in exactly the conditions that need it most. The proper recommendation is a matched set of four new tires with a road-force balance, mount, and a 4-wheel alignment."
8. "The total investment for the recommended tire package, installation, and alignment is \$[XXX]."
9. "Tires carry the manufacturer's road-hazard and tread warranty, plus our 3-year / 36,000-mile labor coverage."
10. "Once you give the green light we'll have the tires here within a few hours so we can finish today. Still the best number?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER · WHY WE TIE TIRES TO WEATHER INSTEAD OF LEGALITY

"Legal minimum" is permission language — it tells the customer they can wait. "Wet-pavement stopping distance" is risk language. Always frame tires against the customer's actual driving conditions, not the legal floor.

7 · Alignment — Pull / Premature Wear (Inspection-Triggered)

Scenario: vehicle pulls right. DVI confirms left-front toe out of spec, inside-edge tire wear visible.

BASE-1 ISO · ALIGNMENT

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Is now a good time to walk through the inspection?"
2. "I reviewed the alignment readings and the tire-wear evidence with our tech so I could give you the full story."
3. "Were you able to see the alignment-spec sheet and the tire-wear photos on the report?"
4. "You brought the vehicle in for the pulling-right concern. We've identified the cause."
5. "Good news is the steering and suspension components themselves are mechanically sound, this isn't a worn-part problem."
6. "More good news, we caught this early enough that the tires still have usable life. Another few thousand miles and you'd be buying tires too."
7. "The left-front toe is out of specification, that's what's causing the pull, and it's what's scrubbing the inside edge of the tire. Left as-is, you'll need a full set of tires inside of 5,000 miles, plus the steering input it takes to keep the car straight increases driver fatigue and impacts emergency handling. The proper repair is a four-wheel alignment to manufacturer spec with a printed before-and-after report."
8. "The total investment for today's alignment service is \$[XXX]."
9. "Alignment work is covered by our service warranty and includes a free re-check inside 30 days if anything feels off."
10. "While the vehicle's on the rack we'll finish the remaining inspection items and let you know if anything else surfaces. Still the best number?"

8 · A/C — Low Refrigerant + Leak Test (Heat-Sensitive Framing)

Scenario: A/C blows warm. Diagnostic: low charge with UV-dye-confirmed leak at the condenser.

BASE-1 ISO · A/C SYSTEM

1. "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Is now a good time to go through the A/C diagnosis?"
2. "I reviewed the leak-test results with our tech, we ran UV dye through the system and pulled a vacuum to confirm."
3. "Did you receive the photos showing the leak source on the digital report?"
4. "You brought it in because the A/C is blowing warm, we've identified exactly why."
5. "Good news is the compressor and the evaporator both test as functional, those are the most expensive components, and they're fine."
6. "More good news, we pinpointed the leak source on the first test, which means we know exactly what to repair instead of replacing components on guesswork."
7. "The refrigerant charge is critically low because the condenser has a confirmed leak. If we just recharge it without fixing the leak, you'll be back inside a few weeks with the same problem, and refrigerant venting to atmosphere is both an environmental and a legal concern. The proper repair is to replace the condenser, replace the receiver-drier, evacuate the system, and recharge to manufacturer specification with a verified leak test."
8. "The total investment is \$[XXX], parts and labor included."
9. "Fully covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty on parts and labor."
10. "Once you authorize we'll order the parts and finish the full inspection while we wait. Still the best number?"

PRO TIP · REFUSE THE "JUST RECHARGE IT" ASK

Customers often ask for "just a refill" when the diagnosis is a leak. Politely refuse — a recharge without leak repair is a 3-week fix, and the customer comes back angry. Reframe: "I'd be doing you a disservice by recharging a system that we've already confirmed has a leak. Let me fix it once, right."

The Cross-Library Anatomy — Why Every Example Hits the Same Beats

BEAT	CONSTANT ACROSS ALL EXAMPLES	WHAT CHANGES PER REPAIR
1 Warm Open	Permission framing, name use.	Time of day / context.
2 Co-Review	"I personally reviewed with the tech."	Which system / component reviewed.
3 Media Confirm	Locks in DVI evidence.	Which photos / readings to point to.
4 Concern	Honors the original reason for the visit.	The specific symptom language.
5 Good News	Names healthy adjacent components.	Which adjacent components to name.
6 More Good News	Reframes the finding as a save / early catch.	The specific "could have been worse" angle.
7 Risk → Solution	Risk explicit, solution proper, no shortcuts.	The technical content of the repair.
8 Investment	Single number, parts & labor.	The actual dollar amount.
9 Coverage	Warranty named without pause.	Any category-specific warranty (tires, battery).
10 Tee-Up	Confirms contact, sets up the next base.	The specific tee-up language.

COACH'S CORNER · ONE EXAMPLE PER MORNING STANDUP

Rotate through all 8 (plus the water pump = 9) over a two-week cycle. You deliver the chosen example from memory; the coach scores against the 10-beat anatomy. By the end of rollout Phase 2, every advisor can deliver every category cold. By Phase 3, the structure is so internalized that brand-new repair categories slot in automatically.

MASTERY CHECK · LIBRARY MASTERY — THE PRO GATE

You are Library-certified when you can deliver any 3 randomly selected examples from this library, back to back, from memory, with all 10 beats present and the Risk step explicit on every one. Coach signs off. This is one of the gates between Closer (Level 3) and Pro (Level 4).

The Glossary — Every Named Technique in One Place

30+ named techniques, principles, and anti-patterns — one-line definitions with pointers to where each is covered.

Group A · Booking & First Contact

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
"When Is Now a Good Time" Quick Close	The opening of every inbound call, in two versions: direct ask — answer ("Absolutely") and close in the same breath; vague or quote ask — concern question, urgency line, then close.	Ch 1 + Ch 1.5
Concern Discovery Before the Close	On a vague or quote call, ask "What kind of concern are you having with your [system]?" before closing. The concern feeds the urgency; the urgency feeds the close. Trained checkpoint on every rep.	Ch 1 + Ch 1.5
The "And I" Accountability Frame	"At no charge to you, my certified technician AND I will inspect..." — a personal promise: the advisor ensures the tech understands the concern, inspects with the tech, personally builds the written estimate, and educates the customer on the workflow. The first step of rapport.	Ch 1 + Ch 1.5
The "Oh, No No" Beat	Acknowledge-first counter to "I want to know how much it costs first": meet the price barrier with warmth and surprise ("Oh, no no."), then the no-charge line, then the close. The no-charge line stands with no justification — never "not just X" (banned in all dialogue, universally), never a why-tail.	Ch 3
Root Concern Rule	Even when the customer names a service and says yes, find the TRUE root concern before writing the job. We don't inherit somebody else's problems, and we don't fix a self-diagnosis. Discovery runs on questions only; the reasoning never reaches the customer's ear on the phone.	Ch 3
Say Yes, Get Them In — No Pre-Education	The inbound call has one job: say yes and get the vehicle in the door. Questions, urgency, and value framing are allowed on the phone; warnings, caveats, and education about whether the requested fix will work are banned until the inspection produces evidence.	Ch 1.5 + Ch 3
Process vs. Objectives	The sales process (secure the appointment, get the car in) leads; the sales objectives (rapport, credibility, education) are pursued through and after the close, never blocking it.	Ch 0 + Ch 1.5
East-West Scheduling	Two specific time options, one earlier and one later ("I've got 11:15 or 2:15 open today. Which works best for you?"). Collapses scheduling infinity to a binary choice; when the concern is known, the urgency line leads into the options.	Ch 1 + Ch 3
The Relief Line	"You've called the right place" — delivers nervous-system relief inside the quick close, between the answer and the closing ask.	Ch 1
90-Second Friendship Window	The window in which the first impression locks. Highest-leverage 90 seconds of the sale.	Ch 1
Concern vs. Symptom	Customers describe symptoms; professionals diagnose concerns. The most important translation in service.	Ch 3
Custody	The vehicle in our bay. Every other objective is gated by this.	Ch 3

Group B · Trust & Credibility

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
Invisible Scorecard	Three traits every customer silently grades on: Competence, Transparency, Trustworthiness.	Ch 0
Trust Triangle	Visual model of the Invisible Scorecard. All three legs required.	Ch 0 + Ch 2
Three Channels of Rapport	Tone, Words, Body. Break one and the signal mixes.	Ch 1
Three Hidden Sales in the Tour	Inspection authorization, price defense, repeat visit — all completed by the end of the shop tour.	Ch 2
Anti-Lowest-Price Brag	"We're not the cheapest, and that's intentional." Owning the position.	Ch 2 + Boss 2
Co-Review	"I personally reviewed your vehicle with the tech" — scores Competence and Trustworthy simultaneously.	Ch 6 + App A
Equal-Status Posture	The advisor is the servant of the customer and never the subordinate: serve completely, speak as an equal. Status is never lowered to elevate the customer's.	Ch 0.5
Earned Directness	The deeper why of Modules 1 and 2: customers like directness most of all, but you cannot be direct with someone until rapport and credibility are established. The first two modules are the license to shoot straight.	Ch 0.5 + Ch 1 + Ch 2
Tone Matching	Matching pace, pitch, and delivery to the moment so the customer hears what we need them to hear — slower and lower for discovery and objections (curious, never adamant), even and steady through investment + coverage. Recommended study: Jeremy Miner's NEPQ.	Ch 0.5
Counter Mode vs. Stage Mode	Customer present in the shop: quieter, calmer, more direct. Customer remote on the inspection video: theater — play to the back row with exaggerated expression, vocal energy, and tone to hold attention through a phone screen.	Ch 0.5 + Ch 4

Group C · Inspection & Strategy

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
DVI (Digital Vehicle Inspection)	The customer's X-ray. Photos + video + tech notes = evidence that destroys "not real" doubt.	Ch 4
Vehicle Health Dashboard	Green/Yellow/Red sort of every DVI finding against one spec question. Foundation of base selling.	Ch 4
Tech-Advisor Walk-the-Bay	Physical hand-off protocol within 15 minutes of DVI completion. Prevents guessing.	Ch 4
Diagnosis Funnel	Customer Words → Symptom → Inspection → Concern → Solution.	Ch 3
Media Confirmation	Locking in that the customer has viewed the DVI before delivering the finding.	Ch 6 + App A
Boom Board	The intake artifact of custody — concern in writing before the vehicle enters the bay.	Ch 3
The Keys Moment	"And you're dropping this off with me, right?" — asked while holding the keys up. The assumptive separation close that replaces the waiting-area offer at intake.	Ch 3
The Audible	When the customer plans to wait: serve the drink, inspect, surface the single most critical safety concern, and show-and-sell it at the vehicle. Separation achieved through evidence instead of transportation.	Ch 3
Waiting Window (DVI Timing Rule)	The DVI is presented only after the concern is addressed or the first approval is secured, wrapped in time the customer has already surrendered: "while we're knocking out the tires... I'll call you with any additional concerns that are found." Or carried subliminally by the shop introduction video.	Ch 4 + Ch 5

Group D · Presentation Frameworks

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
Good-Good-Bad	Two positives before the finding/cost. The brain receives the third statement in an open frame.	Ch 5 + Ch 6
PRS (Problem · Risk · Solution)	Mandatory 3-part structure for every finding. Risk is the urgency engine.	Ch 5 + Ch 6
Base Selling / The Diamond	1st (Isolate) → 2nd (Expand) → Short Stop (Save) → 3rd (Protect) → Home Plate (Reinforce).	Ch 5
10-Step ISO Presentation	Canonical 10-beat structure for any 1st-base safety call. Water pump = anchor example.	Ch 6 + App A
Re-Engagement Loop (60–90s)	A micro-question every 60–90 seconds keeps the customer's mind in the call.	Ch 6
Investment-then-Coverage Rule	Warranty must follow price in the same breath. NO pause between.	Ch 6

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
Boss Battles (9)	The nine objections that kill most sales, each with a documented tell and counter.	Ch 7
Boss Battle 9: The Second Opinion	The post-inspection "second opinion / shop around / get it cheaper" objection. Countered with the paid-twice anchor, the Honest Disarm ("we are able to do this cheaper, but it might also reduce the warranty"), the Short Stop live play (reinforce first, never contradict), and the Repair Plan. The prize is not this repair; it is a customer for life.	Boss 9
The Short Stop, Live	The Short Stop run live: a second trusted voice — ideally the technician who inspected the vehicle, realistically whoever the shop trusts to run the play — joins the same call or visit while the objection is on the table, reinforces the advisor's presentation exactly as delivered (never contradicts), then opens collaborative problem-solving against the DVI evidence. The second opinion walks in instead of the customer walking out.	Boss 9
The Reinforcement Rule	The Short Stop never contradicts what the advisor already told the customer — contradiction reads as the shop making things up and destroys the advisor's trustworthiness. Reinforce first ("the repair he presented is the proper repair"), problem-solve second.	Boss 9
The Repair Plan	"Can we create a repair plan where we take care of a portion of it today and move on?" The collaborative pivot of Boss 9: huddle with the technician on the hours first, then work the levers — flexible payment options, comped labor time, the comped accompanying oil service — to a middle ground that works for the customer AND the shop.	Boss 9
Customer-for-Life Close	The named close of Boss 9: thank the customer for working through it with us, promise the middle ground, and program the sentence "if I have a problem with my car, it goes to this shop." The goal of the battle is the customer, not the repair.	Boss 9
Minimum Viable Repair	The absolute minimum that needs to be replaced to solve today's problem. Naming the true floor proves the recommendation was never padded and turns one estimate into a good / better / best ladder with the warranty difference explicit at every rung.	Boss 9
Objection Translation Matrix	Surface objection → what the customer actually means → advisor objective → move.	Ch 7
Money Reframe	"No money" means "no money TODAY" → pivot to financing.	Boss 3
Three-Way Bypass	Counter to the spouse objection — get the spouse on the call so PRS is delivered first-hand.	Boss 4
Pro Obligation Frame	Counter to "always selling" — shift identity from salesperson to fiduciary.	Boss 6
Short Stop Re-Open	Fresh voice tagged in to save a missed safety sale. A new voice resets the social contract.	Ch 5 + Ch 7
Five Universal Rules		Ch 7

	Never argue / acknowledge first / find the real concern / pivot to value not discount / re-ask for the close.	
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Group F · Closing

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
Assumptive Close	Skip the decision, move to logistics. The customer must STOP motion to say no.	Ch 8
Choice (Binary) Close	"Option A or option B?" East-West applied to any decision.	Ch 8
Direction-Facing Close	"Which direction would you like the vehicle facing?" The brain switches to logistics → price silently accepted.	Ch 8
Momentum Funnel	Trust accumulates downward through Steps 1–7; by Step 8 the close is gravity.	Ch 8
Home Plate	Final invoice review. Reinforces value and sets up the next visit.	Ch 5 + Ch 8

Group G · Recovery

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
L.A.S.T.	Listen · Acknowledge · Solve · Thank. The four-beat recovery combo. The sequence is the system.	Ch 9
Service Recovery Paradox	A well-recovered customer ends up MORE loyal than one who never had a problem.	Ch 9
24-Hour Recovery Window	Recovery (<1hr) → Fading (1–24hr) → Review (>24hr). Time is the enemy.	Ch 9
Silence Tolerance	The hardest recovery skill: 60 seconds of customer venting without interrupting.	Drill 9.A
BUT Buster	Acknowledgment without "but," "however," or "although."	Drill 9.B

Group H · Coaching & Culture

TERM	ONE-LINE DEFINITION	WHERE
SBI Feedback	Situation · Behavior · Impact. The coaching sentence that always works.	Coach's Book
Five-Beat Coaching Conversation	Open with the win → name the gap (SBI) → ask don't tell → co-design practice → confirm commitment.	Coach's Book
Boss Rush	Daily 15-min team drill, random Boss objections, scored counters.	Ch 7
Ride-Along Scorecard	Weekly per-advisor 8-step scoring sheet. The coaching foundation.	Coach's Book
HAB Oath	Weekly-recited cultural anchor, signed at certification. Do what's Right · Do what's Fair · Do Your Best.	Front of book
Mastery Ladder	Rookie → Advisor → Closer → Pro → Champion. Evidence-based promotion.	Ch 0 + App D

Group I · Anti-Patterns (get these coached OUT)

ANTI-PATTERN	WHY IT'S BAD
Quoting prices on the phone	Loses both the sale and the relationship. Crashes appointment rate. Earn the appointment first.
Scripting past the stated concern	The customer asks "do you work on brakes?" and the advisor recites the shop introduction instead of answering. Answer the question, close for the visit, introduce after the yes.
Closing a quote call blind	The request was vague or a quote and the advisor closed (or countered on price) without asking the concern question. No concern, no urgency; no urgency, weak close.
Writing the job on a self-diagnosis	The customer named a service, the advisor wrote it without asking why. Inherits someone else's problem, and the shop owns the failure when the "fix" doesn't fix it. Run the Root Concern Rule.
Saying "not just X" — anywhere	"We'll inspect your complete oil system, not just change the oil" subliminally tells the customer NO to the thing they asked for and insinuates EXTRA — and extra means extra cost in the customer's mind, an undisclosed upsell that creates distrust. The construction is banned in ALL customer-facing dialogue, in every script and every boss battle, not only on the phone. State the value affirmatively; the no-charge line needs no justification.
Status Shrinking (the "just" leak)	"I'm just calling to follow up" lowers the advisor's status to elevate the customer's — it says "my time is not as valuable as yours; is it okay that I'm talking to you?" The advisor is the servant, never the subordinate. Kill the word "just" and state the reason for the call as an equal: "I'm calling with an update on your vehicle."
Justifying the free inspection	A why-tail on the no-charge line ("so we know exactly what that light is telling us") re-opens the fear the line just closed. Deliver it clean, then close for the visit.
Selling the inspection too early	Booking the appointment with the DVI, or pitching it before the customer's concern is handled. Book with the concern; present the DVI after the first approval, inside a waiting window, or via the shop introduction video. Coaches audit WHEN, not just whether.
Offering the waiting area at intake	Hands the customer a comfortable way to stay attached to the vehicle — the separation objective fails. Run the keys moment; if they still wait, call the audible.
Pre-educating on the phone	The advisor warns or hints, before any inspection, that the customer's requested service may not fix the problem. It voices the customer's fear, kills the yes, and guesses without evidence. Say yes, get them in; educate after the inspection produces evidence.
Generic "how can I help you" energy	The customer needs relief, not a menu. Use The Relief Line.
Skipping the shop tour	Price objections triple. Trust craters.
Kitchen-Sinking	Dumping all findings into one call. Halves authorization rate. Run the bases.
Skipping Risk in the PRS	Photo + Solution alone is just a quote; "let me think about it" becomes the standard reply.

Pausing after Investment	Triggers sticker shock. Must flow into Coverage immediately.
Arguing with objections	Wins the argument, loses the customer.
Softening Red to Yellow	The spec question is binary. Have the courage to call it what it is.
Defending before Listening	Recovery's #1 killer. The emotion can't drain through your explanation.
"I understand, BUT..."	The word "but" deletes everything before it.
Using the word "policy"	Tells the customer the rule matters more than they do. Banned in recovery.
Discounting as the first move	Trains customers that complaining = discounts.
Vague recoveries	"We'll get back to you" instead of "I'll call you by 3pm."

The 9 KPIs and Targets

Wall-mount these. Update weekly. Color-code Green / Yellow / Red. Diagnose to the step.

KPI	TARGET	MAPS TO	IF RED, THE ACTUAL PROBLEM IS USUALLY...
Inquiry → Appointment %	≥ 65%	M1 (Rapport)	Quoting on the phone instead of earning the appointment.
Tour Delivery %	100%	M2 (Credibility)	Forgetting the tour when busy — it's the highest-leverage habit.
DVI w/ Media %	≥ 95%	M4 (Inspect)	Tech laziness or no enforcement; M6 will fail without M4.
PRS Completeness	100%	M5/M6 (Strategize/ Present)	Skipping Risk is the most common omission.
1st-Objection Close %	≥ 60%	M7 (Objections)	Arguing instead of listening; reaching for "but."
Authorization Rate	≥ 75%	M8 (Close)	Almost always an upstream failure, not the close itself.
Missed-Sale Recovered %	≥ 25%	M5 Short Stop / M7	Not following up at all is the #1 cause.
ARO	Shop benchmark	M8 (Close)	Tied to PRS Completeness and base order.
5-Star Review %	≥ 80%	All modules	Cumulative — every step contributes. Check the recovery log first.

PRO TIP · READING TWO RED NUMBERS

When two metrics go red in the same week, look for the common root cause one step earlier in the funnel. If any metric goes red two weeks in a row, that becomes the coach's focus metric for the following week — automatically.

Module-Level KPIs (quick reference)

MODULE	KPIS & TARGETS
M1 Rapport	Greet-to-Tour ≥ 80% · 2-Ring Compliance 100% · Inquiry-to-Appointment ≥ 65%
M2 Credibility	Tour Delivery 100% · Tour → DVI Consent ≥ 95% · Tour Duration 75–90 sec
M3 Custody	Inquiry-to-RO ≥ 70% · Boom-Board Complete 100% · Separation Time ≤ 10 min
M4 Inspect	DVI Completion 100% · DVI w/ Media ≥ 95% · DVI View-Rate ≥ 75%
M5 Strategize	Base-Order Compliance ≥ 90% · PRS Completeness 100% · Same-Call Mixing ≤ 5%
M6 Present	Present → Auth ≥ 70% · PRS Completeness 100% · DVI View Before Call ≥ 75%
M7 Objections	1st-Objection Close ≥ 60% · Missed-Sale Recovered ≥ 25% · Boss Coverage 9/9
M8 Close	Authorization Rate ≥ 75% · ARO benchmark · 5-Star Review ≥ 80%
M9 Recovery	Recovery Rate ≥ 90% · Time-to-Acknowledge ≤ 1 hr · Post-Recovery 5-Star ≥ 60%

Your Mastery Tracker

The road from Rookie to Champion. Evidence-based promotion only — mastery checks in live customer calls. Sign as you go.

The Promotion Bars

PROMOTION	THE EVIDENCE REQUIRED (LIVE CALLS, NEVER ROLEPLAY ALONE)
Rookie → Advisor	5 consecutive calls where you identify concern vs. symptom correctly without coach prompting, and run M1–M2 without visibly reading the script. Plus: 8/8 Rapport mastery checks across 3 consecutive inbound calls.
Advisor → Closer	10 consecutive calls where Diamond order is correct, PRS is complete, and the East-West close is used. At least 3 must include a Boss Battle handled to authorization. Plus: 7/7 base-selling checks across 2 real workflows.
Closer → Pro	All 9 Boss Battles defeated in live calls within a single 30-day window. At least 2 Short Stop re-opens converted to authorization. Library-certified (3 random worked examples, back to back, from memory).
Pro → Champion	Customers request you by name (verifiable from intake logs). You train another advisor through at least one mastery check. You own a shop-floor coaching ritual (lead the daily drill or a Friday 1:1 for peers). L.A.S.T. used on 3 real recoveries with documented retention + a positive review.

Certification Tracker

MASTERY CHECK · SIGN AS YOU GO

- ☐ **Level 1 → ADVISOR:** 8/8 mastery checks across 3 inbound calls. Signed by Trainer: _____ Date: _____
- ☐ **Level 2 → TOUR GUIDE / CREDIBILITY CERTIFIED:** 8+ score on three live shop tours under 90 seconds. Signed by Trainer: _____ Date: _____
- ☐ **Level 3 → CLOSER:** 7/7 base-selling checks across 2 workflows. Signed by Manager: _____ Date: _____
- ☐ **Level 4 → PRO:** All 9 Boss Battles defeated in 30 days. Signed by Manager: _____ Date: _____
- ☐ **Level 5 → CHAMPION:** L.A.S.T. on 3 real recoveries + positive review + trained another advisor. Signed by Owner: _____ Date: _____

PRO TIP · THE TWO HARD JUMPS

The transition from Advisor to Closer is the hardest — it's where scripts become strategy. The transition from Pro to Champion is the longest — it's where skill becomes culture. Most advisors plateau at Closer. Don't. The Champion promotion is the moment a shop's culture inflects, and it can be you.

Your Weekly Self-Audit (all modules)

END-OF-SHIFT, TWO MINUTES

- ☐ One win I'll repeat tomorrow: _____
- ☐ One gap I'll close tomorrow: _____
- ☐ One ask for my coach: _____

From uncertainty to certainty. From script to instinct. From advisor to closer.

RECOMMIT

I will treat every car as if it carries my own family.

DO WHAT'S RIGHT · DO WHAT'S FAIR · DO YOUR BEST

HAB ADVISOR BOOK · VERSION 2.9 · CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY ·
HEALTHY AUTO BUSINESS